“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 1

The Festival of Association with Śrī Rūpa

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. When the Gauḍīya devotees received word that Mahāprabhu had returned from Śrī Vṛndāvana to Śrī Kṣetra, they set out for Puruṣottama. Śivānanda Sena was taking a dog along with him and paying its fare at the river crossings. One night the dog was not given its rice, and it went away to the Lord. The next day Śivānanda and the others reached Mahāprabhu and saw that very dog eating *prasāda* — coconut pulp the Lord had given it. Afterwards the dog attained liberation and went (to Vaikuṇṭha). Meanwhile Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī had set out from Vṛndāvana, but he could not travel together with the Gauḍīya devotees: he reached Nīlācala some days later and stayed with Haridāsa. Mahāprabhu read the verse “*priyaḥ so 'yaṁ*” composed by Śrī Rūpa and was overjoyed. One day Mahāprabhu came to Haridāsa's dwelling with Rāmānanda Rāya, Sārvabhauma and other devotees and heard the introductory and other verses of Śrī Rūpa's two plays, the *Lalita-mādhava* and the *Vidagdha-mādhava*. Rāmānanda Rāya examined many of their parts, major and minor, and concluded that both plays were of the highest excellence. After the *cāturmāsya* the Gauḍīya devotees, by the Lord's order, set out for Gauḍa. Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī remained in Śrī Kṣetra.

Homage to the all-merciful Supreme Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu —

পঙ্গুং লঙ্ঘয়তে শৈলং মূকমাবর্ত্তয়েচ্ছ্রুতিম্ ।
যৎকৃপা তমহং বন্দে কৃষ্ণচৈতন্যমীশ্বরম্ ॥ ১ ॥

paṅguṁ laṅghayate śailaṁ
the lame makes cross a mountain
mūkam āvartayec chrutim
the mute makes recite the scriptures (śruti)
yat-kṛpā tam ahaṁ vande
whose mercy to Him I offer obeisance
kṛṣṇa-caitanyam īśvaram
to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya the Lord

1 I offer obeisance to the Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, whose mercy makes the lame cross a mountain and the mute recite the scriptures.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I worship the Lord, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, whose mercy gives the lame the strength to cross a mountain and makes the mute recite the *śruti*.

Anubhāṣya.
yat-kṛpā (*yat*, whose — that is, Caitanyacandra's — mercy) **paṅguṁ** (a person without the strength to take a step) **śailaṁ** (to the peak of the highest mountain) **laṅghayate** (makes cross), **mūkam** (a person without the power of speech) **śrutiṁ** (the Veda) **āvartayet** (makes recite), **tam īśvaram** (that Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu) **ahaṁ vande** (I worship).

A prayer for the mercy of the saints —

দুর্গমে পথি মেঽন্ধস্য স্খলৎপাদগতের্মুহুঃ ।
স্বকৃপা-যষ্টিদানেন সন্তঃ সন্ত্ববলম্বনম্ ॥ ২ ॥

durgame pathi me 'ndhasya
on the difficult path for me blind
skhalat-pāda-gater muhuḥ
slipping of feet whose gait constantly
sva-kṛpā-yaṣṭi-dānena
their own mercy's staff by the gift
santaḥ santv avalambanam
the saints may be the support

2 I am blind, and on this difficult path my feet keep slipping. May the saints give me the staff of their mercy and be my support.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

May the saints give me the staff of their mercy and become my support, for I am blind, and my feet keep slipping on a difficult path.

Anubhāṣya.

santaḥ (the saints) **sva-kṛpā-yaṣṭi-dānena** (by giving their own mercy as a support) **durgame** (impassable) **pathi** (on the path of worldly existence) **muhuḥ** (again and again) **skhalat-pāda-gateḥ** (of one whose feet stumble, who has strayed from the path) **andhasya** (eyeless) **me** (my) **avalambanam** (shelter) **santu** (may become).

শ্রীরূপ, সনাতন, ভট্ট-রঘুনাথ ।
শ্রীজীব, গোপালভট্ট, দাস রঘুনাথ ॥ ৩ ॥

śrī rūpa, sanātana, bhaṭṭa-raghunātha
Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Bhaṭṭa Raghunātha
śrī-jīva, gopāla-bhaṭṭa, dāsa raghunātha
Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, Dāsa Raghunātha

3 Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa, Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa and Raghunātha Dāsa —[1]

এই ছয় গুরুর করোঁ চরণ বন্দন ।
যাহা হৈতে বিঘ্ননাশ, অভীষ্ট-পূরণ ॥ ৪ ॥

ei chaya gurura karoṁ caraṇa vandana
of these six gurus I make to the feet obeisance
yāhā haite vighna-nāśa, abhīṣṭa-pūraṇa
from whom come of obstacles destruction, of the desired fulfilment

4 I bow at the feet of these six gurus, by whose grace obstacles are destroyed and all one longs for is fulfilled.

জয়তাং সুরতৌ পঙ্গোর্মম মন্দমতের্গতী ।
মৎসর্ব্বস্বপদাম্ভোজৌ রাধা-মদনমোহনৌ ॥ ৫ ॥

jayatāṁ suratau paṅgor
glory to the merciful (Pair) of the lame
mama manda-mater gatī
of me of dull mind the refuge
mat-sarvasva-padāmbhojau
whose lotus feet are my all
rādhā-madana-mohanau
Rādhā and Madana-mohana

5 All glory to the merciful Śrī Śrī Rādhā and Madana-mohana! I am lame and dull of mind, and They are my only refuge; Their lotus feet are all I have.[2]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.15.

দীব্যদ্বৃন্দারণ্যকল্পদ্রুমাধঃ
শ্রীমদ্রত্নাগারসিংহাসনস্থৌ ।
শ্রীমদ্রাধা-শ্রীলগোবিন্দদেবৌ
প্রেষ্ঠালীভিঃ সেব্যমানৌ স্মরামি ॥ ৬ ॥

dīvyad-vṛndāraṇya-kalpa-drumādhaḥ
shining in Vṛndāvana forest wish-fulfilling tree beneath
śrīmad-ratnāgāra-siṁhāsana-sthau
in a beautiful jewel temple on a lion-throne seated
śrīmad-rādhā-śrīla-govinda-devau
the beautiful Rādhā Śrīla Govinda the Deities
preṣṭhālībhiḥ sevyamānau smarāmi
by Their dearest friends being served I remember

6 I remember Śrīmatī Rādhā and Śrī Govindadeva, seated on a throne in a beautiful temple of jewels beneath a wish-fulfilling tree in the radiant forest of Vṛndāvana, served by Their dearest companions.[3]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.16.

শ্রীমান্‌রাসরসারম্ভী বংশীবটতটস্থিতঃ ।
কর্ষন্‌ বেণুস্বনৈর্গোপীর্গোপীনাথঃ শ্রিয়েঽস্তু নঃ ॥ ৭ ॥

śrīmān rāsa-rasārambhī
the beautiful of the rāsa dance's sweetness the initiator
vaṁśīvaṭa-taṭa-sthitaḥ
of Vaṁśīvaṭa on the bank standing
karṣan veṇu-svanair gopīr
drawing with the flute's sounds the gopīs
gopī-nāthaḥ śriye 'stu naḥ
of the gopīs the Lord for good may be ours

7 May the beautiful Śrī Gopīnātha, who begins the sweet rāsa dance, be our good fortune. Standing on the bank by Vaṁśīvaṭa, He draws the gopīs to Himself with the sounds of His flute.[4]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.17.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ৮ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory to Gaura's devotees host

8 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura![5]

The beginning of the description of the Antya-līlā —

মধ্যলীলা সংক্ষেপেতে করিলুঁ বর্ণন ।
অন্ত্যলীলা-বর্ণন কিছু শুন, ভক্তগণ ॥ ৯ ॥

madhya-līlā saṅkṣepete kariluṁ varṇana
the Madhya-līlā in brief I have made description
antya-līlā-varṇana kichu śuna, bhakta-gaṇa
of the Antya-līlā the description something hear, O devotees

9 I have described the Madhya-līlā in brief. Now, O devotees, hear something of the Antya-līlā.

*The *sūtras* of the Antya-līlā have already been given, in Madhya-līlā, Chapter 1 —*

মধ্যলীলা-মধ্যে অন্ত্যলীলা-সূত্রগণ ।
পূর্ব্বগ্রন্থে সংক্ষেপেতে কৈরাছি বর্ণন ॥ ১০ ॥

madhya-līlā-madhye antya-līlā-sūtra-gaṇa
of the Madhya-līlā within of the Antya-līlā the sūtras all
pūrva-granthe saṅkṣepete kairāchi varṇana
in the earlier part of the book in brief I have made description

10 Within the Madhya-līlā, in the earlier part of this book, I have briefly described the sūtras (summaries) of the Antya-līlā.

Anubhāṣya.
Pūrva-granthe (in the earlier part of the book) — in the first chapter of the Madhya-līlā.

আমি জরাগ্রস্ত, নিকটে জানিয়া মরণ ।
অন্ত্যলীলার কোন সূত্র কৈরাছি বর্ণন ॥ ১১ ॥

āmi jarā-grasta, nikaṭe jāniyā maraṇa
I by old age seized, near knowing death
antya-līlāra kona sūtra kairāchi varṇana
of the Antya-līlā some sūtras I have made description

11 I am overcome by old age, and knowing that death is near, I have described some sūtras of the Antya-līlā.

*A promise to describe in detail the *sūtras* not mentioned before —*

পূর্ব্ব-লিখিত গ্রন্থসূত্র অনুসারে ।
যেই নাহি লিখি, তাহা লিখিয়ে বিস্তারে ॥ ১২ ॥

pūrva-likhita grantha-sūtra anusāre
earlier written of the book the sūtras according to
yei nāhi likhi, tāhā likhiye vistāre
whatever not I wrote, that I write in detail

12 Following the sūtras written earlier in the book, I now describe in detail what I have not written before.

Word sent to Gauḍa that the Lord has returned from Vṛndāvana to Purī —

বৃন্দাবন হৈতে প্রভু নীলাচলে আইলা ।
স্বরূপ-গোসাঞি গৌড়ে বার্ত্তা পাঠাইলা ॥ ১৩ ॥

vṛndāvana haite prabhu nīlācale āilā
Vṛndāvana from the Lord to Nīlācala came
svarūpa-gosāñi gauḍe vārtā pāṭhāilā
Svarūpa Gosāñi to Gauḍa news sent

13 When the Lord returned from Vṛndāvana to Nīlācala, Svarūpa Gosāñi sent word of it to Gauḍa.

Śacī hears the news; the devotees prepare to go to Purī —

শুনি' শচী আনন্দিত, সব ভক্তগণ ।
সবে মিলি' নীলাচলে করিলা গমন ॥ ১৪ ॥

śuni' śacī ānandita, saba bhakta-gaṇa
hearing Śacī was delighted, all the devotees
sabe mili' nīlācale karilā gamana
all gathering to Nīlācala made the journey

14 Hearing this, Śacī and all the devotees rejoiced, and together they set out for Nīlācala.

All the devotees come to Śivānanda —

কুলীনগ্রামী ভক্ত আর যত খণ্ডবাসী ।
আচার্য্য, শিবানন্দে মিলিলা সবে আসি' ॥ ১৫ ॥

kulīna-grāmī bhakta āra yata khaṇḍa-vāsī
of Kulīnagrāma the devotees and all of Khaṇḍa the residents
ācārya, śivānande mililā sabe āsi'
the Ācārya, with Śivānanda met all coming

15 The devotees of Kulīnagrāma, all the residents of Khaṇḍa and the Ācārya came and joined Śivānanda.

Anubhāṣya.
Ācārya — Śrī Advaita Ācārya.

Śivānanda looks after everyone —

শিবানন্দ করে সবার ঘাটি সমাধান ।
সবারে পালন করে, দেয় বাসা স্থান ॥ ১৬ ॥

śivānanda kare sabāra ghāṭi samādhāna
Śivānanda makes for all at the tollgates settlement
sabāre pālana kare, deya vāsā sthāna
all care takes, gives lodging place

16 Śivānanda settled everyone's dues at the tollgates, looked after them all and found them places to stay.

The story of Śivānanda's dog, a devotee of the Lord —

এক কুক্কুর চলে শিবানন্দ-সনে ।
ভক্ষ্য দিয়া লঞা চলে করিয়া পালনে ॥ ১৭ ॥

eka kukkura cale śivānanda-sane
one dog goes with Śivānanda
bhakṣya diyā lañā cale kariyā pālane
food giving, taking (it) along he goes showing care

17 A dog was travelling with Śivānanda. He fed it and took it along with loving care.

একদিন একস্থানে নদী পার হৈতে ।
ওড়িয়া নাবিক কুক্কুর না চড়ায় নৌকাতে ॥ ১৮ ॥

ekadina eka-sthāne nadī pāra haite
one day in one place the river across while crossing
oḍiyā nāvika kukkura nā caḍāya naukāte
an Oriya boatman the dog not lets board into the boat

18 One day, at a river crossing, an Oriya boatman would not let the dog into his boat.

কুক্কুর রহিলা, — শিবানন্দ দুঃখী হৈলা ।
দশ পণ কড়ি দিয়া কুক্কুরে পার কৈলা ॥ ১৯ ॥

kukkura rahilā, — śivānanda duḥkhī hailā
the dog remained, Śivānanda sad became
daśa paṇa kaḍi diyā kukkure pāra kailā
ten paṇas of cowries giving, the dog across he took

19 The dog was left behind, and Śivānanda grew sad. He paid ten *paṇas* of cowries and had the dog taken across.

একদিন শিবানন্দ ঘাটিতে রহিলা ।
কুক্কুরকে ভাত দিতে সেবক পাসরিলা ॥ ২০ ॥

ekadina śivānanda ghāṭite rahilā
one day Śivānanda at the tollgate remained
kukkurake bhāta dite sevaka pāsarilā
to the dog rice to give the servant forgot

20 One day Śivānanda had to stay behind at a tollgate, and his servant forgot to give the dog its rice.[6]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Pāsarilā — forgot.

রাত্রে আসি' শিবানন্দ ভোজনের কালে ।
'কুক্কুর পাঞাছে ভাত?' — সেবকে পুছিলে ॥ ২১ ॥

rātre āsi' śivānanda bhojanera kāle
at night coming Śivānanda of the meal at the time
kukkura pāñāche bhāta? — sevake puchile
the dog has received rice? the servant he asked

21 When he returned at night, Śivānanda asked his servant at mealtime, "Has the dog been given its rice?"

কুক্কুর নাহি পায় ভাত শুনি' দুঃখী হৈলা ।
কুক্কুর চাহিতে দশ-মনুষ্য পাঠাইলা ॥ ২২ ॥

kukkura nāhi pāya bhāta śuni' duḥkhī hailā
the dog not received rice hearing sad he became
kukkura cāhite daśa-manuṣya pāṭhāilā
the dog to search for ten men he sent

22 Hearing that the dog had not been fed, he grew sad and sent ten men to search for it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Cāhite — to search.

চাহিয়া না পাইল কুক্কুর, লোক সব আইলা ।
দুঃখী হঞা শিবানন্দ উপবাস কৈলা ॥ ২৩ ॥

cāhiyā nā pāila kukkura, loka saba āilā
searching not found the dog, the men all came back
duḥkhī hañā śivānanda upavāsa kailā
sad becoming Śivānanda a fast observed

23 The men searched but could not find the dog, and they all came back. In his sorrow Śivānanda fasted.

প্রভাতে কুক্কুর চাহি’ কাঁহা না পাইল ।
সকল বৈষ্ণবের মনে চমৎকার হৈল ॥ ২৪ ॥

prabhāte kukkura cāhi’ kāṁhā nā pāila
in the morning the dog searching for anywhere not they found
sakala vaiṣṇavera mane camatkāra haila
of all the Vaiṣṇavas in the minds wonder arose

24 In the morning they searched for the dog but found it nowhere, and all the Vaiṣṇavas were astonished.

উৎকণ্ঠায় চলি’ সবে আইলা নীলাচলে ।
পূর্ব্ববৎ মহাপ্রভু মিলিলা সকলে ॥ ২৫ ॥

utkaṇṭhāya cali’ sabe āilā nīlācale
anxiously traveling all came to Nīlācala
pūrvavat mahāprabhu mililā sakale
as before Mahāprabhu met with all

25 Restless at heart, they all travelled on to Nīlācala, and Mahāprabhu met them all as before.

সবা লঞা কৈলা জগন্নাথ দরশন ।
সবা লঞা মহাপ্রভু করেন ভোজন ॥ ২৬ ॥

sabā lañā kailā jagannātha daraśana
all taking He had of Jagannātha darśana
sabā lañā mahāprabhu karena bhojana
all taking (with Him) Mahāprabhu takes His meal

26 He brought them all for darśana of Jagannātha, and then Mahāprabhu took His meal together with them.

পূর্ব্ববৎ সবারে প্রভু পাঠাইলা বাসা-স্থানে ।
প্রভু-স্থানে আর দিন সবার গমনে ॥ ২৭ ॥

pūrvavat sabāre prabhu pāṭhāilā vāsā-sthāne
as before all the Lord sent to their lodgings
prabhu-sthāne āra dina sabāra gamane
to the Lord's place the next day of all the coming

27 As before, the Lord sent everyone to their lodgings, and the next day they all came to Him.

আসিয়া দেখিল সবে সেই ত' কুক্কুরে ।
প্রভু-পাশে বসিয়াছে কিছু অল্পদূরে ॥ ২৮ ॥

āsiyā dekhila sabe sei ta' kukkure
coming saw all that very dog
prabhu-pāśe vasiyāche kichu alpa-dūre
near the Lord is sitting a little at a short distance

28 When they arrived, they all saw that very dog sitting a short distance from the Lord.

প্রসাদ নারিকেল-শস্য দেন ফেলাঞা ।
'রাম' 'কৃষ্ণ' 'হরি' কহ' — বলেন হাসিয়া ॥ ২৯ ॥

prasāda nārikela-śasya dena phelāñā
prasāda coconut pulp He gives tossing
'rāma' 'kṛṣṇa' 'hari' kaha' — balena hāsiyā
"Rāma" "Kṛṣṇa" "Hari" say He says smiling

29 The Lord was tossing it coconut pulp, His prasāda, and with a smile He said, "Say 'Rāma,' 'Kṛṣṇa,' 'Hari'!"

শস্য খায় কুক্কুর, 'কৃষ্ণ' কহে বার বার ।
দেখিয়া লোকের মনে হৈল চমৎকার ॥ ৩০ ॥

śasya khāya kukkura, 'kṛṣṇa' kahe bāra bāra
the pulp eats the dog, "Kṛṣṇa" says again and again
dekhiyā lokera mane haila camatkāra
seeing of the people in the minds arose wonder

30 The dog ate the pulp and said “Kṛṣṇa” again and again. The sight filled the people with wonder.[7]

শিবানন্দ কুক্কুর দেখি’ দণ্ডবৎ কৈলা ।
দৈন্য করি’ নিজ অপরাধ ক্ষমাইলা ॥ ৩১ ॥

śivānanda kukkura dekhi’ daṇḍavat kailā
Śivānanda the dog seeing obeisance offered
dainya kari’ nija aparādha kṣamāilā
humility showing his own offense had forgiven

31 When Śivānanda saw the dog, he bowed down before it and humbly begged forgiveness for his offence.

The dog attains perfection and reaches Vaikuṇṭha —

আর দিন কেহ তার দেখা না পাইলা ।
সিদ্ধ-দেহ পাঞা কুক্কুর বৈকুণ্ঠেতে গেলা ॥ ৩২ ॥

āra dina keha tāra dekhā nā pāilā
the next day anyone its sight not got
siddha-deha pāñā kukkura vaikuṇṭhete gelā
a perfected body attaining the dog to Vaikuṇṭha went

32 From the next day no one saw the dog again: it had attained a perfected body and gone to Vaikuṇṭha.

The Lord, full of wonderful, unearthly pastimes —

ঐছে দিব্যলীলা করে শচীর নন্দন ।
কুক্কুরকে ‘কৃষ্ণ’ কহাঞা করিলা মোচন ॥ ৩৩ ॥

aiche divya-līlā kare śacīra nandana
such divine pastimes performs of Śacī the son
kukkurake ‘kṛṣṇa’ kahāñā karilā mocana
the dog “Kṛṣṇa” making say He made deliverance

33 Such are the divine pastimes of the son of Śacī: He made even a dog say "Kṛṣṇa," and so He delivered it.

Śrī Rūpa comes to Vṛndāvana and begins writing the play —

এথা প্রভু-আজ্ঞায় রূপ আইলা বৃন্দাবন ।
কৃষ্ণলীলা-নাটক করিতে হৈল মন ॥ ৩৪ ॥

ethā prabhu-ājñāya rūpa āilā vṛndāvana
meanwhile by the Lord's order Rūpa came to Vṛndāvana
kṛṣṇa-līlā-nāṭaka karite haila mana
of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes a drama to write there arose the wish

34 Meanwhile, by the Lord's order, Rūpa had come to Vṛndāvana, and the wish arose in him to write a drama on Kṛṣṇa's pastimes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa-līlā-nāṭaka — a play about Kṛṣṇa's pastimes.

বৃন্দাবনে নাটকের আরম্ভ করিলা ।
মঙ্গলাচরণ 'নান্দী-শ্লোক' তথাই লিখিলা ॥ ৩৫ ॥

vṛndāvane nāṭakera ārambha karilā
in Vṛndāvana of the drama the beginning he made
maṅgalācaraṇa 'nāndī-śloka' tathāi likhilā
the invocation the nāndī verse right there he wrote

35 He began the drama in Vṛndāvana and wrote its invocation, the *nāndī* verse, right there.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Nāndī-śloka — the auspicious invocatory verse recited at the start of a play is called the *nāndī* verse.

Anubhāṣya.
Nāndī. The *Nāṭaka-candrikā* says: "At the opening, in the prologue (*prastāvanā*), one should place an auspicious *nāndī*. It contains one of three things — a blessing, an obeisance, or an indication of the subject. It consists of eight, ten, or twelve *padas*, is usually marked with a name of the moon, and

shines with auspicious words. Auspicious things are the discus, the lotus, the *cakora* bird, the night lotus (*kumuda*), and so on." The *Sāhitya-darpaṇa*, in its sixth chapter, at number 282, says: "It is called *nāndī* because in it praise of the gods, the *brāhmaṇas*, kings and others is offered together with a blessing."

*Śrī Rūpa sets out for Gauḍa with his younger brother and drafts the play in the form of *sūtras* —*

পথে চলি' আইসে নাটকের ঘটনা ভাবিতে ।
কড়চা করিয়া কিছু লাগিলা লিখিতে ॥ ৩৬ ॥

pathe cali' āise nāṭakera ghaṭanā bhāvite
on the road traveling he comes of the drama the plot pondering
kaḍacā kariyā kichu lāgilā likhite
a draft making something he began to write

36 As he travelled, he pondered the plot of the drama, and he began to set some of it down in a draft (*kaḍacā*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kaḍacā — a draft, that is, a rough manuscript.

In Gauḍa Anupama leaves this world on the bank of the Ganges —

এইমতে দুইভাই গৌড়দেশে আইলা ।
গৌড়ে আসি' অনুপমের গঙ্গা-প্রাপ্তি হৈলা ॥ ৩৭ ॥

ei-mate dui-bhāi gauḍa-deśe āilā
in this way the two brothers to Gauḍa came
gauḍe āsi' anupamera gaṅgā-prāpti hailā
in Gauḍa coming Anupama's attaining of the Gaṅgā took place

37 In this way the two brothers came to Gauḍa, and there Anupama left this world on the bank of the Gaṅgā.

Anubhāṣya.
The two brothers — Śrī Rūpa and his younger brother, Śrī Anupama.

Śrī Rūpa sets out for Purī to see the Lord —

রূপ-গোসাঞি প্রভুপাশে করিলা গমন ।
প্রভুরে দেখিতে তাঁর উৎকণ্ঠিত মন ॥ ৩৮ ॥

rūpa-gosāñi prabhu-pāśe karilā gamana
Rūpa Gosāñi to the Lord made his way
prabhure dekhite tāṁra utkaṇṭhita mana
the Lord to see his longing heart

38 Rūpa Gosāñi set out for the Lord; his heart longed to see Him.

Anupama's departure delayed Śrī Rūpa, and he missed the Gauḍīya devotees going to see the Lord —

অনুপমের লাগি' তাঁর বিলম্ব হইল ।
ভক্তগণ-পাশ আইলা, লাগ্ না পাইল ॥ ৩৯ ॥

anupamera lāgi' tāṁra vilamba ha-ila
of Anupama because his delay occurred
bhakta-gaṇa-pāśa āilā, lāg nā pāila
to the devotees he came, meeting not he got

39 Because of Anupama he was delayed, and when he came to join the devotees, he found they had already gone.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Lāg nā pāila — Śrī Rūpa heard that Śivānanda and the other devotees were going to the Lord, and he came intending to go to Nīlācala with them. But he could not meet them: they had already left for Nīlācala.

*Satyabhāmā-devī's instruction in Satyabhāmāpura is the origin of the *Lalita-mādhava* —*

ওড়িয়া-দেশে 'সত্যভামাপুর'-নামে গ্রাম ।
এক রাত্রি সেই গ্রামে করিলা বিশ্রাম ॥ ৪০ ॥

oḍiyā-deśe 'satyabhāmā-pura'-nāme grāma
in the Oriya land Satyabhāmā-pura by name a village
eka rātri sei grāme karilā viśrāma
one night in that village he made rest

40 In the land of Orissa there is a village called Satyabhāmā-pura. He rested there for one night.

Anubhāṣya.
The village of Satyabhāmāpura lies near Jānkādeipura in Cuttack district.

রাত্রে স্বপ্নে দেখে, — এক দিব্যরূপা নারী ।
সম্মুখে আসিয়া আজ্ঞা দিলা কৃপা করি' ॥ ৪১ ॥

rātre svapne dekhe, — eka divya-rūpā nārī
at night in a dream he sees, a divinely beautiful woman
sammukhe āsiyā ājñā dilā kṛpā kari'
before him coming an order she gave mercy showing

41 That night he saw in a dream a woman of divine beauty. She came before him and graciously gave him an order:

"আমার নাটক পৃথক্ করহ রচন ।
আমার কৃপাতে নাটক হবে বিলক্ষণ" ॥ ৪২ ॥

āmāra nāṭaka pṛthak karaha racana
my drama separately make composition
āmāra kṛpāte nāṭaka habe vilakṣaṇa
by my mercy the drama will be extraordinary

42 "Compose a separate drama about me. By my mercy the drama will be extraordinary."

Śrī Rūpa's reflections —

স্বপ্ন দেখি' রূপ-গোসাঞি করিলা বিচার ।
সত্যভামার আজ্ঞা — পৃথক্ নাটক করিবার ॥ ৪৩ ॥

svapna dekhi' rūpa-gosāñi karilā vicāra
the dream seeing Rūpa Gosāñi made reflection
satyabhāmāra ājñā — pṛthak nāṭaka karibāra
Satyabhāmā's order a separate drama to write

43 After this dream Rūpa Gosāñi reflected: "Satyabhāmā orders me to write a separate drama.

A resolve to describe, in separate plays, the pastimes in Vraja and in the cities, earlier described together —

ব্রজ-পুর-লীলা একত্র কৈরাছি ঘটনা ।
দুই ভাগ করি' এবে করিমু রচনা ॥ ৪৪ ॥

vraja-pura-līlā ekatra kairāchi ghaṭanā
of Vraja of the cities the pastimes together I have made the plot
dui bhāga kari' ebe karimu racanā
two parts making now I shall make the composition

44 I have joined the pastimes of Vraja and of the cities in one plot. Now I shall divide them into two parts and compose them."

Śrī Rūpa arrives in Purī at the dwelling of Ṭhākura Haridāsa in the Siddha-bakula Maṭha —

ভাবিতে ভাবিতে শীঘ্র আইলা নীলাচলে ।
আসি' উত্তরিলা হরিদাস-বাসাস্থলে ॥ ৪৫ ॥

bhāvite bhāvite śīghra āilā nīlācale
thinking thinking quickly he came to Nīlācala
āsi' uttarilā haridāsa-vāsā-sthale
coming he stayed at Haridāsa's dwelling

45 Absorbed in these thoughts, he soon reached Nīlācala and went to stay at Haridāsa's dwelling.

The Ṭhākura's affectionate words —

হরিদাস-ঠাকুর তাঁরে বহুকৃপা কৈলা ।
'তুমি আসিবে, — মোরে প্রভু যে কহিলা' ॥ ৪৬ ॥

haridāsa-ṭhākura tāṁre bahu-kṛpā kailā
Haridāsa Ṭhākura to him great mercy showed
tumi āsibe, — more prabhu ye kahilā
you will come to me the Lord that told

46 Haridāsa Ṭhākura received him with great kindness and said, "The Lord told me that you would come."

*The Lord comes unexpectedly to give Haridāsa His *darśana* —*

'উপল-ভোগ' দেখি' হরিদাসেরে দেখিতে ।
প্রতিদিন আইসেন, প্রভু আইলা আচম্বিতে ॥ ৪৭ ॥

'upala-bhoga' dekhi' haridāsere dekhite
the upala-bhoga seeing Haridāsa to see
pratidina āisena, prabhu āilā ācambite
every day He comes; the Lord came unexpectedly

47 Every day, after seeing the *upala-bhoga* offering, the Lord would come to see Haridāsa. Now He arrived unexpectedly.

Śrī Rūpa bows down to the Lord, and the Lord embraces him —

'রূপ দণ্ডবৎ করে', — হরিদাস কহিলা ।
হরিদাসে মিলি' প্রভু রূপে আলিঙ্গিলা ॥ ৪৮ ॥

rūpa daṇḍavat kare, — haridāsa kahilā
Rūpa obeisance offers, Haridāsa said
haridāse mili' prabhu rūpe āliṅgilā
with Haridāsa meeting the Lord Rūpa embraced

48 "Rūpa is offering You obeisance," said Haridāsa. The Lord greeted Haridāsa and then embraced Rūpa.

Their conversation —

হরিদাস, রূপে লঞা প্রভু বসিলা একস্থানে ।
কুশল-প্রশ্ন, ইষ্টগোষ্ঠী কৈলা কতক্ষণে ॥ ৪৯ ॥

haridāsa, rūpe lañā prabhu vasilā eka-sthāne
Haridāsa, Rūpa taking the Lord sat in one place
kuśala-praśna, iṣṭa-goṣṭhī kailā kata-kṣaṇe
about welfare questions, talk on Kṛṣṇa He had for some time

49 The Lord sat down together with Haridāsa and Rūpa. He asked about their welfare, and for some time they spoke together of Kṛṣṇa (*iṣṭa-goṣṭhī*).

The Lord asks about Sanātana; Śrī Rūpa says he did not meet him —

সনাতনের বার্ত্তা যবে গোসাঞি পুছিল ।
রূপ কহে, — "তাঁর সঙ্গে দেখা না হইল ॥ ৫০ ॥

sanātanera vārtā yabe gosāñi puchila
of Sanātana news when Gosāñi (the Lord) asked
rūpa kahe, — tāṁra saṅge dekhā nā haila
Rūpa says, him with meeting not happened

50 When the Lord asked for news of Sanātana, Rūpa said, "I did not meet him.

The reason explained —

আমি গঙ্গাপথে আইলাঙ, তিঁহো রাজপথে ।
অতএব আমার দেখা নহিল তাঁর সাথে ॥ ৫১ ॥

āmi gaṅgā-pathe āilāṅa, tiṁho rāja-pathe
I by the Gaṅgā route came, he by the main road
ataeva āmāra dekhā nahila tāṁra sāthe
therefore my meeting did not happen with him

51 I came by the route along the Gaṅgā, and he by the main road, so we did not meet.

News of Anupama's departure on the bank of the Ganges —

প্রয়াগে শুনিলুঁ, — তেঁহো গেলা বৃন্দাবনে ।
অনুপমের গঙ্গা-প্রাপ্তি কৈল নিবেদনে” ॥ ৫২ ॥

prayāge śunilum̐, — tem̐ho gelā vṛndāvane
at Prayāga I heard, he went to Vṛndāvana
anupamera gaṅgā-prāpti kaila nivedane
of Anupama the attaining of the Gaṅgā he made report

52 At Prayāga I heard that he had gone to Vṛndāvana.” Then he told the Lord that Anupama had left this world on the bank of the Gaṅgā.

The Lord leaves; His companions meet Śrī Rūpa —

রূপে তাঁহা বাসা দিয়া গোসাঞি চলিলা ।
গোসাঞির সঙ্গী ভক্ত রূপেরে মিলিলা ॥ ৫৩ ॥

rūpe tām̐hā vāsā diyā gosāñi calilā
to Rūpa there lodging giving Gosāñi (the Lord) went away
gosāñira saṅgī bhakta rūpere mililā
of Gosāñi the companions the devotees Rūpa met

53 The Lord gave Rūpa lodging there and left. Then the devotees who accompanied the Lord came to meet Rūpa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Tāṅhā — in Haridāsa's dwelling, that is, in the Siddha-bakula Maṭha.

One day the Lord introduces Śrī Rūpa to the devotees —

আর দিন মহাপ্রভু সব ভক্ত লঞা ।
রূপে মিলাইলা সবায় কৃপা ত’ করিয়া ॥ ৫৪ ॥

āra dina mahāprabhu saba bhakta lañā
the next day Mahāprabhu all the devotees taking
rūpe milāilā sabāya kṛpā ta’ kariyā
Rūpa introduced to all mercy indeed showing

54 The next day Mahāprabhu came with all the devotees and kindly introduced Rūpa to them all.

Śrī Rūpa honors the feet of all the devotees, and all of them embrace Rūpa —

সবার চরণ রূপ করিলা বন্দন ।
কৃপা করি' রূপে সবে কৈলা আলিঙ্গন ॥ ৫৫ ॥

sabāra caraṇa rūpa karilā vandana
of all the feet Rūpa made worship
kṛpā kari' rūpe sabe kailā āliṅgana
mercy showing Rūpa all made embrace

55 Rūpa bowed at the feet of all of them, and they all affectionately embraced him.

Mahāprabhu asks both Prabhus, Nitāi and Advaita, to show mercy to Śrī Rūpa —

'অদ্বৈত নিত্যানন্দ, তোমরা দুইজনে ।
প্রভু কহে — রূপে কৃপা কর কায়মনে ॥ ৫৬ ॥

advaita nityānanda, tomarā dui-jane
Advaita, Nityānanda, You both
prabhu kahe — rūpe kṛpā kara kāya-mane
the Lord says, to Rūpa mercy show with body and mind

56 The Lord said, "Advaita and Nityānanda, both of You, give Rūpa Your mercy with all Your heart.

তোমা-দুঁহার কৃপাতে ইঁহার হউ শক্তি ।
যাতে বিবরিতে পারেন কৃষ্ণরসভক্তি' ॥ ৫৭ ॥

tomā-duṁhāra kṛpāte iṁhāra hau śakti
of You both by the mercy his may be the power
yāte vivarite pārena kṛṣṇa-rasa-bhakti
so that to describe he can in relation to Kṛṣṇa in rasa devotion

57 By the mercy of You both, may he gain the power to describe devotion to Kṛṣṇa and its rasas.”

Śrī Rūpa, beloved of all the Lord's devotees —

গৌড়ীয়া, ওড়িয়া, যত প্রভুর ভক্তগণ ।
সবার হইল রূপ স্নেহের ভাজন ॥ ৫৮ ॥

gauḍīyā, oḍiyā, yata prabhura bhakta-gaṇa
Gauḍīya, Oriya, all of the Lord the devotees
sabāra haila rūpa snehera bhājana
of all became Rūpa of affection the object

58 All the Lord’s devotees, from Gauḍa and from Orissa, came to hold Rūpa dear.

*The Lord Himself gives Śrī Rūpa His *darśana* and *prasāda* every day —*

প্রতিদিন আসি’ রূপে করেন মিলনে ।
মন্দিরে যে প্রসাদ পান, দেন দুই জনে ॥ ৫৯ ॥

pratidina āsi’ rūpe karena milane
every day coming with Rūpa He makes meeting
mandire ye prasāda pāna, dena dui jane
in the temple whatever prasāda He receives He gives to the two persons

59 Every day the Lord came to meet Rūpa, and whatever prasāda He received in the temple He gave to the two of them.

Talks about Kṛṣṇa —

ইষ্টগোষ্ঠী দুঁহা-সনে করি’ কতক্ষণ ।
মধ্যাহ্ন করিতে প্রভু করিলা গমন ॥ ৬০ ॥

iṣṭa-goṣṭhī duṁhā-sane kari’ kata-kṣaṇa
talk on Kṛṣṇa with the two having for some time
madhyāhna karite prabhu karilā gamana
the midday duties to perform the Lord made departure

60 After speaking with them of Kṛṣṇa for a while, the Lord would leave to perform His midday duties.

Śrī Rūpa's joy at receiving the Lord's mercy —

এইমত প্রতিদিন প্রভুর ব্যবহার ।
প্রভুকৃপা পাঞা রূপের আনন্দ অপার ॥ ৬১ ॥

ei-mata pratidina prabhura vyavahāra
in this way every day of the Lord the practice
prabhu-kṛpā pāñā rūpera ānanda apāra
the Lord's mercy receiving of Rūpa the joy boundless

61 Such was the Lord's practice every day, and receiving the Lord's mercy, Rūpa felt boundless joy.

The Lord's pastimes with the devotees in Nīlācala —

ভক্তগণ লঞা কৈলা গুণ্ডিচা মার্জ্জন ।
আইটোটা আসি' কৈলা বন্য-ভোজন ॥ ৬২ ॥

bhakta-gaṇa lañā kailā guṇḍicā mārjana
the devotees taking He did of Guṇḍicā the cleansing
āiṭoṭā āsi' kailā vanya-bhojana
to Āiṭoṭā coming He had a feast in the garden

62 With the devotees the Lord cleansed the Guṇḍicā temple; then He came to Āiṭoṭā and held a feast in the garden there.

Anubhāṣya.
Āiṭoṭā — a garden near the Guṇḍicā.

Śrī Rūpa and Haridāsa rejoice to see the joy of all the devotees —

প্রসাদ খায়, 'হরি' বলে সর্ব্বভক্তজন ।
দেখি' হরিদাস-রূপের হরষিত মন ॥ ৬৩ ॥

prasāda khāya, ‘hari’ bale sarva-bhakta-jana
prasāda eat, “Hari” say all the devotees
dekhi’ haridāsa-rūpera haraṣita mana
seeing, of Haridāsa and Rūpa delighted the minds

63 All the devotees were eating prasāda and calling out “Hari!” Seeing this, Haridāsa and Rūpa were delighted.

*Receiving the Lord's remnants, the two dance, overwhelmed by *prema* —*

গোবিন্দদ্বারা প্রভুর শেষ-প্রসাদ পাইলা ।
প্রেমে মত্ত দুইজন নাচিতে লাগিলা ॥ ৬৪ ॥

govinda-dvārā prabhura śeṣa-prasāda pāilā
through Govinda of the Lord the remnants of prasāda they received
preme matta dui-jana nācite lāgilā
in love intoxicated the two to dance began

64 Through Govinda they received the remnants of the Lord’s meal, and the two of them, intoxicated with love, began to dance.

On another day the Lord meets Rūpa —

আর দিন প্রভু রূপে মিলিয়া বসিলা ।
সর্ব্বজ্ঞ-শিরোমণি প্রভু কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ৬৫ ॥

āra dina prabhu rūpe miliyā vasilā
another day the Lord with Rūpa meeting sat
sarvajña-śiromaṇi prabhu kahite lāgilā
of the omniscient the crown jewel the Lord to speak began

65 Another day the Lord met Rūpa and sat with him. The Lord, the crown jewel of the omniscient, began to speak:

*The Lord's merciful order is the origin of the *Vidagdha-mādhava* —*

‘কৃষ্ণেরে বাহির নাহি করিহ ব্রজ হৈতে ।
ব্রজ ছাড়ি’ কৃষ্ণ কভু না যান কাঁহাতে ॥ ৬৬ ॥

kṛṣṇere bāhira nāhi kariha vraja haite
Kṛṣṇa outside not do take Vraja from
vraja chāḍi' kṛṣṇa kabhu nā yāna kāṁhāte
Vraja leaving Kṛṣṇa ever not goes anywhere

66 "Do not take Kṛṣṇa out of Vraja. Kṛṣṇa never leaves Vraja to go anywhere else.

*The son of the king of Vraja stays in Vraja alone (words of the *Yāmala*) —*

কৃষ্ণোঽন্যো যদুসম্ভূতো যস্তু গোপেন্দ্রনন্দনঃ ।
বৃন্দাবনং পরিত্যজ্য স ক্বচিন্নৈব গচ্ছতি' ॥ ৬৭ ॥

kṛṣṇo 'nyo yadu-sambhūto
Kṛṣṇa another in the Yadu dynasty born
yastu gopendranandanaḥ
who however the son of the king of cowherds
vṛndāvanaṁ parityajya
Vṛndāvana leaving
sa kvacin naiva gacchati
He anywhere never at all goes

67 'The Kṛṣṇa born in the Yadu dynasty is another; but He who is the son of the king of the cowherds never leaves Vṛndāvana to go anywhere.'" (Yāmala, quoted in Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, 1.5.461)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa born in the Yadu dynasty is the *tattva* of Vāsudeva; He is therefore distinct from the son of the king of the cowherds. It is He who performs pastimes in Mathurā and Dvārakā. But the one who is the son of the king of the cowherds never leaves Vṛndāvana to go anywhere.

Anubhāṣya.
yadu-sambhūtaḥ (born in the Yadu dynasty) **kṛṣṇaḥ** — **anyaḥ** (is other than the son of the king of Vraja); **yaḥ tu gopendra-nandanaḥ** (the son of Nanda), **saḥ tu vṛndāvanaṁ parityajya** (leaving) **kvacit** (anywhere) **naiva gacchati**.

Śrī Rūpa reflects on the Lord's words —

এত কহি' মহাপ্রভু মধ্যাহ্নে চলিলা ।
রূপ-গোসাঞি মনে কিছু বিস্ময় হইলা ॥ ৬৮ ॥

eta kahi' mahāprabhu madhyāhne calilā
this saying Mahāprabhu for the midday duties left
rūpa-gosāñi mane kichu vismaya hailā
Rūpa Gosāñi in the mind some wonder felt

68 Saying this, Mahāprabhu left for His midday duties, and Rūpa Gosāñi was somewhat astonished.

*Satyabhāmā-devī and the Lord both order separate plays — she the *Lalita-mādhava*, He the *Vidagdha-mādhava* —*

"পৃথক্ নাটক করিতে সত্যভামা আজ্ঞা দিল ।
জানিলু, পৃথক্ নাটক করিতে প্রভু-আজ্ঞা হৈল ॥ ৬৯ ॥

pṛthak nāṭaka karite satyabhāmā ājñā dila
a separate drama to write Satyabhāmā the order gave
jānilu, pṛthak nāṭaka karite prabhu-ājñā haila
I understand, a separate drama to write the Lord's order has come

69 "Satyabhāmā ordered me to write a separate drama, and now I understand that the Lord's order is the same.

The two plays, earlier described together, are now conceived and written separately —

পূর্ব্বে দুই নাটক ছিল একত্র রচনা ।
দুইভাগ করি এবে করিমু ঘটনা ॥ ৭০ ॥

pūrve dui nāṭaka chila ekatra racanā
before two dramas were together in composition
dui-bhāga kari ebe karimu ghaṭanā
in two parts dividing now I shall make the plot

70 Before, the two dramas were composed together. Now I shall divide them in two and arrange their plots.

Anubhāṣya.

The two parts — this is the division: the *Vidagdha-mādhava* presents the pastimes in Vraja, and the *Lalita-mādhava* the pastimes in the cities.

*The *nāndī*, the prologue, the subject and all the rest are worked out separately for each play —*

দুই ‘নান্দী’ ‘প্রস্তাবনা’, দুই ‘সংঘটনা’ ।
পৃথক্ করিয়া লিখি করিয়া ভাবনা” ॥ ৭১ ॥

dui ‘nāndī’ ‘prastāvanā’, dui ‘saṁghaṭanā’
two nāndīs, prologues, two plots
pṛthak kariyā likhi kariyā bhāvanā
separately making I shall write, making reflection

71 Two *nāndī* verses, two prologues (*prastāvanā*), two plots: after careful thought I shall write them separately.”

Anubhāṣya.

The *Sāhitya-darpaṇa*, in its sixth chapter, verse 287, says: “Where the actress (*naṭī*), the jester (*vidūṣaka*), or the assistant (*pāripārśvika*) converse with the *sūtradhāra* (the stage manager), hinting to one another with striking words about their own business at what is to come — know this as the *āmukha*; it is also called the *prastāvanā*.” That is, where the actress, the jester, or the actor standing beside him converse fittingly with the *sūtradhāra* and, with charming words about their own business, introduce the actual story — know this as the *āmukha*; it is the *prastāvanā* (the prologue with which the performance begins).

*The theme-*sūtra* of the *Vidagdha-mādhava*: hearing a verse from the mouth of the Lord, absorbed in the mood of separation (*vipralambha*), Śrī Rūpa composes a verse that reveals that mood —*

রথযাত্রায় জগন্নাথ দর্শন করিলা ।
রথ-অগ্রে প্রভুর নৃত্য-কীর্ত্তন দেখিলা ॥ ৭২ ॥

ratha-yātrāya jagannātha darśana karilā
at the Ratha-yātrā of Jagannātha darśana he had
ratha-agre prabhura nṛtya-kīrtana dekhilā
before the chariot the Lord's dancing and kīrtana he saw

72 At the Ratha-yātrā Rūpa had darśana of Jagannātha and saw the Lord dancing and singing kīrtana before the chariot.

প্রভুর নৃত্য-শ্লোক শুনি' শ্রীরূপ-গোসাঞি ।
সেই শ্লোকার্থ লঞা শ্লোক করিলা তথাই ॥ ৭৩ ॥

prabhura nṛtya-śloka śuni' śrī rūpa-gosāñi
of the Lord the verse of the dance hearing Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi
sei ślokārtha lañā śloka karilā tathāi
that verse's meaning taking a verse composed right there

73 Hearing the verse the Lord recited as He danced, Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi took up its meaning and composed a verse on the spot.

This was described in Madhya-līlā, Chapter 1, but now it is told again in brief —

পূর্ব্বে সেই সব কথা কৈরাছি বর্ণন ।
তথাপি কহিয়ে কিছু সংক্ষেপে কথন ॥ ৭৪ ॥

pūrve sei saba kathā kairāchi varṇana
before those all matters I have made description
tathāpi kahiye kichu saṅkṣepe kathana
still I tell something briefly narration

74 I have described all this before; still I shall tell something of it briefly.

The inner meaning of the mysterious verse the Lord recited in the mood of Śrī Rādhā is beyond everyone except Svarūpa Dāmodara —

সামান্য এক শ্লোক প্রভু পড়েন কীর্ত্তনে ।
কেনে শ্লোক পড়ে — ইহা কেহ নাহি জানে ॥ ৭৫ ॥

sāmānya eka śloka prabhu paḍena kīrtane
an ordinary one verse the Lord recites in kīrtana
kene śloka paḍe — ihā keha nāhi jāne
why the verse He recites this anyone not knows

75 During kīrtana the Lord would recite an ordinary verse, and no one knew why He recited it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kene — in what mood.

Svarūpa pleases the Lord by singing songs that reveal the mood of that verse —

সবে একা স্বরূপ গোসাঞি শ্লোকের অর্থ জানে ।
শ্লোকানুরূপ পদ প্রভুকে করান আস্বাদনে ॥ ৭৬ ॥

sabe ekā svarūpa gosāñi ślokera artha jāne
only alone Svarūpa Gosāñi of the verse the meaning knows
ślokānurūpa pada prabhuke karāna āsvādane
matching the verse songs to the Lord makes relish

76 Svarūpa Gosāñi alone knew the meaning of the verse, and he would sing songs that matched it for the Lord to relish.

Śrī Rūpa composes a verse after the Lord's own heart —

রূপ-গোসাঞি প্রভুর জানিয়া অভিপ্রায় ।
সেই অর্থে শ্লোক কৈলা প্রভুরে যে ভায় ॥ ৭৭ ॥

rūpa-gosāñi prabhura jāniyā abhiprāya
Rūpa Gosāñi of the Lord understanding the intent
sei arthe śloka kailā prabhure ye bhāya
in that sense a verse composed to the Lord that appeals

77 Rūpa Gosāñi understood the Lord’s intent and composed a verse with that meaning — one that the Lord loved.

*The verse the Lord recited (*Kāvya-prakāśa* 1.4; *Sāhitya-darpaṇa* 1.10; *Padyāvalī*, number 382) —*

যঃ কৌমারহরঃ স এব হি বরস্তা এব চৈত্রক্ষপা-
স্তে চোন্মীলিতমালতীসুরভয়ঃ প্রৌঢ়াঃ কদম্বানিলাঃ ৷
সা চৈবাস্মি তথাপি তত্র সুরতব্যাপারলীলাবিধৌ
রেবারোধসি বেতসীতরুতলে চেতঃ সমুৎকণ্ঠতে ॥ ৭৮ ॥

yaḥ kaumāra-haraḥ sa eva hi varas tā eva caitra-kṣapās
who stole my heart in my girlhood He the same indeed my beloved those same nights of Caitra
te conmīlita-mālatī-surabhayaḥ prauḍhāḥ kadambānilāḥ
those same and fragrant with blossoming mālatī full breezes from the kadambas
sā caivāsmi tathāpi tatra surata-vyāpāra-līlā-vidhau
she the same am I yet there for the pastimes of love
revā-rodhasi vetasī-taru-tale cetaḥ samutkaṇṭhate
of the Revā on the bank of the vetasī tree beneath My heart yearns

78 "He who stole My heart in My girlhood is now My lord. These are the same moonlit nights of Caitra, and the same full breezes blow from the kadamba groves, fragrant with blossoming *mālatī*. I too am the same. Yet My heart yearns for Our play of love there, beneath the *vetasī* trees on the bank of the Revā." (Padyāvalī, 382)[8]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 1.58.

*(A verse composed by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī; *Padyāvalī*, number 383)*

প্রিয়ঃ সোঽয়ং কৃষ্ণঃ সহচরি কুরুক্ষেত্রমিলিত-
স্তথাহং সা রাধা তদিদমুভয়োঃ সঙ্গমসুখম্ ৷
তথাপ্যন্তঃখেলন্মধুরমুরলীপঞ্চমজুষে
মনো মে কালিন্দীপুলিনবিপিনায় স্পৃহয়তি ॥ ৭৯ ॥

priyaḥ so 'yaṁ kṛṣṇaḥ saha-cari kuru-kṣetra-militas
beloved that very Kṛṣṇa O companion at Kurukṣetra met
tathāhaṁ sā rādhā tad idam ubhayoḥ saṅgama-sukham
likewise I that Rādhā that this of both of union the joy
tathāpy antaḥ-khelan-madhura-muralī-pañcama-juṣe
yet within playing sweet of the flute the fifth note delighting in
mano me kālindī-pulina-vipināya spṛhayati
mind My of the Kālindī bank for the forest longs

79 "My dear companion, this is that same beloved Kṛṣṇa, met again at Kurukṣetra, and I am that same Rādhā; this is the same joy of Our union. Yet My heart longs for the forest on the bank of the Kālindī, which delights in the sweet fifth note of His flute playing in its depths." (Padyāvalī, 383)[9]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 1.76.

তালপত্রে শ্লোক লিখি' চালেতে রাখিলা ।
সমুদ্রস্নান করিবারে রূপ-গোসাঞি গেলা ॥ ৮০ ॥

tāla-patre śloka likhi' cālete rākhilā
on a palm leaf the verse writing in the thatched roof he placed
samudra-snāna karibāre rūpa-gosāñi gelā
sea bath to take Rūpa Gosāñi went

80 Rūpa Gosāñi wrote the verse on a palm leaf, tucked it into the thatched roof and went to bathe in the sea.

The story of Śrī Rūpa's verse and the Lord: the Lord reads the verse composed by Rūpa —

হেনকালে প্রভু আইলা তাঁহারে মিলিতে ।
চালে শ্লোক দেখি' প্রভু লাগিলা পড়িতে ॥ ৮১ ॥

hena-kāle prabhu āilā tāṁhāre milite
at that time the Lord came him to meet
cāle śloka dekhi' prabhu lāgilā paḍite
in the thatch the verse seeing the Lord began to read

81 Just then the Lord came to see him. Noticing the verse in the thatch, the Lord began to read it.

*The Lord is overwhelmed by *prema* —*

শ্লোক পড়ি' প্রভু সুখে প্রেমাবিষ্ট হৈলা ।
হেনকালে রূপ-গোসাঞি স্নান করি' আইলা ॥ ৮২ ॥

śloka paḍi' prabhu sukhe premāviṣṭa hailā
the verse reading the Lord in joy absorbed in love became
hena-kāle rūpa-gosāñi snāna kari' āilā
at that time Rūpa Gosāñi bath having taken came

82 As He read the verse, the Lord was overwhelmed with joy and love. Just then Rūpa Gosāñi returned from his bath.

The Lord's unfeigned affection and mercy toward Śrī Rūpa —

প্রভু দেখি' দণ্ডবৎ প্রাঙ্গণে পড়িলা ।
প্রভু তাঁরে চাপড় মারি' কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ৮৩ ॥

prabhu dekhi' daṇḍavat prāṅgaṇe paḍilā
the Lord seeing flat like a rod in the courtyard he fell
prabhu tāṁre cāpaḍa māri' kahite lāgilā
the Lord him a slap giving to speak began

83 Seeing the Lord, Rūpa fell flat in the courtyard to offer obeisance. The Lord gave him an affectionate slap and said,

The Lord embraces Śrī Rūpa tightly —

'গূঢ় মোর হৃদয় তুমি জানিলা কেমনে?'
এত কহি' রূপে কৈলা দৃঢ় আলিঙ্গনে ॥ ৮৪ ॥

gūḍha mora hṛdaya tumi jānilā kemane?
hidden My heart you knew how?
eta kahi' rūpe kailā dṛḍha āliṅgane
this saying Rūpa He made firm embrace

84 "How did you know My hidden heart?" And saying this, He embraced Rūpa tightly.

The Lord shows the verse to Śrī Svarūpa and, pretending not to know, playfully asks him how Śrī Rūpa came to know His inner feelings —

সেই শ্লোক লঞা প্রভু স্বরূপে দেখাইলা ।
স্বরূপের পরীক্ষা লাগি' তাঁহারে পুছিলা ॥ ৮৫ ॥

sei śloka lañā prabhu svarūpe dekhāilā
that verse taking the Lord to Svarūpa showed
svarūpera parīkṣā lāgi' tāṁhāre puchilā
of Svarūpa the test for the sake of him He asked

85 The Lord took the verse and showed it to Svarūpa, and to test Svarūpa He asked him,

'মোর অন্তর-বার্ত্তা রূপ জানিল কেমনে?'
স্বরূপ কহে — "জানি, কৃপা কৈরাছ আপনে ॥ ৮৬ ॥

mora antara-vārtā rūpa jānila kemane?
My inner feelings Rūpa knew how?
svarūpa kahe — jāni, kṛpā kairācha āpane
Svarūpa says, I know, mercy You have shown Yourself

86 "How did Rūpa know what is in My heart?" Svarūpa said, "I know: You Yourself have shown him mercy.

Svarūpa infers that Śrī Rūpa has received the Lord's mercy —

অন্যথা এ অর্থ কার নাহি হয় জ্ঞান ।
তুমি পূর্ব্বে কৃপা কৈলা, করি অনুমান" ॥ ৮৭ ॥

anyathā e artha kāra nāhi haya jñāna
otherwise this meaning anyone's not becomes knowledge
tumi pūrve kṛpā kailā, kari anumāna
You before mercy showed, I make inference

87 Otherwise no one could know this meaning. I infer that You showed him mercy earlier.”

The Lord tells Svarūpa how He instructed Rūpa at Prayāga —

প্রভু কহে, — ‘ইঁহো আমায় প্রয়াগে মিলিল ।
যোগ্যপাত্র জানি’ মোর কৃপা ত’ হইল ॥ ৮৮ ॥

prabhu kahe, — iṁho āmāya prayāge milila
the Lord says, he with Me at Prayāga met
yogya-pātra jāni’ mora kṛpā ta’ haila
a worthy recipient knowing (him) My mercy indeed arose

88 The Lord said, “He met Me at Prayāga, and knowing him to be a worthy recipient, I gave him My mercy.

তবে শক্তি সঞ্চারি’ আমি কৈলুঁ উপদেশ ।
তুমিহ কহিও ইঁহায় রসের বিশেষ’ ॥ ৮৯ ॥

tabe śakti sañcāri’ āmi kailuṁ upadeśa
then power infusing I gave instruction
tumiha kahio iṁhāya rasera viśeṣa
you also tell him of rasa the particulars

89 Then I infused him with power and instructed him. You too should teach him the finer points of rasa.”

Svarūpa's inference is correct —

স্বরূপ কহে — “যাতে এই শ্লোক দেখিলুঁ ।
তুমি করিয়াছ কৃপা, তবঁহি জানিলু ॥ ৯০ ॥

svarūpa kahe — yāte ei śloka dekhiluṁ
Svarūpa says, when this verse I saw
tumi kariyācha kṛpā, tabaṁhi jānilu
You have shown mercy, at once I knew

90 Svarūpa said, “As soon as I saw this verse, I knew that You had shown him mercy.

*From the fruit one infers its cause (a maxim of *nyāya*) —*

ফলেন ফলকারণমনুমীয়তে ॥ ৯১ ॥

phalena phala-kāraṇam anumīyate
by the fruit the fruit’s cause is inferred

91 ‘The cause of a fruit is inferred from the fruit itself.’ (a maxim of Nyāya)[10]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The cause of a fruit is inferred from the fruit itself.

*(The swan's words to Damayantī; *Naiṣadhīya*, canto 3, verse 17)*

স্বর্গাপগা-হেমমৃণালিনীনাং
নানা-মৃণালাগ্রভুজো ভজামঃ ৷
অন্নানুরূপাং তনুরূপঋদ্ধিং
কার্য্যং নিদানাদ্ধি গুণানধীতে” ॥ ৯২ ॥

svargāpagā-hema-mṛṇālinīnāṁ
of the heavenly Gaṅgā golden of the lotuses
nānā-mṛṇālāgra-bhujo bhajāmaḥ
of various lotus stalks’ tips eating we obtain
annānurūpāṁ tanu-rūpa-ṛddhiṁ
matching the food of the body of beauty the wealth
kāryaṁ nidānād dhi guṇān adhīte
the effect from the cause indeed the qualities acquires

92 (The swan said to Damayantī:) ‘We eat the tips of the stalks of the golden lotuses that grow in the heavenly Gaṅgā, and so our bodies have gained a beauty that matches our food: an effect takes on the qualities of its cause.’” (Naiṣadhīya, 3.17)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

We eat the tips of the stems of the golden lotuses of the heavenly Ganges, and so we have gained a corresponding beauty of body: qualities appear in keeping with their original cause.

Anubhāṣya.

he damayanti, **svargāpagā-hema-mṛṇālinīnāṁ** (*svargāpagāyāḥ*, of the heavenly Ganges, the Mandākinī; *hema-mṛṇālinīnāṁ*, of lotuses like gold) **nānā-mṛṇālāgra-bhujaḥ** (we, who are accustomed to eat the tips of various tender lotus roots) **annānurūpāṁ** (matching what is eaten) **tanu-rūpa-ṛddhiṁ** (a wealth of bodily beauty) **bhajāmaḥ** (have gained); **hi** (for) **kāryaṁ** (the effect) **nidānāt** (from its original cause) **guṇān adhīte** (receives its qualities).

*At the end of the *cāturmāsya* the Gauḍīya devotees return to Gauḍa —*

চাতুর্ম্মাস্য রহি' গৌড়ে বৈষ্ণব চলিলা ।
রূপ-গোসাঞি মহাপ্রভুর চরণে রহিলা ॥ ৯৩ ॥

cāturmāsya rahi' gauḍe vaiṣṇava calilā
the Cāturmāsya staying to Gauḍa the Vaiṣṇavas departed
rūpa-gosāñi mahāprabhura caraṇe rahilā
Rūpa Gosāñi of Mahāprabhu at the feet remained

93 After staying for the Cāturmāsya, the Vaiṣṇavas returned to Gauḍa, but Rūpa Gosāñi remained at Mahāprabhu's feet.

One day, while Śrī Rūpa was writing his play, the Lord came unexpectedly —

একদিন রূপ করেন নাটক লিখন ।
আচম্বিতে মহাপ্রভুর হৈল আগমন ॥ ৯৪ ॥

ekadina rūpa karena nāṭaka likhana
one day Rūpa is doing of the drama writing
ācambite mahāprabhura haila āgamana
unexpectedly Mahāprabhu's took place arrival

94 One day, as Rūpa was writing his drama, Mahāprabhu arrived unexpectedly.

Śrī Rūpa and Haridāsa bow down to the Lord; the Lord sits down —

সম্ভ্রমে দুঁহে উঠি' দণ্ডবৎ হৈলা ।
দুঁহে আলিঙ্গিয়া প্রভু আসনে বসিলা ॥ ৯৫ ॥

sambhrame duṁhe uṭhi' daṇḍavat hailā
in reverent haste both rising flat like rods became
duṁhe āliṅgiyā prabhu āsane vasilā
both embracing the Lord on a seat sat

95 In reverent haste the two of them rose and fell flat before Him. The Lord embraced them both and sat down.

The Lord takes a leaf written by Rūpa and is pleased to see his handwriting —

'ক্যা পুঁথি লিখ?' বলি' এক পত্র নিলা ।
অক্ষর দেখিয়া প্রভু মনে সুখী হৈলা ॥ ৯৬ ॥

kyā puṁthi likha? bali' eka patra nilā
what book are you writing? saying one leaf He took
akṣara dekhiyā prabhu mane sukhī hailā
the letters seeing the Lord at heart happy became

96 "What book are you writing?" He asked, and He took up one leaf. Seeing the handwriting, the Lord was pleased at heart.

The Lord praises Śrī Rūpa's handwriting —

শ্রীরূপের অক্ষর — যেন মুকুতার পাঁতি ।
প্রীত হঞা করেন প্রভু অক্ষরের স্তুতি ॥ ৯৭ ॥

śrī-rūpera akṣara — yena mukutāra pāṁti
of Śrī Rūpa the letters like of pearls a row
prīta hañā karena prabhu akṣarera stuti
pleased becoming makes the Lord of the letters praise

97 Śrī Rūpa's letters were like rows of pearls, and the Lord, delighted, praised the handwriting.

*Seeing a certain verse, the Lord is overwhelmed by *prema* —*

সেই পত্রে প্রভু এক শ্লোক দেখিলা ।
পড়িতেই শ্লোক, প্রেমে আবিষ্ট হইলা ॥ ৯৮ ॥

sei patre prabhu eka śloka dekhilā
on that leaf the Lord one verse saw
paḍitei śloka, preme āviṣṭa ha-ilā
as soon as reading the verse in love absorbed He became

98 On that leaf the Lord saw a verse, and as soon as He read it, He was overwhelmed with love.

*A verse that reveals the taste of the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's name (Paurṇamāsī's words to Nāndīmukhī; *Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 15) —*

তুণ্ডে তাণ্ডবিনী রতিং বিতনুতে তুণ্ডাবলীলব্ধয়ে
কর্ণক্রোড়কড়ম্বিনী ঘটয়তে কর্ণার্ব্বুদেভ্যঃ স্পৃহাম্ ।
চেতঃপ্রাঙ্গণসঙ্গিনী বিজয়তে সর্ব্বেন্দ্রিয়াণাং কৃতিং
নো জানে জনিতা কিয়দ্ভিরমৃতৈঃ কৃষ্ণেতি বর্ণদ্বয়ী ॥ ৯৯ ॥

tuṇḍe tāṇḍavinī ratiṁ vitanute tuṇḍāvalī-labdhaye
on the lips dancing attraction it generates many mouths to gain
karṇa-kroḍa-kaḍambinī ghaṭayate karṇārbudebhyaḥ spṛhām
of the ears in the hollow sprouting it arouses for millions of ears longing
cetaḥ-prāṅgaṇa-saṅginī vijayate sarvendriyāṇāṁ kṛtiṁ
of the mind in the courtyard as a companion it conquers of all the senses the activity
no jāne janitā kiyadbhir amṛtaiḥ kṛṣṇeti varṇa-dvayī
not I know born with how many nectars "Kṛṣṇa" of syllables the pair

99 (Paurṇamāsī said to Nāndīmukhī:) "I do not know with how many nectars the two syllables 'Kṛṣ-ṇa' were born. When they dance on the lips, they make one long for many mouths; when they sprout in the hollows of the ears, they make one yearn for millions of ears; and when they come as a companion into the courtyard of the mind, they conquer the workings of all the senses." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.15)[11]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I do not know with how much nectar these two syllables, "Kṛṣ-ṇa," were born. See: when they dance on the lips like an actress, they awaken a longing to obtain many mouths — that is, they increase one's attachment. When they enter the hollows of the ears and sprout there, they create a craving for millions of ears. When they rise in the courtyard of the mind as a companion, they conquer the activity of all the senses.

Anubhāṣya.

kṛṣṇa iti varṇa-dvayī kiyadbhiḥ (with how great a measure) **amṛtaiḥ** (together with nectars) **janitā** (it was born — this) (I) **no jāne** (do not know; for it), **he nāndīmukhi**, **tuṇḍe** (on the lips) **tāṇḍavinī** (by the saying "a male dance is called *tāṇḍava*," *tāṇḍava* means "dance"; performing it) **tuṇḍāvalī-labdhaye** (to obtain many mouths) **ratiṁ** (craving) **vitanute** (displays); **karṇa-kroḍa-kaḍambinī** (sprouting in the passage of the ears) **karṇārbudebhyaḥ** (to obtain ears numbering an *arbuda*) **spṛhām** (desire) **ghaṭayate**; **cetaḥ-prāṅgaṇa-saṅginī** (the mind itself is a courtyard — becoming a companion there) **sarvendriyāṇāṁ** (of all the senses) **kṛtiṁ** (the activity) **vijayate** (conquers: it takes hold of them and stops all their movement).

Hearing the verse, the Nāmācārya dances with joy —

শ্লোক শুনি' হরিদাস হইলা উল্লাসী ।
নাচিতে লাগিলা শ্লোকের অর্থ প্রশংসি' ॥ ১০০ ॥

śloka śuni' haridāsa hailā ullāsī
the verse hearing Haridāsa became jubilant
nācite lāgilā ślokera artha praśaṁsi'
to dance began of the verse the meaning praising

100 Hearing the verse, Haridāsa was jubilant, and he began to dance, praising its meaning.

The verse reveals the unequaled glory of Kṛṣṇa's name —

কৃষ্ণনামের মহিমা শাস্ত্র-সাধু-মুখে জানি ।
নামের মাধুরী ঐছে কাঁহা নাহি শুনি ॥ ১০১ ॥

kṛṣṇa-nāmera mahimā śāstra-sādhu-mukhe jāni
of Kṛṣṇa's name the glory from scripture and the mouths of saints I know
nāmera mādhurī aiche kāṁhā nāhi śuni
of the name sweetness such anywhere not I hear

101 "I know the glory of Kṛṣṇa's name from the scriptures and from the lips of saints, but nowhere have I heard of such sweetness in the name."[12]

The Lord leaves for His midday bath —

তবে মহাপ্রভু দুঁহে করি' আলিঙ্গন ।
মধ্যাহ্ন করিতে সমুদ্রে করিলা গমন ॥ ১০২ ॥

tabe mahāprabhu duṁhe kari' āliṅgana
then Mahāprabhu both making embrace
madhyāhna karite samudre karilā gamana
the midday duties to perform to the sea He made His way

102 Then Mahāprabhu embraced them both and went to the sea to perform His midday duties.

On the way the Lord Himself glorifies Śrī Rūpa —

আর দিন মহাপ্রভু দেখি' জগন্নাথ ।
সার্ব্বভৌম-রামানন্দ-স্বরূপাদি-সাথ ॥ ১০৩ ॥

সবে মিলি' চলি আইলা শ্রীরূপে মিলিতে ।
পথে তাঁর গুণ সবারে লাগিলা কহিতে ॥ ১০৪ ॥

āra dina mahāprabhu dekhi' jagannātha
the next day Mahāprabhu seeing Jagannātha
sārvabhauma-rāmānanda-svarūpādi-sātha
with Sārvabhauma, Rāmānanda, Svarūpa and others together
sabe mili' cali āilā śrī rūpe milite
all meeting setting out came Śrī Rūpa to meet
pathe tāṁra guṇa sabāre lāgilā kahite
on the way his qualities to all He began to tell

103–104 The next day, after seeing Jagannātha, Mahāprabhu set out together with Sārvabhauma, Rāmānanda, Svarūpa and others, and they all came to meet Śrī Rūpa. On the way the Lord began to tell them all about Rūpa's qualities.

*The Lord praises Śrī Rūpa's verses "*priyaḥ so 'yaṁ*" and "*tuṇḍe tāṇḍavinī*" —*

দুই শ্লোক কহি' প্রভুর হৈল মহাসুখ ।
নিজ-ভক্তের গুণ কহে হঞা পঞ্চমুখ ॥ ১০৫ ॥

dui śloka kahi' prabhura haila mahā-sukha
two verses reciting of the Lord there was great joy
nija-bhaktera guṇa kahe hañā pañca-mukha
of His own devotee the qualities He tells becoming five-mouthed

105 Reciting the two verses, the Lord felt great joy, and He praised the qualities of His devotee as though He had five mouths.

The Lord Himself describes Śrī Rūpa's qualities to Rāya and the Bhaṭṭācārya —

সার্ব্বভৌম-রামানন্দে পরীক্ষা করিতে ।
শ্রীরূপের গুণ দুঁহারে লাগিলা কহিতে ॥ ১০৬ ॥

sārvabhauma-rāmānande parīkṣā karite
Sārvabhauma and Rāmānanda a test to make
śrī rūpera guṇa duṁhāre lāgilā kahite
of Śrī Rūpa the qualities to both He began to tell

106 To test Sārvabhauma and Rāmānanda, He began to describe Śrī Rūpa's qualities to them both.

Bhagavān's love for His devotees —

'ঈশ্বর-স্বভাব' — ভক্তের না লয় অপরাধ ।
অল্পসেবা বহু মানে আত্মপর্য্যন্ত প্রসাদ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

'īśvara-svabhāva' — bhaktera nā laya aparādha
the nature of the Lord: of the devotee not He takes the offenses
alpa-sevā bahu māne ātma-paryanta prasāda
small service great He considers, up to Himself grace

107 It is the Lord's nature not to hold His devotee's offences against him. He regards a little service as great, and His grace goes so far that He gives Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Ātma-paryanta prasāda — He bestows mercy even to the point of giving His *ātmā*, that is, Himself.

*How Bhagavān treats His devotee (*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, Vibhāva-laharī, verse 138) —*

ভৃত্যস্য পশ্যতি গুরূনপি নাপরাধান্
সেবাং মনাগপি কৃতাং বহুধাভ্যুপৈতি ৷
আবিষ্করোতি পিশুনেষ্বপি নাভ্যসূয়াং
শীলেন নির্ম্মলমতিঃ পুরুষোত্তমোঽয়ম্ ॥ ১০৮ ॥

bhṛtyasya paśyati gurūn api nāparādhān
of the servant He sees grave even not the offenses
sevāṁ manāg api kṛtāṁ bahudhābhyupaiti
service slight even done manifold He accepts
āviṣkaroti piśuneṣv api nābhyasūyāṁ
He shows toward slanderers even not ill will
śīlena nirmala-matiḥ puruṣottamo 'yam
by nature pure in mind Puruṣottama this

108 "This Lord Puruṣottama, pure in mind by nature, does not see even the grave offences of His servant; He accepts even the slightest service as many times greater; and even toward those who slander Him He shows no ill will." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.138)[13]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This Bhagavān, Puruṣottama, is pure in mind. By His good nature He does not notice even the grave offenses of His servant. He considers the slightest service great. Even toward a wicked person who reviles Him He shows no ill will.

Anubhāṣya.

ayaṁ nirmala-matiḥ (He whose mind is pure, that is, free from innate attachment, aversion and the like) **puruṣottamaḥ** (Kṛṣṇa; another reading has *kamalekṣaṇaḥ*, "the lotus-eyed") **śīlena** (by His good nature) **bhṛtyasya** (of His servant) **gurūn** (grave) **api aparādhān na paśyati**; **manāk** (the slightest) **api kṛtāṁ** (performed) **sevāṁ bahudhā** (manifold) **abhyupaiti** (accepts); **piśuneṣu** (toward the wicked or evil-minded) **api abhyasūyāṁ** (a fault-finding eye) **na āviṣkaroti** (does not show).

Śrī Rūpa and Haridāsa bow down to the Lord and His companions —

ভক্তসঙ্গে প্রভু আইলা, দেখি' দুই জন ।
দণ্ডবৎ হঞা কৈলা চরণ বন্দন ॥ ১০৯ ॥

bhakta-saṅge prabhu āilā, dekhi' dui jana
with the devotees the Lord came, seeing the two persons
daṇḍavat hañā kailā caraṇa vandana
flat like rods becoming made to the feet worship

109 When the two of them saw that the Lord had come with His devotees, they fell flat and bowed at their feet.

The Lord sits among the devotees; out of humility the two sit lower —

ভক্তসঙ্গে কৈলা প্রভু দুঁহারে মিলন ।
পিণ্ডাতে বসিলা প্রভু লঞা ভক্তগণ ॥ ১১০ ॥

bhakta-saṅge kailā prabhu duṁhāre milana
with the devotees made the Lord with the two meeting
piṇḍāte vasilā prabhu lañā bhakta-gaṇa
on the raised platform sat the Lord with the devotees

110 Together with His devotees the Lord greeted the two of them, and then He sat down with the devotees on the raised platform (*piṇḍā*).[14]

রূপ-হরিদাস দুঁহে বসিলা পিণ্ডাতলে ।
সবার অগ্রে না উঠিলা পিঁড়ার উপরে ॥ ১১১ ॥

rūpa haridāsa duṁhe vasilā piṇḍā-tale
Rūpa Haridāsa both sat of the platform at the foot
sabāra agre nā uṭhilā piṁḍāra upare
of all in front not climbed the seats onto

111 Rūpa and Haridāsa sat below, at the foot of the platform; in front of everyone they would not climb up onto it.

*The Lord tells Śrī Rūpa to recite the verse "*priyaḥ so 'yaṁ*"; Śrī Rūpa is embarrassed and stays silent —*

'পূর্ব্বশ্লোক পড়, রূপ, প্রভু আজ্ঞা কৈলা ।
লজ্জাতে না পড়ে রূপ মৌন ধরিলা ॥ ১১২ ॥

pūrva-śloka paḍa, rūpa, prabhu ājñā kailā
the earlier verse recite Rūpa the Lord order gave
lajjāte nā paḍe rūpa mauna dharilā
out of shyness not recites Rūpa silence kept

112 The Lord ordered, "Rūpa, recite the earlier verse." But Rūpa, overcome with shyness, would not recite it and kept silent.

Svarūpa recites the verse; hearing it, everyone is amazed —

স্বরূপ-গোসাঞি তবে সেই শ্লোক পড়িল ।
শুনি' সবাকার চিত্তে চমৎকার হৈল ॥ ১১৩ ॥

svarūpa-gosāñi tabe sei śloka paḍila
Svarūpa Gosāñi then that verse recited
śuni' sabākāra citte camatkāra haila
hearing of everyone in the heart wonder arose

113 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi recited that verse, and on hearing it everyone was filled with wonder.

*(A verse composed by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī; *Padyāvalī*, number 383)*

প্রিয়ঃ সোঽয়ং কৃষ্ণঃ সহচরি কুরুক্ষেত্রমিলিত-
স্তথাহং সা রাধা তদিদমুভয়োঃ সঙ্গমসুখম্ ।
তথাপ্যন্তঃখেলন্মধুরমুরলীপঞ্চমজুষে
মনো মে কালিন্দীপুলিনবিপিনায় স্পৃহয়তি ॥ ১১৪ ॥

priyaḥ so 'yaṁ kṛṣṇaḥ saha-cari kuru-kṣetra-militas
beloved that very Kṛṣṇa O companion at Kurukṣetra met
tathāhaṁ sā rādhā tad idam ubhayoḥ saṅgama-sukham
likewise I that Rādhā that this of both of union the joy
tathāpy antaḥ-khelan-madhura-muralī-pañcama-juṣe
yet within playing sweet of the flute the fifth note delighting in
mano me kālindī-pulina-vipināya spṛhayati
mind My of the Kālindī bank for the forest longs

114 "My dear companion, this is that same beloved Kṛṣṇa, met again at Kurukṣetra, and I am that same Rādhā; this is the same joy of Our union. Yet My heart longs for the forest on the bank of the Kālindī, which delights in the sweet fifth note of His flute playing in its depths." (Padyāvalī, 383)[15]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 1.76.

Rāmānanda and the other devotees conclude that Śrī Rūpa grasped the Lord's mood only by His mercy —

রায়, ভট্টাচার্য্য বলে, — "তোমার প্রসাদ বিনে ।
তোমার হৃদয় এই জানিবে কেমনে ॥ ১১৫ ॥

rāya, bhaṭṭācārya bale, — tomāra prasāda vine
Rāya Bhaṭṭācārya say Your grace without
tomāra hṛdaya ei jānibe kemane
Your heart this would know how

115 Rāmānanda Rāya and Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya said, "Without Your grace, how could he know this heart of Yours?

আমাতে সঞ্চারি' পূর্ব্বে কহিলা সিদ্ধান্ত ।
যে সব সিদ্ধান্তে ব্রহ্মা নাহি পায় অন্ত ॥ ১১৬ ॥

āmāte sañcāri' pūrve kahilā siddhānta
into me infusing (power) earlier You spoke conclusive truths
ye saba siddhānte brahmā nāhi pāya anta
which all in the truths Brahmā not finds the end

116 Earlier You infused Your power into me and spoke conclusive truths whose end even Brahmā cannot find.

Anubhāṣya.
Pūrve — see Madhya, Chapter 8.

তাতে জানি — পূর্ব্বে তোমার পাঞাছে প্রসাদ ।
তাহা বিনা নহে তোমার হৃদয়ানুবাদ" ॥ ১১৭ ॥

tāte jāni — pūrve tomāra pāñāche prasāda
by that we know earlier Your he has received grace
tāhā vinā nahe tomāra hṛdayānuvāda
that without is not Your heart's expression

117 From this we know that he received Your grace earlier: without it, no one could put Your heart into words."

Anubhāṣya.
Hṛdayānuvāda — expressing the feelings of the heart.

*The Lord tells Śrī Rūpa to recite the verse "*tuṇḍe tāṇḍavinī*" —*

প্রভু কহে, — কহ "রূপ, নাটকের শ্লোক ।
যে শ্লোক শুনিলে লোকের যায় দুঃখ-শোক" ॥ ১১৮ ॥

prabhu kahe, — kaha rūpa, nāṭakera śloka
the Lord says recite Rūpa of your play the verse
ye śloka śunile lokera yāya duḥkha-śoka
which verse on hearing people's goes away sorrow and grief

118 The Lord said, “Rūpa, recite the verse from your play that takes away people’s sorrow and grief when they hear it.”

At first Śrī Rūpa is shy to recite his own verse; then he recites it —

বার বার প্রভু তারে আজ্ঞা যদি দিলা ।
তবে সেই শ্লোক রূপ কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ১১৯ ॥

bāra bāra prabhu tāre ājñā yadi dilā
time after time the Lord to him order when gave
tabe sei śloka rūpa kahite lāgilā
then that verse Rūpa to recite began

119 When the Lord had ordered him again and again, Rūpa began to recite that verse:

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 15)*

তুণ্ডে তাণ্ডবিনী রতিং বিতনুতে তুণ্ডাবলীলব্ধয়ে
কর্ণক্রোড়কড়ম্বিনী ঘটয়তে কর্ণার্ব্বুদেভ্যঃ স্পৃহাম্ ।
চেতঃপ্রাঙ্গণসঙ্গিনী বিজয়তে সর্ব্বেন্দ্রিয়াণাং কৃতিং
নো জানে জনিতা কিয়দ্ভিরমৃতৈঃ কৃষ্ণেতি বর্ণদ্বয়ী ॥ ১২০ ॥

tuṇḍe tāṇḍavinī ratiṁ vitanute tuṇḍāvalī-labdhaye
on the lips dancing attraction it generates many mouths to gain
karṇa-kroḍa-kaḍambinī ghaṭayate karṇārbudebhyaḥ spṛhām
of the ears in the hollow sprouting it arouses for millions of ears longing
cetaḥ-prāṅgaṇa-saṅginī vijayate sarvendriyāṇāṁ kṛtiṁ
of the mind in the courtyard as a companion it conquers of all the senses the activity
no jāne janitā kiyadbhir amṛtaiḥ kṛṣṇeti varṇa-dvayī
not I know born with how many nectars “Kṛṣṇa” of syllables the pair

120 “I do not know with how many nectars the two syllables ‘Kṛṣ-ṇa’ were born. When they dance on the lips, they make one long for many mouths; when they sprout in the hollows of the ears, they make one yearn for millions of ears; and when they come as a companion into the courtyard of

the mind, they conquer the workings of all the senses." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.15)[16]

Anubhāṣya.
See Antya 1.99.

Hearing it, Rāmānanda and the other devotees are filled with wonder and joy —

যত ভক্তবৃন্দ আর রামানন্দ রায় ।
শ্লোক শুনি' সবার হইল আনন্দ-বিস্ময় ॥ ১২১ ॥

yata bhakta-vṛnda āra rāmānanda rāya
all of the devotees the assembly and Rāmānanda Rāya
śloka śuni' sabāra haila ānanda-vismaya
the verse hearing of all arose bliss and wonder

121 All the assembled devotees and Rāmānanda Rāya were filled with bliss and wonder on hearing the verse.

A verse that reveals the unequaled sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's name —

সবে বলে, — 'নাম-মহিমা শুনিয়াছি অপার ।
এমন মাধুর্য্য কেহ বর্ণে নাহি আর' ॥ ১২২ ॥

sabe bale, — nāma-mahimā śuniyāchi apāra
all say of the Name the glory we have heard boundless
emana mādhurya keha varṇe nāhi āra
such sweetness anyone describes not else

122 All said, "We have heard of the boundless glory of the Name, but no one else has described such sweetness."

The conversation of Śrī Rāya and Rūpa: Rāya asks what book this is from —

রায় কহে, — "কোন্ গ্রন্থ কর হেন জানি ?
যাহার ভিতরে এই সিদ্ধান্তের খনি ?" ॥ ১২৩ ॥

rāya kahe, — kon grantha kara hena jāni?
Rāya says what book you are composing so I wonder
yāhāra bhitare ei siddhāntera khani?
of which within this of conclusive truths the mine

123 Rāya said, “What book are you composing, I wonder, that holds within it this mine of conclusive truths?”

Svarūpa tells about the two plays —

স্বরূপ কহে, — “কৃষ্ণলীলার নাটক করিতে ।
ব্রজলীলা-পুরলীলা একত্র বর্ণিতে ॥ ১২৪ ॥

svarūpa kahe, — kṛṣṇa-līlāra nāṭaka karite
Svarūpa says of Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes a play to compose
vraja-līlā-pura-līlā ekatra varṇite
Vraja pastimes city pastimes together to describe

124 Svarūpa said, “He wished to compose a play on Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes, describing His pastimes in Vraja and in the cities together,

আরম্ভিয়াছিলা, এবে প্রভু-আজ্ঞা পাঞা ।
দুই নাটক কৈরাছেন বিভাগ করিয়া ॥ ১২৫ ॥

ārambhiyāchilā, ebe prabhu-ājñā pāñā
he had begun now the Lord’s order receiving
dui nāṭaka kairāchena vibhāga kariyā
two plays he has made division making

125 and he had begun it; but now, by the Lord’s order, he has divided it into two plays:

*The *Vidagdha-mādhava* is about the pastimes in Vraja, the *Lalita-mādhava* about the pastimes in the cities —*

বিদগ্ধমাধব আর ললিতমাধব ।
দুই নাটকে প্রেমরস অদ্ভুত সব” ॥ ১২৬ ॥

vidagdha-mādhava āra lalita-mādhava
Vidagdha-mādhava and Lalita-mādhava
dui nāṭake prema-rasa adbhuta saba
in the two plays of love the rasa wondrous all

126 *Vidagdha-mādhava* and *Lalita-mādhava*. In both plays the rasa of love is wondrous throughout."

Anubhāṣya.
The *Vidagdha-mādhava* was written in Śaka 1454, and the *Lalita-mādhava* in Śaka 1459. The conversation of Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya with Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī about these two books takes place in Śaka 1437.

*Rāya asks Śrī Rūpa to recite the *nāndī* of the *Vidagdha-mādhava* —*

রায় কহে, — "নান্দী-শ্লোক পড় দেখি, শুনি?"
শ্রীরূপ শ্লোক পড়ে প্রভু-আজ্ঞা মানি' ॥ ১২৭ ॥

rāya kahe, — nāndī-śloka paḍa dekhi, śuni?
Rāya says the nāndī verse recite let us see let us hear
śrī rūpa śloka paḍe prabhu-ājñā māni'
Śrī Rūpa the verse recites the Lord's order accepting

127 Rāya said, "Recite the *nāndī* verse — let us hear it." Accepting the Lord's order, Śrī Rūpa recited the verse:

Anubhāṣya.
Now Śrī Rāmānanda asks about the subject of Śrī Rūpa's play, the *Vidagdha-mādhava*.

*Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, which bring blessing to the world (*Vidagdha-mādhava*, *maṅgalācaraṇa*, Act 1, verse 1) —*

সুধানাং চান্দ্রীণামপি মধুরিমোন্মাদ-দমনী
দধানা রাধাদিপ্রণয়ঘনসারৈঃ সুরভিতাম্ ।
সমন্তাৎ সন্তাপোদ্গম-বিষমসংসার-সরণী-
প্রণীতাং তে তৃষ্ণাং হরতু হরিলীলা-শিখরিণী ॥ ১২৮ ॥

sudhānāṁ cāndrīṇām api madhurimonmāda-damanī
of nectars lunar even of sweetness the intoxication subduing
dadhānā rādhādi-praṇaya-ghana-sāraiḥ surabhitām
bearing of Rādhā and others of love with the camphor fragrance
samantāt santāpodgama-viṣama-saṁsāra-saraṇī-
on all sides sufferings producing uneven of worldly existence by the road
praṇītāṁ te tṛṣṇāṁ haratu hari-līlā-śikhariṇī
produced your thirst may it take away of Hari's pastimes the śikhariṇī

128 "May Hari's pastimes, a sweet *śikhariṇī* drink, wholly take away your thirst, born on the rough road of worldly life that breeds suffering on every side. Their sweetness humbles the pride even of the moon's nectar, and the camphor of the love of Rādhā and Her companions lends them their fragrance." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.1)[17]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

May this sweet drink (*śikhariṇī*) — the pastimes of Hari — wholly take away your unholy thirst, born of wandering along the path of worldly existence, which breeds suffering. This *śikhariṇī* of Hari's pastimes subdues the intoxication born of the sweetness of the moon's nectar, and through the camphor of the love (*praṇaya*) of Śrī Rādhā and others it bears a special fragrance.

Anubhāṣya.

cāndrīṇām (connected with the moon) **sudhānām api madhurimonmāda-damanī** (she whose nature is to subdue the madness born of sweetness, that is, the pride "I alone am full of sweetness in every way"), **rādhādi-praṇaya-ghana-sāraiḥ** (the love of Rādhā and the others is itself *ghanasāra*, camphor; with it) **surabhitām** (fragrance; in the other sense, charm) **dadhānā hari-līlā-śikhariṇī** (a sweet drink, a *rasālā*, in the form of Hari's pastimes) **samantāt** (on every side) **te** (your) **santāpodgama-viṣama-saṁsāra-saraṇī-praṇītāṁ** (in which sufferings — *ādhyātmika* and the rest — arise; such a harsh worldly existence, which leads to birth as a god, a human or an immobile being, is itself the path; born of it, that is, produced by wandering along it) **tṛṣṇāṁ** (thirst) **haratu** (may remove).[31]

Rāya asks for a description of the worshipable Deity; Śrī Rūpa is embarrassed

—

রায় কহে, — ‘কহ ইষ্টদেবের বর্ণন’ ।
প্রভুর সঙ্কোচে রূপ না করে পঠন ॥ ১২৯ ॥

rāya kahe, — kaha iṣṭa-devera varṇana
Rāya says tell of your worshipful Deity the description
prabhura saṅkoce rūpa nā kare paṭhana
before the Lord out of hesitation Rūpa not does reciting

129 Rāya said, “Recite the description of your worshipful Deity.” But Rūpa, hesitating before the Lord, would not recite it.

The Lord's insistent order —

প্রভু কহে, — “কহ-না কেনে, কি সঙ্কোচ-লাজে ?
গ্রন্থের ফল শুনাইবা বৈষ্ণব-সমাজে ?” ॥ ১৩০ ॥

prabhu kahe, — kaha nā kene, ki saṅkoca-lāje?
the Lord says recite do why what hesitation shyness
granthera phala śunāibā vaiṣṇava-samāje?
of the book the fruit you will let hear in the assembly of Vaiṣṇavas

130 The Lord said, “Why don’t you recite it? Why this hesitation and shyness? Let the assembly of Vaiṣṇavas hear the fruit of your book.”

Śrī Rūpa recites a verse of blessing; on hearing it, the Lord outwardly shows feigned displeasure —

তবে রূপ-গোসাঞি যদি শ্লোক পড়িল ।
শুনি’ প্রভু কহে, — ‘এই অতি স্তুতি হৈল’ ॥ ১৩১ ॥

tabe rūpa-gosāñi yadi śloka paḍila
then Rūpa Gosāñi when the verse recited
śuni’ prabhu kahe, — ei ati stuti haila
hearing the Lord says this excessive praise has become

131 Then Rūpa Gosāñi recited the verse, and on hearing it the Lord said, “This is too much praise.”

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, *maṅgalācaraṇa*, verse 2)*

অনর্পিতচরীং চিরাৎ করুণয়াবতীর্ণঃ কলৌ
সমর্পয়িতুমুন্নতোজ্জ্বলরসাং স্বভক্তিশ্রিয়ম্ ।
হরিঃ পুরটসুন্দরদ্যুতিকদম্বসন্দীপিতঃ
সদা হৃদয়কন্দরে স্ফুরতু বঃ শচীনন্দনঃ ॥ ১৩২ ॥

anarpita-carīṁ cirāt karuṇayāvatīrṇaḥ kalau
not given before for a long time out of mercy descended in Kali
samarpayitum unnatojjvala-rasāṁ sva-bhakti-śriyam
to bestow of the most exalted radiant rasa devotion to Himself the treasure
hariḥ puraṭa-sundara-dyuti-kadamba-sandīpitaḥ
Hari golden beautiful lustre with a mass illumined
sadā hṛdaya-kandare sphuratu vaḥ śacī-nandanaḥ
always in the cave of the heart may He shine your Śacī's son

132 "May the Lord Hari, the son of Śacī, illumined by a mass of lustre more beautiful than gold, ever shine in the inmost cave of your hearts. Out of His mercy He has descended in the age of Kali to bestow what had not been given for a very long time — the treasure of devotion to Himself, rich in the most exalted, radiant *ujjvala-rasa*." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.2)[18]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.4.

Śrīmad Viśvanātha Cakravartī's commentary on the *Vidagdha-mādhava*: "The idea is that without the manifestation (*sphūrti*) of Mahāprabhu one cannot taste the *rasa* of Hari's pastimes. May Hari, the son of Śacī, appear in the cave of your heart; in the other sense, *hari* means a lion. This son of Śacī mercifully descended in Kali to bestow the treasure of devotion to Himself, that is, the wealth of service to Himself. What kind of treasure? 'Never given before' — given by no one before. But did not Kapiladeva and others earlier teach their mothers and others how to serve Bhagavān? To this it is said: although all *rasas* are present in it, in this treasure of *bhakti* the *rasa* is exalted and radiant (*ujjvala*); that is, a *bhakti* in which the *ujjvala-rasa* is foremost had never been taught. What is He like? Lit up by a host of rays more beautiful than even gold (*puraṭa*). This being so, just as a lion that has risen in a mountain cave kills the elephants there, so the

lion who is the son of Śacī, risen in the cave of your heart, kills the elephants that are the diseases of the heart. This is the suggested meaning (*dhvani*).”

Hearing the verse, the devotees praise it —

সব ভক্তগণ কহে শ্লোক শুনিয়া ।
কৃতার্থ করিলা সবায় শ্লোক শুনাঞা ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

saba bhakta-gaṇa kahe śloka śuniyā
all the devotees say the verse hearing
kṛtārtha karilā sabāya śloka śunāñā
fulfilled you have made all the verse letting hear

133 On hearing the verse, all the devotees said, “By letting us hear this verse you have blessed us all.”

*Rāya asks about the various parts of the *Vidagdha-mādhava* and how the characters are introduced; Śrī Rūpa answers by quoting verses from his play —*

রায় কহে, — “কোন্ আমুখে পাত্র সন্নিধান ?”
রূপ কহে, — “কালসাম্যে ‘প্রবর্ত্তক’ নাম” ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

rāya kahe, — kon āmukhe pātra-sannidhāna?
Rāya says in which prologue the characters’ entrance
rūpa kahe, — kāla-sāmye ‘pravartaka’ nāma
Rūpa says at the fitting time ‘pravartaka’ named

134 Rāya asked, “In which prologue (*āmukha*) do the characters enter?” Rūpa said, “In the one called *pravartaka*: they enter when the fitting time has come.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Those who play the roles — the hero and the other persons spoken of in the play — are called *pātra*. For example, the *Sāhitya-darpaṇa*, in its sixth chapter, verse 283, says: “In a play about the divine or the mortal he takes the same kind of form, and in a mixed one, either of the two. Let him hint at the subject (*vastu*), the seed (*bīja*), the opening (*mukha*), or else a character (*pātra*).” The

meaning of the word *āmukha* is given in the *Nāṭaka-candrikā*: “When the *sūtradhāra*, answering the actress, speaks of his own business in striking words that hint at what is to come, this is called the *āmukha*.” The point of Rāmānanda Rāya's question is this: in which *āmukha* (*prastāvanā*) do the actors who play the characters come onto the stage in this play? Śrī Rūpa's answer: the characters appear in the *āmukha* called *pravartaka* (entrance onto the stage) — *kāla-sāmye*, that is, at the time that has arrived.

Anubhāṣya.

See Antya 1.17.[32] The *āmukha*, or *prastāvanā*, is of five kinds. The *Sāhitya-darpaṇa*, in its sixth chapter, verse 288, says: “*Udghātyaka*, *kathodghāta*, *prayogātiśaya*, as well as *pravartaka* and *avalagita* — these are the five varieties of the *prastāvanā*.” That is, the *āmukha*, or *prastāvanā*, of a play is of five kinds: (1) *udghātyaka*, (2) *kathodghāta*, (3) *prayogātiśaya*, (4) *pravartaka*, (5) *avalagita*. The *Nāṭaka-candrikā* says: “Three parts (*aṅgas*) of the *āmukha* are named — *kathodghāta*, *pravartaka* and *prayogātiśaya* — and likewise the pair of parts of the *vīthī*, called *udghātyaka* and *avalagita*, as the sage declared.” Śrī Rāmānanda asked, “Which of these kinds does the prologue of the play follow?” In answer Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī said, “Of these kinds, the *pravartaka* has been adopted.” The *Sāhitya-darpaṇa*, in its sixth chapter, verse 292, says: “Where the *sūtradhāra* describes the time that has arrived, taking his stand on it, and the entrance of a character also rests on that time, this is the *pravartaka*.” That is, if the *sūtradhāra* describes the present time, taking his stand on it, and an actor playing a character enters in connection with that time, this is called *pravartaka*.

*(*Nāṭaka-candrikā*, verse 12)*

আক্ষিপ্তঃ কালসাম্যেন প্রবেশঃ স্যাৎ প্রবর্ত্তকম্ ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

ākṣiptaḥ kāla-sāmyena
brought on by the fitting of time
praveśaḥ syāt pravartakam
an entrance is pravartaka

135 “An entrance brought on by the arrival of the fitting time is called *pravartaka*.” (Nāṭaka-candrikā, 12)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When an actor playing a character enters the stage prompted (called forth) by a fitting time, that is, by the time that has arrived, this is called *pravartaka*.

Anubhāṣya.

kāla-sāmyena (relying on the time that has arrived) **ākṣiptaḥ** (sent, that is, relying on the time that has arrived) (**pātrasya**, of the actor) **praveśaḥ** (another reading has *pravṛttiḥ*) **pravartakam syāt**.

*An example of this — (*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 10)*[33]

সোঽয়ং বসন্তসময়ঃ সমিয়ায় যস্মিন্
পূর্ণং তমীশ্বরমুপোঢ়-নবানুরাগম্ ৷
গূঢ়গ্রহা রুচিরয়া সহ রাধয়াসৌ
রঙ্গায় সঙ্গময়িতা নিশি পৌর্ণমাসী ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

so 'yaṁ vasanta-samayaḥ samiyāya yasmin
that this of spring the season has come in which
pūrṇaṁ tam īśvaram upoḍha-navānurāgam
complete that Lord who has gained fresh love
gūḍha-grahā rucirayā saha rādhayāsau
with hidden intent lovely together with Rādhā she
raṅgāya saṅgamayitā niśi paurṇamāsī
for the play will unite at night Paurṇamāsī

136 "This is that springtime in which Paurṇamāsī, cherishing a hidden purpose, will bring together at night lovely Rādhā and the Lord in all His fullness, in whom fresh love has awakened, for the joy of Their play." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.10)[19]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Spring has come. At this season, at night, Paurṇamāsī will unite the complete Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, filled with fresh love (*anurāga*), with the supremely beautiful Śrī Rādhikā, to enhance the beauty of the pastimes. This verse has two meanings, one referring to the moon and one to Śrī Kṛṣṇa; of these, the meaning referring to Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the principal one.

Anubhāṣya.

yasmin (in which springtime) **asau gūḍha-grahā** (she in whom, because of the abundance of moonlight, the planets with weaker rays are hidden) **paurṇamāsī** (the lunar day, the full moon) **niśi** (at night) **upoḍha-navānurāgam** (him who has gained a fresh redness that accompanies him: *upoḍhaḥ*, gained; *navaḥ*, new; *anugataḥ*, accompanying; *rāgaḥ*, redness) **pūrṇaṁ tam īśvaram** (the lord of *tamī*, the night, that is, the moon) **rucirayā** (beautiful) **rādhayā** (with the constellation Viśākhā) **saha** (together) **raṅgāya** (for beauty) **saṅgam** (union) **ayitā** (brought about), **saḥ ayaṁ vasanta-samayaḥ samiyāya** (has arrived) — this describes the special quality of the time. In the other sense: she who has *gūḍha graha*, a hidden eagerness, is Bhagavatī Paurṇamāsī. She united that celebrated, complete Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, with the beautiful Rādhā *raṅgāya* — to reveal the secret of Their joyful pastimes.

রায় কহে, — “প্ররোচনাদি কহ দেখি’ শুনি ?”
রূপ কহে, — “মহাপ্রভুর শ্রবণেচ্ছা জানি” ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

rāya kahe, — prarocanādi kaha dekhi, śuni?
Rāya says prarocanā and the rest tell let us see let us hear

rūpa kahe, — mahāprabhura śravaṇecchā jāni
Rūpa says Mahāprabhu’s desire to hear I take (as such)

137 Rāya said, “Tell us the *prarocanā* and the rest — let us hear.” Rūpa said, “I take Mahāprabhu’s desire to hear as the *prarocanā*.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Prarocanā — the technique of awakening in the audience a desire to listen by praising the place, the time, the hero, the assembly and so on.

Anubhāṣya.

Prarocanā. The *Nāṭaka-candrikā* says: “Turning the attention of the audience toward the performance by praising the place, the time, the story, the subject, the assembly and so on is called *prarocanā*.” The *Sāhitya-darpaṇa*, in its sixth chapter, verse 286, says: “Its (the *prastāvanā*'s) parts are the *prarocanā*, the *vīthī*, as well as the *prahasana* and the *āmukha*. Turning attention by means of praise is *prarocanā*”; and further: “*Prarocanā* is making the audience eager to attend to the performance at hand by means of praise.” That is, awakening the audience's eagerness to attend by means of praise is called *prarocanā*.

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 8)*

ভক্তানামুদগাদনর্গলধিয়াং বর্গো নিসর্গোজ্জ্বলঃ
শীলৈঃ পল্লবিতঃ স বল্লববধূবন্ধোঃ প্রবন্ধোঽপ্যসৌ ৷
লেভে চত্বরতাঞ্চ তাণ্ডববিধের্বৃন্দাটবীগর্ভভূ-
র্মন্যে মদ্বিধপুণ্যমণ্ডলপরীপাকোঽয়মুন্মীলতি ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

bhaktānām udagād anargala-dhiyāṁ vargo nisargojjvalaḥ
of devotees has arisen of unobstructed intelligence an assembly naturally radiant
śīlaiḥ pallavitaḥ sa ballava-vadhū-bandhoḥ prabandho 'py asau
with fine qualities blossomed that of the cowherd women's Friend composition also this
lebhe catvaratāṁ ca tāṇḍava-vidher vṛndāṭavī-garbha-bhūr
has gained the state of an arena and for the dance of the Vṛndāvana forest the inner ground
manye mad-vidha-puṇya-maṇḍala-parīpāko 'yam unmīlati
I think of people like me of merits of the mass the ripening this is unfolding

138 "Here an assembly of devotees has gathered, radiant by nature, whose intelligence knows no bounds; this composition about the Friend of the cowherd maidens has blossomed with lifelike portrayals; and the sacred ground in the heart of the Vṛndāvana forest has become the arena for the dance. I think the merit of people like me has now ripened in full and is unfolding." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.8)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Devotees whose intelligence knows no obstruction and whose nature is radiant have gathered. This work about Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Lord of the life of the young wives of the cowherds, has also blossomed with many virtues. And the stage itself is the arena for the dance in the *rāsa-maṇḍala* of Vṛndāvana. Therefore I think that the ripened fruit of the pious merit (*sukṛti*) of people like us has come to light.

Anubhāṣya.

anargala-dhiyām (of those whose intelligence meets no obstruction — the expert) **bhaktānām nisargojjvalaḥ** (radiant by its very nature) **vargaḥ** (assembly) **udagāt** (has appeared — this describes the special quality of the characters); (and) **ballava-vadhū-bandhoḥ** (of Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **saḥ asau** (in the form of the *Vidagdha-

mādhava*) **prabandhaḥ api śīlaiḥ** (with the ornament of *svabhāvokti*, the description of things as they are) **pallavitaḥ** (has blossomed; for in this book every description is full of the ornament of *svabhāvokti* — this describes the special quality of the subject); **vṛndāṭavī-garbha-bhūḥ** (the innermost land of Vṛndāvana, the *rāsa-pīṭha*) **tāṇḍava-vidheḥ** (for the dance) **catvaratām** (the status of a courtyard, that is, of a dancing ground) **lebhe** (has obtained) — this describes the special quality of the place; (therefore) **ayaṁ mad-vidha-puṇya-maṇḍala-parīpākaḥ** (the ripening, the culmination, of the whole sphere of piety — the *sukṛti* — of people like me) **unmīlati** (comes to light).

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 6)*

অভিব্যক্তা মত্তঃ প্রকৃতিলঘুরূপাদপি বুধা
বিধাত্রী সিদ্ধার্থান্ হরিগুণময়ী বঃ কৃতিরিয়ম্ ।
পুলিন্দেনাপ্যগ্নিঃ কিমু সমিধমুন্মথ্য জনিতো
হিরণ্যশ্রেণীনামপহরতি নান্তঃকলুষতাম্ ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

abhivyaktā mattaḥ prakṛti-laghu-rūpād api budhā
brought forth by me by nature insignificant though O wise ones
vidhātrī siddhārthān hari-guṇa-mayī vaḥ kṛtir iyam
will make fulfilled in their aims full of Hari's qualities you composition this
pulindenāpy agniḥ kim u samidham unmathya janito
by a Pulinda even fire how then firewood by churning produced
hiraṇya-śreṇīnām apaharati nāntaḥ-kaluṣatām
of gold of bars remove not inner impurity

139 "O wise ones, this work has come forth from me, a lowly soul by nature, yet it is full of Hari's qualities and will fulfil your heart's desires. When even a Pulinda kindles fire by rubbing wood, does that fire not purge the hidden dross from bars of gold?" (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.6)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O wise ones! Though this composition, full of descriptions of Hari's qualities, has been brought forth by me, insignificant by nature, may it fulfil your cherished desires. Cannot fire, kindled by rubbing wood even by a Pulinda (a man of the lowest birth), remove the inner impurity (the dross) of bars of gold?

Anubhāṣya.

bhoḥ budhāḥ (O you assembled), **prakṛti-laghu-rūpāt** (from one insignificant by nature — wretched. But Sarasvatī, unable to bear the author's humility, praises Rūpa Gosvāmī: “from one who swiftly [*laghu*] brings forth, that is, composes, an excellent work”) **mattaḥ** (from me) **abhivyaktā** (brought forth) **iyaṁ hari-guṇa-mayī** (that is, full of their description) **kṛtiḥ** (the poem in the form of the play *Vidagdha-mādhava*) **api vaḥ** (you) **siddhārthān** (with your cherished, longed-for desires fulfilled) **vidhātrī** (she whose nature is to make; that is, may it make. For) **pulindena** (by a man of the lowest, untouchable birth) **api samidham** (wood) **unmathya janitaḥ** (born of rubbing or friction) **agniḥ api hiraṇya-śreṇīnām** (of heaps of gold) **antaḥ-kaluṣatām kim u na apaharati** (does it not remove? In the same way this work will surely remove your boundless pain of separation).

রায় কহে, — “কহ দেখি প্রেমোৎপত্তি-কারণ
পূর্ব্বানুরাগ, বিকার, চেষ্টা, কামলিখন ?” ॥ ১৪০ ॥

rāya kahe, — kaha dekhi premotpatti-kāraṇa?
Rāya says tell let us see of love’s arising the causes
pūrvānurāga, vikāra, ceṣṭā, kāma-likhana?
first attraction transformation actions love letter

140 Rāya said, “Tell us now the causes from which love arises: the first attraction (*pūrvānurāga*), its transformations (*vikāra*), its actions (*ceṣṭā*), and the love letter (*kāma-likhana*).”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Pūrvānurāga means *pūrva-rāga*, the first attraction, before meeting; *vikāra* is the transformation of love (*praṇaya-vikāra*), that is, the lovesickness (*vyādhi*) born of divine madness; *ceṣṭā* means the bodily actions born of *prema*; *kāma-likhana* is a letter of the gopīs that reveals their love. The Lord[30] asked about the causes from which *prema* arises, and Śrī Rūpa told everything.

Anubhāṣya.

Kāma-likhana, a love letter: the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* (section on *vipralambha*, verse 26) says: “A message that reveals one's own love, sent by a young woman to

a young man or by a young man to a young woman, is called a love letter (*kāma-lekha*).”

ক্রমে শ্রীরূপ-গোসাঞি সকলি কহিল ।
শুনি’ প্রভুর ভক্তগণের চমৎকার হৈল ॥ ১৪১ ॥

krame śrī rūpa-gosāñi sakali kahila
in order Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi everything told
śuni’ prabhura bhakta-gaṇera camatkāra haila
hearing the Lord’s of the devotees wonder arose

141 Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi explained everything in order, and the Lord’s devotees were amazed to hear it.

*An example of the cause from which *rati* arises —*

একস্য শ্রুতমেব লুম্পতি মতিং কৃষ্ণেতি নামাক্ষরং
সান্দ্রোন্মাদপরম্পরামুপনয়ত্যন্যস্য বংশীকলঃ ।
এষ স্নিগ্ধঘনদ্যুতির্মনসি মে লগ্নঃ পটে বীক্ষণাৎ
কষ্টং ধিক্ পুরুষত্রয়ে রতিরভূন্মন্যে মৃতিঃ শ্রেয়সী ॥ ১৪২ ॥

ekasya śrutam eva lumpati matiṁ kṛṣṇeti nāmākṣaraṁ
of one heard merely steal away the mind “Kṛṣṇa” of the name the syllables
sāndronmāda-paramparām upanayaty anyasya vaṁśī-kalaḥ
of dense madness a stream brings of another of the flute the sound
eṣa snigdha-ghana-dyutir manasi me lagnaḥ paṭe vīkṣaṇāt
this one with the soft lustre of a rain cloud in mind My is fixed in a picture from seeing
kaṣṭaṁ dhik puruṣa-traye ratir abhūn manye mṛtiḥ śreyasī
alas shame for three men attraction has arisen I think death is better

142 “Merely hearing the syllables of one man’s name, ‘Kṛṣṇa’, I lost My senses; the sound of another’s flute brings on a stream of deep madness; and this one, with the soft lustre of a rain cloud, has been fixed in My mind ever since I saw Him in a picture. Alas, shame on Me! My heart is drawn to three men. I think it is better for Me to die.” (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.9)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Rādhikā, overcome by *pūrva-rāga*, says: “I heard the syllables of the name ‘Kṛṣṇa’ belonging to some other man — and I lost My senses. The sound of another man's flute awakens a deep madness in My heart. And ever since I saw in a picture the soft, cloudlike luster of yet another man, it has remained fixed in My heart. Alas, shame on Me! How could such *rati* for three different men arise in Me? It is better for Me to die.”

Anubhāṣya.

(**He sakhi**,) **ekasya** (of another man) **“kṛṣṇa” iti nāmākṣaraṁ** (the syllables of the name “Kṛṣṇa”) **śrutam eva** (merely heard) **matim** (the mind — of Me, Rādhā — the sense of fidelity to a husband proper to a woman) **lumpati** (cut away: hearing for the first time only the syllables of Kṛṣṇa's name, I tasted their supreme sweetness and felt *rati* for Kṛṣṇa who bears that name). **anyasya** (of a second, other man) **vaṁśī-kalaḥ** (the sound of the flute, when I heard it) **sāndronmāda-paramparām** (a stream of thickened divine madness) **upanayati** (brings: then, tasting the supreme sweetness of the flute's sound, I felt *rati* for the one who plays that flute). **vīkṣaṇāt** (because I saw him) **eṣaḥ** (another, a third man) **snigdha-ghana-dyutiḥ** (shining like a cloud that gives delight) **paṭe** (in a picture) **me** (My) **manasi** (in the heart) **lagnaḥ** (merged with it, clung, became joined: then, tasting with My eyes just once a picture of Kṛṣṇa's form and taking him to be different, I felt *rati* for him as well). **Dhik kaṣṭaṁ** (alas, woe!), **puruṣa-traye** (for three heroes — one named Kṛṣṇa, one who plays the flute, and one dark as a sapphire and a rain cloud; for Me, a woman of a noble family, even *rati* for one other man is improper, what to speak of three!) My **ratiḥ abhūt** (*rati* has arisen); (therefore) **mṛtiḥ** (death alone) **śreyasī** (is the good) — so I **manye** (think: without death there is no escape from this shameful *rati* — this is the sense).

*An example of *vikāra*, transformation —*

ইয়ং সখি সুদুঃসাধ্যা রাধা-হৃদয়বেদনা ।
কৃতা যত্র চিকিৎসাপি কুৎসায়াং পর্য্যবস্যতি ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

iyaṁ sakhi su-duḥsādhyā
this O friend very hard to cure
rādhā-hṛdaya-vedanā
Rādhā's heart's pain
kṛtā yatra cikitsāpi
undertaken in which treatment even
kutsāyāṁ paryavasyati
in disgrace ends

143 (Śrī Rādhā said to Lalitā and Viśākhā:) "Friend, this pain in Rādhā's heart is very hard to cure: even the treatment one undertakes for it ends only in disgrace." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.8)[20]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Sakhī, Rādhā's heartache can hardly be cured: even if She is treated, it all ends only in disgrace."

Anubhāṣya.
He sakhi, **iyaṁ rādhā-hṛdaya-vedanā** (this heartache of Rādhā) **su-duḥsādhyā** (is almost incurable), **yatra** (for in it) **kṛtā api cikitsā** (even the treatment undertaken) **kutsāyāṁ paryavasyati** (ends in disgrace: if the pain does not subside, the physician himself will be blamed; besides, I long for all three men at one and the same moment, so even if one of them is brought, the pain will not go — this is the sense).

*An example of a love letter (*kandarpa-lekha*) in Prakrit —*

ধরিঅ পড়িচ্ছন্দগুণং সুন্দর
মহ মন্দিরে তুমং বসসি ৷
তহ তহ রুন্ধসি বলিঅং
জহ জহ চইদা পলাএম্হি ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

dhari-a paḍicchanda-guṇaṁ sundara
taking of a painted picture the form O beautiful one
maha mandire tumaṁ vasasi
in My house You dwell
taha taha rundhasi bali-aṁ
there there You block (My way) by force
jaha jaha ca-idā palāemhi
wherever wherever frightened I flee

144 (Śrī Rādhikā wrote to Kṛṣṇa:) "O beautiful one, taking the form of a painted picture, You dwell in My house; and wherever I flee in fright, there You forcibly block My way." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.33)[21]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"O beautiful one, taking the form of an image — a painted picture — You dwell in My house (*mandira*). Wherever I run in fright, there You block My way." The verse is written in Prakrit; its Sanskrit rendering is this: "Taking the form of an image, O beautiful one, You dwell in My house. Wherever I run in fright, there You forcibly block My way."

Anubhāṣya.

He sundara (O beautiful one), **tumaṁ** (*tvam*, You) **paḍicchanda-guṇaṁ** (*praticchanda-guṇam*, the form of a painted picture) **dhari-a** (*dhṛtvā*, taking) **maha** (*mama*, My) **mandire** (in the house) **vasasi** (*tiṣṭhasi*, dwell); **jaha jaha** (*yathā yathā*, wherever) **ca-idā** (*cakitā satī*, in fright) **palāemhi** (*palāye*, I run), **taha taha** (*tathā tathā*, there You) **bali-aṁ** (*balitam*, forcibly, using force) **rundhasi** (*ruṇatsi*, block My way).

*An example of *ceṣṭā*, the display in actions —*

অগ্রে বীক্ষ্য শিখণ্ডখণ্ডমচিরাদুৎকম্পমালম্বতে
গুঞ্জানাঞ্চ বিলোকনান্মুহুরসৌ সাস্রং পরিক্রোশতি ৷
নো জানে জনয়ন্নপূর্ব্বনটনক্রীড়া-চমৎকারিতাং
বালায়াঃ কিল চিত্তভূমিমবিশৎ কোঽয়ং নবীনগ্রহঃ ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

agre vīkṣya śikhaṇḍa-khaṇḍam acirād utkampam ālambate
before her seeing of a peacock feather a piece at once trembling she takes on
guñjānāṁ ca vilokanān muhur asau sāsraṁ parikrośati
of guñjā berries and at the sight again and again she with tears cries aloud
no jāne janayann apūrva-naṭana-krīḍā-camatkāritāṁ
not I know producing unprecedented of dancing play the wonder
bālāyāḥ kila citta-bhūmim aviśat ko 'yaṁ navīna-grahaḥ
of the girl surely of the heart the field has entered what this new graha

145 "On seeing even a scrap of peacock feather before Her, She at once begins to tremble; at the sight of *guñjā* berries She cries aloud again and again, in tears. I do not know what new *graha*, what possessing power, has entered the field of this girl's heart and brings forth in Her a wondrous dance never seen before." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.15)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Seeing a peacock feather before Her, this girl suddenly begins to tremble, and seeing *guñjā* berries She cries aloud, shedding tears. I do not know what new *graha*, a power that possesses the soul, has entered the field of Her heart and awakens in Her the wonder of an unprecedented dancing play."

Anubhāṣya.

He bhagavati paurṇamāsi (O venerable Paurṇamāsī), **asau** (Rādhā) **agre** (before Her) **śikhaṇḍa-khaṇḍam** (a peacock feather) **vīkṣya** (seeing) **acirāt** (at once) **utkampam ālambate** (begins to tremble), **guñjānāṁ tu** (and of *guñjā* berries) **vilokanāt** (from the sight) **sāsraṁ** (in tears) **muhuḥ parikrośati** (sobs aloud again and again); (I) **no jāne** (do not know) **kaḥ ayaṁ navīna-grahaḥ** (what this new *graha* is) that, **apūrva-naṭana-krīḍā-camatkāritāṁ** (complete absorption in the most wondrous play of dance) **janayan** (producing), **bālāyāḥ** (of Rādhā) **citta-bhūmim** (the field of the heart) **aviśat** (has entered).

*An example of resolve (*vyavasāya*) —*

অকারুণ্যঃ কৃষ্ণো যদি ময়ি তবাগঃ কথমিদং
মুধা মা রোদীর্মে কুরু পরমিমামুত্তরকৃতিম্ ৷
তমালস্য স্কন্ধে সখি কলিত-দোর্ব্বল্লরিরিয়ং
যথা বৃন্দারণ্যে চিরমবিচলা তিষ্ঠতি তনুঃ ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

akāruṇyaḥ kṛṣṇo yadi mayi tavāgaḥ katham idaṁ
merciless Kṛṣṇa if to Me your fault how this
mudhā mā rodīr me kuru param imām uttara-kṛtim
in vain do not weep for Me perform only this last rite
tamālasya skandhe sakhi kalita-dor-vallarir iyaṁ
of the tamāla on the trunk O friend with creeper-arms placed this
yathā vṛndāraṇye ciram avicalā tiṣṭhati tanuḥ
so that in the Vṛndāvana forest forever unmoving remains body

146 "If Kṛṣṇa is merciless to Me, how is that your fault? Do not weep in vain. Only perform this last rite for Me, friend: lay the creepers of My arms on the trunk of a *tamāla* tree, so that this body of Mine may stay unmoving in the forest of Vṛndāvana forever." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.47)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Since Kṛṣṇa Himself has become merciless to Me, what fault is yours, sakhī? Do not weep in vain. You can do one thing for Me — My funeral rite: in Vṛndāvana, wind these creeper-arms of Mine around the trunk of a *tamāla* tree, and leave My body so forever."

Anubhāṣya.
He viśākhe (O Viśākhā), **yadi kṛṣṇaḥ mayi akāruṇyaḥ** (if Kṛṣṇa has become cruel to Me), (then) **katham** (how) **tava mayi āgaḥ** (could the fault toward Me be yours)? (Therefore) **mudhā** (in vain) **mā rodīḥ** (do not weep). **He sakhi**, **param** (only) **imām uttara-kṛtim** (this funeral rite) **kuru** (perform), **yathā** (so that) **iyaṁ me tanuḥ** (this body of Mine), **tamālasya skandhe kalita-dor-vallariḥ** (whose creeper-arms are laid on the trunk of a *tamāla*), **vṛndāraṇye** (in Vṛndāvana) **ciram** (forever) **avicalā** (motionless) **tiṣṭhati** (may remain) (that is, when I give up My life, see that My body, its creeper-arms wound around the trunk of a *tamāla*, remains in Vṛndāvana).

রায় কহে, — "কহ দেখি ভাবের স্বভাব ?"
রূপ কহে, — "ঐছে হয় কৃষ্ণবিষয়ক 'ভাব'" ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

rāya kahe, — kaha dekhi bhāvera svabhāva?
Rāya says tell let us see of bhāva the nature
rūpa kahe, — aiche haya kṛṣṇa-viṣayaka 'bhāva'
Rūpa says such is Kṛṣṇa concerning bhāva

147 Rāya said, “Tell us now the nature of *bhāva*.” Rūpa answered that *bhāva* directed toward Kṛṣṇa is like this:

Anubhāṣya.
Bhāva means *prema*.

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 2, verse 18)*

পীড়াভির্নবকালকূটকটুতা-গর্ব্বস্য নির্ব্বাসনো
নিঃস্যন্দেন মুদাং সুধা-মধুরিমাহঙ্কার-সঙ্কোচনঃ ।
প্রেমা সুন্দরি নন্দনন্দনপরো জাগর্ত্তি যস্যান্তরে
জ্ঞায়ন্তে স্ফুটমস্য বক্রমধুরাস্তেনৈব বিক্রান্তয়ঃ ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

pīḍābhir nava-kālakūṭa-kaṭutā-garvasya nirvāsano
by its pains of fresh kālakūṭa poison pungency’s pride banishing
niḥsyandena mudāṁ sudhā-madhurimāhaṅkāra-saṅkocanaḥ
by the outpouring of joys of nectar sweetness’s conceit humbling
premā sundari nanda-nandana-paro jāgarti yasyāntare
love O beautiful one for Nanda’s son directed awakens in whose heart
jñāyante sphuṭam asya vakra-madhurās tenaiva vikrāntayaḥ
are known clearly its crooked and sweet by him alone powers

148 “O beautiful one, when love for Nanda’s son awakens in someone’s heart, its pains drive out the pride that fresh *kālakūṭa* poison takes in its sting, and its outpouring of joys humbles the boast of nectar in its sweetness. Its crooked and sweet powers are clearly known to that person alone.” (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.18)[22]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 2.52.

রায় কহে, — “কহ সহজ-প্রেমের লক্ষণ” ।
রূপ-গোসাঞি কহে, — ‘সাহজিক প্রেমধর্ম্ম’ ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

rāya kahe, — kaha sahaja-premera lakṣaṇa
Rāya says tell of natural love the signs
rūpa-gosāñi kahe, — sāhajika prema-dharma
Rūpa Gosāñi says natural of prema the nature

149 Rāya said, “Tell us the characteristics of natural love.” Rūpa Gosāñi answered that prema is natural in its very essence:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
When Rāya asked about the “natural” (*sahaja*) characteristic of *prema*, Śrī Rūpa answered: “The nature of *prema* is natural (*sāhajika*) in itself.”

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 5, verse 4)*

স্তোত্রং যত্র তটস্থতাং প্রকটয়চ্চিত্তস্য ধত্তে ব্যথাং
নিন্দাপি প্রমদং প্রয়চ্ছতি পরীহাসশ্রিয়ং বিভ্রতী ।
দোষেণ ক্ষয়িতাং গুণেন গুরুতাং কেনাপ্যনাতন্বতী
প্রেম্ণঃ স্বারসিকস্য কস্যচিদিয়ং বিক্রীড়তি প্রক্রিয়া ॥ ১৫০ ॥

stotraṁ yatra taṭa-sthatāṁ prakaṭayac cittasya dhatte vyathāṁ
praise in which indifference displaying to the heart gives pain
nindāpi pramadaṁ prayacchati parīhāsa-śriyaṁ bibhratī
blame even delight gives of a jest the charm bearing
doṣeṇa kṣayitāṁ guṇena gurutāṁ kenāpy anātanvatī
by a fault decrease by a virtue increase by anything not showing
premṇaḥ svārasikasya kasyacid iyaṁ vikrīḍati prakriyā
of love natural of a certain this plays the working

150 “In this love, praise makes one show indifference yet pains the heart; even blame, bearing the charm of a jest, gives delight; it neither wanes because of any fault nor grows because of any virtue. Such is the play of a certain natural love.” (Vidagdha-mādhava, 5.4)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Svārasika means natural. Natural *prema* acts and plays in this way. When the loving one hears herself praised (by the beloved), she shows indifference but feels a special pain. When she hears herself blamed (by the beloved), she takes it as the charm of a jest, and it gives her (great) joy. When she sees some fault in the one

she loves, her love does not diminish at all; and when she sees some virtue in him, (her love) does not grow either.

Anubhāṣya.

Yatra (in which — in *prema*) **stotraṁ** (words of praise), **taṭa-sthatāṁ** (indifference) **prakaṭayat** (displaying), **cittasya vyathāṁ dhatte** (cause the heart pain); **nindā api** (even blame), **parīhāsa-śriyaṁ** (the charm of a jest) **bibhratī** (bearing), **pramadaṁ** (joy) **prayacchati** (gives); **kena api doṣeṇa** (by no fault whatever) **kṣayitāṁ** (decrease) **na**, **guṇena** (by a virtue) **gurutāṁ** (increase) **na ca ātanvatī** (displaying neither: if love arises in dependence on some *upādhi*, such as virtues, then on seeing faults it weakens and on seeing virtues it grows stronger; but here it is free of *upādhis* and depends neither on faults nor on virtues) — **kasyacit svārasikasya** (of a certain natural) **premṇaḥ** (*prema*) **iyaṁ prakriyā** (such is the working, and it) **vikrīḍati** (plays in the heart).

*An example of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's remorse after He has tested her *rāga* —*

শ্রুত্বা নিষ্ঠুরতাং মমেন্দুবদনা প্রেমাঙ্কুরং ভিন্দতী
স্বান্তে শান্তিধুরাং বিধায় বিধুরে প্রায়ঃ পরাঞ্চিষ্যতি ।
কিম্বা পামর-কাম-কার্ম্মুকপরিত্রস্তা বিমোক্ষ্যত্যসূন্
হা মৌগ্ধ্যাৎ ফলিনী মনোরথলতা মৃদ্বী ময়োন্মূলিতা ॥ ১৫১ ॥

śrutvā niṣṭhuratāṁ mamendu-vadanā premāṅkuraṁ bhindatī
hearing of the cruelty My the moon-faced one the sprout of love breaking
svānte śānti-dhurāṁ vidhāya vidhure prāyaḥ parāñciṣyati
in Her heart steadiness establishing afflicted probably will turn away
kimvā pāmara-kāma-kārmuka-paritrastā vimokṣyaty asūn
or of wicked Kāma of the bow terrified will give up Her life
hā maugdhyāt phalinī manoratha-latā mṛdvī mayonmūlitā
alas through folly about to bear fruit of desire the creeper tender by Me uprooted

151 (Śrī Kṛṣṇa lamented:) “Hearing of My cruelty, moon-faced Rādhā will break the sprout of Her love, make Her afflicted heart steady, and probably turn away from Me; or else, terrified of the bow of merciless Kāma, She will give up Her life. Alas, in My folly I have uprooted the tender creeper of desire that was about to bear fruit!” (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.40)[23]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Hearing of My cruelty, moon-faced Rādhā will break the sprout of love, somehow establish calm or steadiness in Her suffering heart, and probably turn away from Me. Or else, frightened by the bow of wicked Kandarpa, She will give up Her life. Alas, in My folly I have uprooted the tender creeper of desire that was just about to bear fruit."

Anubhāṣya.

Indu-vadanā (moon-faced Rādhikā), **mama niṣṭhuratāṁ śrutvā** (hearing of My cruelty), **premāṅkuraṁ** (the newly arisen *prema*) **bhindatī** (breaking), **vidhure** (in Her saddened, suffering) **svānte** (heart) **śānti-dhurāṁ** (the utmost steadiness) **vidhāya** (taking up), **parāñcişyati** (will turn away); **kiṁ vā** (or else), **pāmara-kāma-kārmuka-paritrastā** (frightened by the arrows [*kārmuka*] of unruly [*pāmara*] Kāma, Kandarpa), **asūn** (Her life) **vimokṣyati** (will give up); **hā** (alas!) **maugdhyāt** (out of folly) **mayā** (by Me) **mṛdvī** (tender, since it has just sprouted) **phalinī** (about to bear fruit) **manoratha-latā** (the creeper of desire) **unmūlitā** (has been uprooted).

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 2, verse 41)*

যস্যোৎসঙ্গসুখাশয়া শিথিলিতা গুর্ব্বী গুরুভ্যস্ত্রপা
প্রাণেভ্যোঽপি সুহৃত্তমাঃ সখি তথা যূয়ং পরিক্লেশিতাঃ ৷
ধর্ম্মঃ সোঽপি মহান্ময়া ন গণিতঃ সাধ্বীভিরধ্যাসিতো
ধিগ্ধৈর্য্যং তদুপেক্ষিতাপি যদহং জীবামি পাপীয়সী ॥ ১৫২ ॥

yasyotsaṅga-sukhāśayā śithilitā gurvī gurubhyas trapā
whose embrace by the hope of happiness cast off great before the elders shyness
prāṇebhyo 'pi suhṛt-tamāḥ sakhi tathā yūyaṁ parikleśitāḥ
than life even dearest friends O friend likewise you tormented
dharmaḥ so 'pi mahān mayā na gaṇitaḥ sādhvībhir adhyāsito
dharma that even great by Me not regarded by chaste women followed
dhig dhairyaṁ tad-upekṣitāpi yad ahaṁ jīvāmi pāpīyasī
shame on steadiness by Him neglected though that I live sinful

152 "Friend, in the hope of the happiness of His embrace I cast off My great shyness before the elders; I tormented you, My dearest friends, dearer

to Me than life; I disregarded even the great dharma that chaste women follow. Shame on My steadiness, that though He neglects Me, I, sinful as I am, still live!" (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.41)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Sakhī, I longed for happiness in His embrace — and for His sake I cast off even My great shyness before the elders. For His sake I caused you so much pain, though you are dearer to Me than life. For His sake I counted as nothing even that *dharma* (of fidelity to a husband) on which chaste women rely. And now Kṛṣṇa Himself has neglected Me, yet I, sinful as I am, still live! Shame on My steadiness!"

Anubhāṣya.

He sakhi, **yasya** (Kṛṣṇa's) **utsaṅga-sukhāśayā** (out of an intense desire for the bliss of closeness with Him) **gurubhyaḥ** (before the venerable elders) **gurvī** (great) **trapā** (shyness) **śithilitā** (was cast off), **tathā** (and likewise) **prāṇebhyaḥ api suhṛt-tamāḥ** (the dearest, dearer than life) **yūyaṁ** (you) **parikleśitāḥ** (have been tormented); **sādhvībhiḥ adhyāsitaḥ** (followed by chaste women) **yaḥ mahān dharmaḥ** (the great *dharma* — fidelity to a husband), **saḥ api** (even that) **mayā** (by Me, a wife of a noble family) **na gaṇitaḥ** (was not taken into account); **yat** (since) **ahaṁ pāpīyasī** (I, the sinful one), **tad-upekṣitā api** (even neglected by Him, Kṛṣṇa), **jīvāmi** (live on), (therefore) **dhairyaṁ** (My steadiness) — **dhik** (shame on it)!

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 2, verse 46)*

গৃহান্তঃখেলন্ত্যো নিজসহজবাল্যস্য বলনা-
দভদ্রং ভদ্রং বা কিমপি হি ন জানীমহি মনাক্ ।
বয়ং নেতুং যুক্তাঃ কথমশরণাং কামপি দশাং
কথং বা ন্যায়্যা তে প্রথয়িতুমুদাসীনপদবী ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

gṛhāntaḥ khelantyo nija-sahaja-bālyasya balanād
within the house playing of our own natural childhood by the force
abhadraṁ bhadraṁ vā kim api hi na jānīmahi manāk
ill good or anything indeed not we know in the least
vayaṁ netuṁ yuktāḥ katham aśaraṇāṁ kām api daśāṁ
us to bring proper how helpless some state
kathaṁ vā nyāyyā te prathayitum udāsīna-padavī
how or just for You to display of indifference the path

153 "Playing at home in our natural childlike simplicity, we did not know in the least what was good or bad. How was it proper to bring us into such a helpless state? And how is it just for You now to take the path of indifference?" (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.46)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"By My natural childlike simplicity I was playing at home and knew nothing at all of what is called 'good' and what 'bad'! Was it worthy of You to plunge us into such a helpless state? And is it just of You now to take the path of indifference?"

Anubhāṣya.

(**He bakī-hantaḥ**, O slayer of Bakī![34]) **Nija-sahaja-bālyasya balanāt** (by the force of our natural childlike simplicity) **gṛhāntaḥ khelantyaḥ** (playing at home), **vayaṁ** (we) **kim api abhadraṁ** (misfortune) **bhadraṁ vā** (or good fortune) **manāk** (in the least) **na jānīmahi** (do not know); **katham vayaṁ kām api** (into such a) **aśaraṇāṁ** (shelterless) **daśāṁ** (state) **netuṁ** (to bring) **yuktāḥ** (is it proper, is it in keeping with *dharma*)? (And if we have been brought into such a state,) **kathaṁ vā te** (for You) **udāsīna-padavī** (indifference) **prathayitum** (to display) **nyāyyā** (is it just? — so You are bent only on killing us — this is the sense).

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 2, verse 37)*

অন্তঃক্লেশকলঙ্কিতাঃ কিল বয়ং যামোঽদ্য যাম্যাং পুরীং
নায়ং বঞ্চনসঞ্চয়প্রণয়িনং হাসং তথাপ্যুজ্ঝতি ।
অস্মিন্ সম্পুটিতে গভীরকপটৈরাভীরপল্লীবিটে
হা মেধাবিনি রাধিকে তব কথং প্রেমা গরীয়ানভূৎ ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

antaḥ-kleśa-kalaṅkitāḥ kila vayaṁ yāmo 'dya yāmyāṁ purīṁ
inner by suffering stained surely we go today of Yama to the city
nāyaṁ vañcana-sañcaya-praṇayinaṁ hāsaṁ tathāpy ujjhati
not He of deceits heaps fond of laughter still gives up
asmin sampuṭite gabhīra-kapaṭair ābhīra-pallī-viṭe
for this filled with deep guile of the cowherd village rake
hā medhāvini rādhike tava kathaṁ premā garīyān abhūt
ah wise Rādhikā Your how love so great arose

154 "Stained by inner suffering, we are surely going today to the city of Yama, and still He will not stop laughing, His laughter full of deceit. Ah, wise Rādhikā, how could such great love arise in You for this rake of the cowherd village, so full of deep guile?" (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"With hearts stained by suffering we are going to the abode of Yama this very day, and still this Kṛṣṇa does not give up His affectionate laughter full of deceit (a cruel laughter so full of deceit)! O wise Rādhikā, how could so lofty a *prema* arise in You for this philanderer of the cowherd village, so full of deep guile?"

Anubhāṣya.

Vayam (we), **antaḥ-kleśa-kalaṅkitāḥ** (stained, marked, by inner suffering: this suffering will remain even after death — this is the sense), **adya** (today) **yāmyāṁ purīṁ** (to the abode of Yama) **kila** (certainly) **yāmaḥ** (are going); **tathāpi** (and yet, though He is so merciless,) **ayaṁ** (this Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **vañcana-sañcaya-praṇayinaṁ** (that heaps up deceptions) **hāsaṁ** (His laughter) **na ujjhati** (does not give up)! **Hā medhāvini** (O wise) **rādhike**, **gabhīra-kapaṭaiḥ sampuṭite** (filled with deep guile) **asmin ābhīra-pallī-viṭe** (in this Kṛṣṇa, the gallant [*viṭa*] who seeks the love of the cowherd women, the beauties of Vraja) **tava garīyān** (great) **premā katham abhūt** (how did it arise)? (Let others love Him, whose minds are blinded by amorous desire, but for You, the wise one, this is not fitting — this is the sense.)

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 3, verse 9)*

হিত্বা দূরে পথি ধবতরোরন্তিকং ধর্ম্মসেতো-
র্ভঙ্গোদগ্রা গুরুশিখরিণং রংহসা লঙ্ঘয়ন্তী ৷
লেভে কৃষ্ণার্ণব নবরসা রাধিকা-বাহিনী ত্বাং
বাগ্বীচিভিঃ কিমিব বিমুখীভাবমস্যাস্তনোষি ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

hitvā dūre pathi dhava-taror antikaṁ dharma-setor
leaving far on the way of the husband-tree the nearness of the bridge of dharma

bhaṅgodagrā guru-śikhariṇaṁ raṁhasā laṅghayantī
eager to break the mountain of elders swiftly crossing

lebhe kṛṣṇārṇava nava-rasā rādhikā-vāhinī tvāṁ
has reached O Kṛṣṇa-ocean full of fresh rasa the river Rādhikā You

vāg-vīcibhiḥ kim iva vimukhī-bhāvam asyās tanoṣi
with waves of words why then estrangement toward her You show

155 "O ocean Kṛṣṇa, the river Rādhikā, full of fresh rasa, has left far behind on her way the tree of her husband that stood beside her, broken through the bridge of dharma, and swiftly crossed the mountain of her elders, and she has reached You. Why, then, do You turn her away with the waves of Your words?" (Vidagdha-mādhava, 3.9)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"O Kṛṣṇa, ocean! The river Rādhikā, whose nature is ever-new *rasa*, has left far behind the path that ran beside the tree — her lawful husband; she has swiftly broken the bridge of *dharma*, forcibly crossed the mountain of the elders, and reached You. How is it that You now show her estrangement with waves of words?"

Anubhāṣya.

He kṛṣṇārṇava (O Kṛṣṇa, ocean), **dhava-taroḥ** (of the tree — Her husband) **antikaṁ** (the nearness) **dūre pathi** (far off on the way) **hitvā** (leaving), **dharma-setoḥ** (of the bridge — the *dharma* of the family, for that is the bridge) **bhaṅgodagrā** (the breaker, one whose foremost urge is to break it; able to break it), **guru-śikhariṇaṁ** (the mountain — the venerable elders) **raṁhasā** (swiftly) **laṅghayantī** (crossing over), **nava-rasā** (She in whom there is new, fresh *rasa*

— the *rasas* from *śānta* to *śṛṅgāra*) **rādhikā-vāhinī** (the river Rādhikā) **tvāṁ** (You, the ocean Kṛṣṇa) **lebhe** (has reached); **tvaṁ ca** (and You) **vāg-vīcībhiḥ** (with mere waves of words) **kim iva** (why) **asyāḥ** (Her — the river Rādhā's) **vimukhī-bhāvam** (estrangement) **tanoṣi** (spread)?

রায় কহে, — "বৃন্দাবন, মুরলী-নিঃস্বন ।
কৃষ্ণ, রাধিকার কৈছে কৈরাছ বর্ণন ? ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

rāya kahe, — vṛndāvana, muralī-niḥsvana
Rāya says Vṛndāvana of the flute the sound
kṛṣṇa, rādhikāra kaiche kairācha varṇana?
Kṛṣṇa of Rādhikā how you have made the description

156 Rāya said, "How have you described Vṛndāvana, the sound of the flute, Kṛṣṇa, and Rādhikā?

কহ, তোমার কবিত্ব শুনি' হয় চমৎকার" ।
ক্রমে রূপ-গোসাঞি কহে করি' নমস্কার ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

kaha, tomāra kavitva śuni' haya camatkāra
tell your poetry hearing there is wonder
krame rūpa-gosāñi kahe kari' namaskāra
in order Rūpa Gosāñi speaks making obeisance

157 Tell us, for hearing your poetry fills one with wonder." Bowing down, Rūpa Gosāñi recited them in order:

An example [of the description] of Vṛndāvana —

সুগন্ধৌ মাকন্দপ্রকরমকরন্দস্য মধুরে
বিনিস্যন্দে বন্দীকৃতমধুপবৃন্দং মুহুরিদম্ ।
কৃতান্দোলং মন্দোন্নতিভিরনিলৈশ্চন্দনগিরে-
র্মমানন্দং বৃন্দা-বিপিনমতুলং তুন্দিলয়তি ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

su-gandhau mākanda-prakara-makarandasya madhure
in the fragrant of mango of masses of buds of the nectar sweet
vinisyande vandī-kṛta-madhupa-vṛndaṁ muhur idam
flow held captive of bees the swarms again and again this
kṛtāndolaṁ mandonnatibhir anilaiś candana-girer
set swaying by the gently rising breezes of the sandalwood mountain
mamānandaṁ vṛndā-vipinam atulaṁ tundilayati
My bliss of Vṛndā the forest incomparable swells

158 "This forest of Vṛndā, where swarms of bees are held captive again and again by the sweet, fragrant flow of nectar from masses of mango buds, and which sways in the gentle breezes from the sandalwood mountain (Malaya), swells My incomparable bliss." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.23)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Sweet with the honey of mango buds, full of swarms of bees captured again and again by that fragrant flow, set swaying by the gentlest wafting of the breeze from the sandalwood mountain (Malaya), this Śrī Vṛndāvana increases My incomparable bliss."

Anubhāṣya.
He madhumaṅgala, **mākanda-prakara-makarandasya** (of the nectar of the many mango buds) **madhure su-gandhau vinisyande** (in the sweet, fragrant flow) **muhuḥ** (again and again) **vandī-kṛta-madhupa-vṛndaṁ** (that by which swarms of bees are captured, bound), **candana-gireḥ** (of the Malaya mountain) **mandonnatibhiḥ** (gently blowing) **anilaiḥ** (by breezes) **kṛtāndolaṁ** (shaken, set swaying) **idam vṛndā-vipinam** (this forest of Vṛndāvana) **mama atulaṁ ānandaṁ** (My incomparable bliss) **tundilayati** (increases).

বৃন্দাবনং দিব্যলতা-পরীতং
লতাশ্চ পুষ্পস্ফুরিতাগ্রভাজঃ ৷
পুষ্পাণি চ স্ফীতমধুব্রতানি
মধুব্রতাশ্চ শ্রুতিহারিগীতাঃ ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

vṛndāvanaṁ divya-latā-parītaṁ
Vṛndāvana by divine creepers surrounded
latāś ca puṣpa-sphuritāgra-bhājaḥ
the creepers and with flowers sparkling tips bearing
puṣpāṇi ca sphīta-madhu-vratāni
the flowers and with intoxicated bees (filled)
madhu-vratāś ca śruti-hāri-gītāḥ
the bees and the ear captivating songs (having)

159 "Vṛndāvana is surrounded by divine creepers; the creepers bear tips sparkling with flowers; the flowers are filled with intoxicated bees; and the bees sing songs that captivate the ear." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.24)[24]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Look: this Vṛndāvana is encircled by divine creepers; the tips of the creepers are adorned with flowers; the flowers are full of bees; and the bees are absorbed in songs that captivate the ear."

Anubhāṣya.
(**He śrīdāman**, this very) **vṛndāvanaṁ divya-latā-parītaṁ** (is encircled by divine creepers); **latāḥ ca puṣpa-sphuritāgra-bhājaḥ** (their tips glitter with flowers), **puṣpāṇi ca sphīta-madhu-vratāni** (in them are intoxicated [*sphīta*] bees), **madhu-vratāḥ ca śruti-hāri-gītāḥ** (their song is an elixir for the ears).

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 31)*

ক্বচিদ্ভৃঙ্গীগীতং ক্বচিদনিলভঙ্গীশিশিরতা
ক্বচিদ্বল্লীলাস্যং ক্বচিদমলমল্লীপরিমলঃ ৷
ক্বচিদ্ধারাশালী করকফলপালী-রসভরো
হৃষীকাণাং বৃন্দং প্রমদয়তি বৃন্দাবনমিদম্ ॥ ১৬০ ॥

kvacid bhṛṅgī-gītaṁ kvacid anila-bhaṅgī-śiśiratā
somewhere of bees the song somewhere of the breeze by the softness coolness

kvacid vallī-lāsyaṁ kvacid amala-mallī-parimalaḥ
somewhere of creepers the dance somewhere pure of mallikā the fragrance

kvacid dhārā-śālī karaka-phala-pālī-rasa-bharo
somewhere in streams flowing of pomegranate fruits of rows of juice abundance

hṛṣīkāṇāṁ vṛndaṁ pramadayati vṛndāvanam idam
of the senses all delights Vṛndāvana this

160 “Here the bees are singing, there it is cool with the soft breeze; here the creepers dance, there drifts the pure fragrance of *mallikā* flowers; and there the juice of rows of pomegranates flows in streams. This Vṛndāvana delights all the senses.” (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.31)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“Friend, this Vṛndāvana delights our senses in every way: in one place the bees sing, in another it is cool with the gentle Malaya breeze, in another the creepers dance, in another flows the pure fragrance of *mallikā* flowers, and in another the pomegranates, overflowing with juice, let it run in streams.”

Anubhāṣya.

He madhumaṅgala, **idam vṛndāvanam hṛṣīkāṇāṁ** (of the eyes, ears, nose, tongue, skin, and the other senses) **vṛndaṁ** (all together) **pramadayati** (delights) — thus: (to delight the ears) **kvacit bhṛṅgī-gītaṁ** (in one place the song of the bees); (to please the sense of touch) **kvacit anila-bhaṅgī-śiśiratā** (*anila*, the wind, *bhaṅgī*, its gentleness, and from that *śiśiratā*, coolness — that is, the coolness of a gentle breeze); (to delight the eyes) **kvacit vallī-lāsyaṁ** (the dance of the creepers); (to delight the sense of smell) **kvacit amala-mallī-parimalaḥ** (*parimalaḥ*, the fragrance, of *mallī*, the *mallikā*, *amalaḥ*, pure, unmixed); (to please the tongue) **kvacit dhārā-śālī** (arranged row upon row) **karaka-phala-pālī-rasa-bharaḥ** (*karaka-phala-pālī*, rows of pomegranates, *rasa-bharaḥ*, the abundance of their juice).

*An example [of the description] of the *muralī*, the flute —*

পরামৃষ্টাঙ্গুষ্ঠত্রয়মসিতরত্নৈরুভয়তো
বহন্তী সংকীর্ণৌ মণিভিররুণৈস্তৎপরিসরৌ ।
তয়োর্মধ্যে হীরোজ্জ্বলবিমল-জাম্বূনদময়ী
করে কল্যাণীয়ং বিহরতি হরেঃ কেলিমুরলী ॥ ১৬১ ॥

parāmṛṣṭāṅguṣṭha-trayam asita-ratnair ubhayato
covered three thumb-breadths with dark gems at both ends
vahantī saṁkīrṇau maṇibhir aruṇais tat-parisarau
bearing inlaid with gems red the adjoining parts
tayor madhye hīrojjvala-vimala-jāmbūnada-mayī
of them in the middle with diamonds shining of pure gold made
kare kalyāṇīyaṁ viharati hareḥ keli-muralī
in the hand auspicious this sports of Hari for play the flute

161 "At both ends, for the breadth of three thumbs, it is inlaid with sapphires; the parts beside them are set with rubies; and between them it is made of pure gold, shining with diamonds. This auspicious flute of Hari's play sports in His hand." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 3.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Inlaid with sapphires (*indranīla*) for three fingers' length at each end, adorned with rubies (*aruṇa-maṇi*) for the same length, and in between made of pure gold and glittering with diamonds — this auspicious flute of Kṛṣṇa's play sports in Kṛṣṇa's hand."

Anubhāṣya.
Ubhayataḥ (at both ends — at the head and at the tail of the flute) **aṅguṣṭha-trayam** (over a span three thumbs wide) **asita-ratnaiḥ** (with sapphires, *indranīlas*) **parāmṛṣṭā** (covered, inlaid), **aruṇaiḥ maṇibhiḥ** (with rubies) **saṅkīrṇau** (inlaid) **tat-parisarau** (the two adjoining spans, also three thumbs each, at the head and at the tail) **vahantī** (bearing), **tayoḥ** (of these two spans) **madhye** (in the middle) **hīrojjvala-vimala-jāmbūnada-mayī** (made of pure gold [*jāmbūnada*] brightly glittering with diamonds), **iyaṁ kalyāṇī** (full of auspiciousness) **keli-muralī** (Kṛṣṇa's flute of play) **hareḥ** (Kṛṣṇa's) **kare** (in the hand) **viharati** (sports).

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 5, verse 17)*

সদ্বংশতস্তব জনিঃ পুরুষোত্তমস্য
পাণৌ স্থিতির্মুরলিকে সরলাসি জাত্যা ।
কস্মাত্ত্বয়া সখি গুরোর্বিষমা গৃহীতা
গোপাঙ্গনাগণবিমোহনমন্ত্রদীক্ষা ॥ ১৬২ ॥

sad-vaṁśatas tava janiḥ puruṣottamasya
from a good bamboo (family) your birth of Puruṣottama
pāṇau sthitir muralike saralāsi jātyā
in the hand your dwelling O flute straight you are by birth
kasmāt tvayā sakhi guror viṣamā gṛhītā
from what by you O friend guru crooked received
gopāṅganā-gaṇa-vimohana-mantra-dīkṣā
the gopīs crowd bewildering in the mantra initiation

162 "O flute, you were born of good bamboo — of a good family; you dwell in the hand of Puruṣottama; and you are straight by birth. Then from what guru, friend, did you receive this crooked initiation into the mantra that bewilders all the gopīs?" (Vidagdha-mādhava, 5.17)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Sakhī Muralī, you were born of a good bamboo, you dwell in the hand of Puruṣottama, and you are straight by birth. Why, then, have you taken initiation into such an especially grave (*viṣama*, 'crooked') mantra, one that bewilders the gopīs?"

Anubhāṣya.

He muralike, **sad-vaṁśataḥ** (from the finest bamboo, that is, from a good family) **tava janiḥ** (you were born); **puruṣottamasya** (Kṛṣṇa's) **pāṇau** (in the hand) **tava sthitiḥ** (you dwell); **jātyā** (by birth) **saralā** (not crooked, straight) **asi** (you are); (**he sakhi**,) **kasmāt guroḥ** (from which guru, by whose grace) **tvayā** (by you) **viṣamā** (not straight, crooked) **gopāṅganā-gaṇa-vimohana-mantra-dīkṣā** (initiation into the mantra that bewilders the gopīs) **gṛhītā** (was received — you have been initiated into a mantra able to steal the gopīs' hearts)?

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 4, verse 7)*

সখি মুরলি বিশালচ্ছিদ্রজালেন পূর্ণা
লঘুরতিকঠিনা ত্বং গ্রন্থিলা নীরসাসি ।
তদপি ভজসি শশ্বচ্চুম্বনানন্দসান্দ্রং
হরিকরপরিরম্ভং কেন পুণ্যোদয়েন ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

sakhi murali viśāla-cchidra-jālena pūrṇā
O friend flute of large holes with a network full
laghur ati-kaṭhinā tvaṁ granthilā nīrasāsi
light very hard you knotty sapless you are
tad api bhajasi śaśvac cumbanānanda-sāndraṁ
that yet you enjoy constantly of kisses with bliss dense
hari-kara-parirambhaṁ kena puṇyodayena
of Hari's hand the embrace by what of merit fruition

163 "Friend flute, you are full of large holes; you are light, very hard, knotty, and sapless. Yet by what fruition of merit do you constantly enjoy the embrace of Hari's hand, dense with the bliss of His kisses?" (Vidagdha-mādhava, 4.7)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Sakhī Muralī, you are full of large holes, light, very hard, dry, and knotty. By what pious merit, then, does Kṛṣṇa unceasingly embrace you with His hand — an embrace dense with the bliss of kissing His lips?"

Anubhāṣya.

He sakhi murali, **tvaṁ viśāla-cchidra-jālena** (with a mass of great flaws) **pūrṇā** (are filled), **laghuḥ** (light, without dignity), **ati-kaṭhinā** (cruel by nature), **granthilā** (you undo the knots of the sashes [*nīvi*]), **nīrasā** (dry) **ca asi**; **tad api** (and yet) **kena puṇyodayena** (by what previous pious merit) **śaśvat** (unceasingly) **cumbanānanda-sāndraṁ** (dense with the happiness born of a kiss) **hari-kara-parirambhaṁ** (the embrace of Kṛṣṇa's hand) **bhajasi** (do you obtain)?

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 27)*

রুন্ধন্নম্বুভৃতশ্চমৎকৃতিপরং কুর্ব্বন্মুহুস্তুম্বুরুং
ধ্যানাদন্তরয়ন্ সনন্দনমুখান্ বিস্মাপয়ন্ বেধসম্ ৷
ঔৎসুক্যাবলিভির্ব্বলিং চটুলয়ন্ ভোগীন্দ্রমাঘূর্ণয়ন্
ভিন্দন্নণ্ডকটাহভিত্তিমভিতো বভ্রাম বংশীধ্বনিঃ ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

rundhann ambu-bhṛtaś camatkṛti-paraṁ kurvan muhus tumburuṁ
stopping the clouds filled with wonder making again and again Tumburu

dhyānād antarayan sanandana-mukhān vismāpayan vedhasam
from meditation drawing away Sanandana and others astonishing Brahmā

autsukyāvalibhir baliṁ caṭulayan bhogīndram āghūrṇayan
with waves of eagerness Bali agitating the king of serpents making spin

bhindann aṇḍa-kaṭāha-bhittim abhito babhrāma vaṁśī-dhvaniḥ
piercing of the universe's shell the wall all around wandered of the flute the sound

164 "The sound of the flute stopped the clouds, filled Tumburu with wonder again and again, drew Sanandana and the other sages away from their meditation, and astonished Brahmā; it stirred Bali with waves of eagerness, set the king of serpents spinning, pierced the wall of the shell of the universe, and spread in all directions." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.27)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The sound of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's flute stopped the movement of the clouds, struck Tumburu and the other Gandharvas with wonder, broke the meditation of Sanandana and the other sages, astonished Brahmā, stirred the composed (that is, unshakable and unmoving) King Bali with impatient longing, set Ananta, the king of serpents who holds up the earth, spinning, pierced the walls of the shell of the universe — and spread in all directions.

Anubhāṣya.

Vaṁśī-dhvaniḥ (the sound of Kṛṣṇa's flute) **ambu-bhṛtaḥ** (the clouds) **rundhan** (stopping), **tumburuṁ** (the king of the Gandharvas) **muhuḥ** (again and again) **camatkṛti-paraṁ** (filled with wonder) **kurvan** (making), **sanandana-mukhān** (the sages headed by the four Sanas, absorbed in knowledge of Brahman) **dhyānāt**

antarayan (making them abandon their meditation), **vedhasam** (Brahmā) **vismāpayan** (astonishing), **autsukyāvalibhiḥ** (with heaps of eager, curious delight) **baliṁ caṭulayan** (making Bali restless), **bhogīndram** (the king of the Nāgas, Śeṣa) **āghūrṇayan** (setting spinning), **aṇḍa-kaṭāha-bhittim** (the covering of the universe) **bhindan** (piercing), **abhitaḥ** (in all directions, everywhere) **babhrāma** (spread).

An example [of the description] of Śrī Kṛṣṇa —

অয়ং নয়নদণ্ডিতপ্রবরপুণ্ডরীকপ্রভঃ
প্রভাতি নবজাগুড়-দ্যুতিবিড়ম্বিপীতাম্বরঃ ।
অরণ্যজপরিষ্ক্রিয়া-দমিতদিব্যবেশাদরো
হরিন্মণিমনোহরদ্যুতিভিরুজ্জ্বলাঙ্গো হরিঃ ॥ ১৬৫ ॥

ayaṁ nayana-daṇḍita-pravara-puṇḍarīka-prabhaḥ
this by His eyes having humbled of the finest white lotus the lustre
prabhāti nava-jāguḍa-dyuti-viḍambi-pītāmbaraḥ
shines of fresh kuṅkuma the glow mocking in yellow garments
araṇyaja-pariṣkriyā-damita-divya-veśādaro
with forest-born adornments having subdued for divine dress the regard
harin-maṇi-manohara-dyutibhir ujjvalāṅgo hariḥ
of an emerald with captivating lustre radiant in body Hari

165 "Here is Hari, shining: the beauty of His eyes has humbled the lustre of the finest white lotus; His yellow garments mock the glow of fresh *kuṅkuma*; His forest adornments have subdued all regard for divine dress; and His body is radiant with a lustre more captivating than an emerald." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.17)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By the beauty of His eyes this Kṛṣṇa has stolen the luster of the finest white lotus. His yellow garments, which outshine the glow of fresh *kuṅkuma*, sparkle. By His forest dress, ornaments, and the like He has taken away all regard for divine attire. So the radiant Kṛṣṇacandra shines, with a luster more enchanting than a sapphire (*indranīla*).

Anubhāṣya.

Ayaṁ hariḥ (this Hari), **nayana-daṇḍita-pravara-puṇḍarīka-prabhaḥ** (He who by the beauty of His eyes has punished and subdued the luster — the beauty — of the finest *puṇḍarīka*, the full-blown white lotus), **nava-jāguḍa-dyuti-viḍambi-pītāmbaraḥ** (He whose yellow garment seems accustomed to mock the luster — the glow — of fresh *kuṅkuma*), **araṇyaja-pariṣkriyā-damita-divya-veśādaraḥ** (He who with forest-born ornaments has overcome all fondness for divine attire), **harin-maṇi-manohara-dyutibhiḥ** (with a luster as enchanting as an emerald) **ujjvalāṅgaḥ** (He whose body is radiant), **prabhāti** (shines).

*(*Lalita-mādhava*, Act 4, verse 27)*

জঙ্ঘাধস্তটসঙ্গিদক্ষিণপদং কিঞ্চিদ্বিভুগ্নত্রিকং
সাচিস্তম্ভিতকন্ধরং সখি তিরঃসঞ্চারিনেত্রাঞ্চলম্ ।
বংশীং কুট্মলিতে দধানমধরে লোলাঙ্গুলী-সঙ্গতাং
বিভ্রৎভ্রূভ্রমরং বরাঙ্গি পরমানন্দং পুরঃ স্বীকুরু ॥ ১৬৬ ॥

jaṅghādhas-taṭa-saṅgi-dakṣiṇa-padaṁ kiñcid vibhugna-trikaṁ
of the shin at the lower part resting right foot slightly bent waist
sāci-stambhita-kandharaṁ sakhi tiraḥ-sañcāri-netrāñcalam
sideways held still neck O friend sidelong moving eyes' corners
vaṁśīṁ kuṭmalite dadhānam adhare lolāṅgulī-saṅgatāṁ
the flute on budlike holding on the lips by restless fingers touched
vibhrad-bhrū-bhramaraṁ varāṅgi paramānandaṁ puraḥ svī-kuru
bearing brow-bees O beautiful one supreme bliss before you accept

166 "Friend, O beautiful one, accept Him who stands before You, the supreme bliss: His right foot rests against His lower shin, His waist is slightly bent, His neck is turned to the side and held still, the corners of His eyes glance sidelong; on His budlike lips He holds the flute, touched by His restless fingers, and His brows are like bees." (Lalita-mādhava, 4.27)[25]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Sakhī, O beautiful one! His right foot rests below His left shin, His waist is slightly bent in three places, His neck is turned to the side and held still, the corners of His eyes are crooked; to His slightly closed, budlike lips He holds the flute,

touched by His restless fingers, and His lotus face is adorned with brows like bees. Accept Him, full of supreme bliss, who stands before you."

Anubhāṣya.

He sakhi, **he varāṅgi** (O beautiful one), **puraḥ** (Him who stands before you), **jaṅghādhas-taṭa-saṅgi-dakṣiṇa-padaṁ** (Him whose right foot — the edge of the right foot — touches the lower part of the left shin), **kiñcid-vibhugna-trikaṁ** (Him whose waist [*trika*] is slightly bent), **sāci-stambhita-kandharaṁ** (Him whose neck [*kandharā*] is turned to the side and held motionless), **tiraḥ-sañcāri-netrāñcalam** (Him the corners of whose eyes are wont to glide sideways), **kuṭmalite** (closed like a bud) **adhare** (at the lips) **lolāṅgulī-saṅgatāṁ** (touched by restless, moving fingers) **vaṁśīṁ** (the flute) **dadhānam** (holding), **vibhrad-bhrū-bhramaraṁ** (Him whose brows are like two hovering bees), **paramānandaṁ** (Mādhava) **svī-kuru** (accept).

*(*Lalita-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 52)*

কুলবরতনুধর্ম্মগ্রাববৃন্দানি ভিন্দন্
সুমুখি নিশিতদীর্ঘাপাঙ্গটঙ্কচ্ছটাভিঃ ।
যুগপদয়মপূর্ব্বঃ কঃ পুরো বিশ্বকর্ম্মা
মরকতমণিলক্ষৈর্গোষ্ঠকক্ষাং চিনোতি ॥ ১৬৭ ॥

kula-vara-tanu-dharma-grāva-vṛndāni bhindan
of noble women of dharma stones heaps splitting
su-mukhi niśita-dīrghāpāṅga-ṭaṅka-cchaṭābhiḥ
O fair-faced one sharp of long sidelong glances of the chisel with flashes
yugapad ayam apūrvaḥ kaḥ puro viśvakarmā
at the same time this unprecedented what before us Viśvakarmā
marakata-maṇi-lakṣair goṣṭha-kakṣāṁ cinoti
of emerald gems with hundreds of thousands in the cowherd village chambers builds

167 "O fair-faced one, what unprecedented Viśvakarmā is this before us? With the flashing chisel of His long, sharp sidelong glances He splits the piled-up stones of noble women's dharma, and at the same time, with countless emeralds, builds chambers in the cowherd village." (Lalita-mādhava, 1.52)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"O fair-faced one, what Viśvakarmā is this standing before us? With the flashing, sharp, long chisel of His sidelong glances He splits the stones of the *svadharma* of noble wives, and at the same time builds chambers in the cowherd village out of His own beautiful dark form, which is like countless emeralds."

Anubhāṣya.

He su-mukhi (O fair-faced one), **puraḥ** (before us) **ayam apūrvaḥ** (never seen or heard of before) **kaḥ viśvakarmā** (what Viśvakarmā is this)? — **yaḥ** (He who) **yugapat** (at the same time) **niśita-dīrghāpāṅga-ṭaṅka-cchaṭābhiḥ** (*niśita*, sharpened; the long sidelong glance itself is the *ṭaṅka*, a special tool for splitting stone; *cchaṭābhiḥ*, with its flashes, its gleams) **kula-vara-tanu-dharma-grāva-vṛndāni** (the *dharmas* of noble wives — fidelity to a husband and the rest — which are heaps of stone) **bhindan** (splitting), **marakata-maṇi-lakṣaiḥ** (with hundreds of thousands of emeralds, that is, with forms full of dark beauty that one takes for emeralds) **goṣṭha-kakṣāṁ** (the cowherd village) **cinoti** (builds, that is, fills; in this verse Rādhā is amazed to see such qualities of Śrī Kṛṣṇa as His artfulness and beauty).

*(*Lalita-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 49)*

মহেন্দ্রমণিমণ্ডলীমদবিড়ম্বিদেহদ্যুতি-
ব্রজেন্দ্রকুলচন্দ্রমাঃ স্ফুরতি কোঽপি নব্যো যুবা ।
সখি স্থিরকুলাঙ্গনা নিকর-নীবি-বন্ধার্গল-
চ্ছিদাকরণ-কৌতুকী জয়তি যস্য বংশীধ্বনিঃ ॥ ১৬৮ ॥

mahendra-maṇi-maṇḍalī-mada-viḍambi-deha-dyutir
of great sapphires of clusters the pride mocking of body the lustre
vrajendra-kula-candramāḥ sphurati ko 'pi navyo yuvā
of the king of Vraja of the dynasty the moon shines some new youth
sakhi sthira-kulāṅganā-nikara-nīvi-bandhārgala-
O friend of steadfast noble women of crowds of sashes of the knots the bolts
cchidā-karaṇa-kautukī jayati yasya vaṁśī-dhvaniḥ
breaking delighting in is victorious whose of the flute the sound

168 "Friend, a certain fresh youth is shining — the moon of the dynasty of the king of Vraja, the lustre of whose body mocks the pride of clusters of

great sapphires. Glory to the sound of His flute, which delights in breaking the bolts of the knotted sashes of crowds of steadfast noble women!" (Lalita-mādhava, 1.49)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Sakhī, a youth in the freshness of youth has appeared — the moon of the dynasty of the king of Vraja; the luster of His body crushes the pride of clusters of great sapphires. Glory to the sound of His flute, which playfully breaks the knots of the sashes of steadfast noble wives!"

Anubhāṣya.

He sakhi, **yasya** (He whose) **sthira-kulāṅganā-nikara-nīvi-bandhārgala-cchidā-karaṇa-kautukī** (for the many steadfast noble wives, the chaste women, the very knot of the sash [*nīvi*] serves as a bolt, a bar, or an obstacle, and this sound delights in cutting that bolt, in breaking those bonds) **vaṁśī-dhvaniḥ** (the sound of the flute) **jayati** (is supreme), **saḥ** (He) **mahendra-maṇi-maṇḍalī-mada-viḍambi-deha-dyutiḥ** (He the luster, the radiance, of whose body seems accustomed to mock the pride of clusters of great sapphires), **kaḥ api navyaḥ yuvā** (a certain youth in the freshness of youth), **vrajendra-kula-candramāḥ** (the moon of Nanda's dynasty), **sphurati** (shines).

Anubhāṣya.

In some manuscripts the three verses 166–168 are not given. For Śrī Rūpa was describing the *Vidagdha-mādhava*, and describing the *Lalita-mādhava* was neither timely nor relevant for him: as is known, he receives Śrī Rāmānanda's instruction to describe the *Lalita-mādhava* only further on, in verse 172.

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 32)*

বলাদক্ষ্ণোর্লক্ষ্মীঃ কবলয়তি নব্যং কুবলয়ং
মুখোল্লাসঃ ফুল্লং কমলবনমুল্লঙ্ঘয়তি চ ৷
দশাং কষ্টামষ্টাপদমপি নয়ত্যাঙ্গিকরুচি
র্বিচিত্রং রাধায়াঃ কিমপি কিল রূপং বিলসতি ॥ ১৬৯ ॥

balād akṣṇor lakṣmīḥ kavalayati navyaṁ kuvalayaṁ
by force of the eyes the beauty swallows fresh blue lotus
mukhollāsaḥ phullaṁ kamala-vanam ullaṅghayati ca
of the face the radiance blooming of lotuses forest surpasses and
daśāṁ kaṣṭām aṣṭāpadam api nayaty āṅgika-rucir
into a state painful gold even brings of the body the lustre
vicitraṁ rādhāyāḥ kim api kila rūpaṁ vilasati
wondrous Rādhā's some indeed beauty plays

169 "The beauty of Her eyes forcibly swallows the fresh blue lotus; the radiance of Her face surpasses a forest of blooming lotuses; the lustre of Her body brings even gold to a sorry plight. Indescribable and wondrous, the beauty of Rādhā is at play here." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 1.32)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The beauty of Her eyes forcibly swallows the beauty of a newly blossomed blue lotus; the joy shining on Her blooming face surpasses a forest of lotuses; the luster of Her body plunges even beautiful gold into distress. So wondrously does Śrī Rādhikā's beauty play, that is, manifest itself.

Anubhāṣya.

(Śrī Rādhā's) **akṣṇoḥ** (eyes') **lakṣmīḥ** (beauty) **navyaṁ** (newly blossomed) **kuvalayaṁ** (the blue lotus) **balāt kavalayati** (forcibly swallows), **mukhollāsaḥ** (the beauty of Her face) **phullaṁ** (blossomed) **kamala-vanam** (forest of lotuses) **ullaṅghayati** (surpasses, sets aside), **āṅgika-rucih** (the luster of Her body) **aṣṭāpadam** (gold) **api kaṣṭāṁ** (full of distress) **daśāṁ** (into a state) **nayati** (brings); (therefore) **rādhāyāḥ rūpaṁ** (Rādhā's beauty) **kila kim api vicitraṁ** (truly something wondrous) **vilasati** (shines).

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 5, verse 20)*

বিধুরেতি দিবা বিরূপতাং
শতপত্রং বত শর্ব্বরীমুখে ৷
ইতি কেন সদাশ্রিয়োজ্জ্বলং
তুলনামর্হতি মৎপ্রিয়াননম্ ॥ ১৭০ ॥

vidhur eti divā virūpatāṁ śata-patraṁ bata śarvarī-mukhe
the moon attains by day loss of beauty the lotus alas of night at the onset
iti kena sadā śriyojjvalaṁ tulanām arhati mat-priyānanam
so with what always with beauty shining comparison deserves of My beloved the face

170 "Alas, the moon loses its beauty by day, and the lotus at nightfall. With what, then, can the face of My beloved, always shining with beauty, be compared?" (Vidagdha-mādhava, 5.20)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The beauty of the moon, though lovely at night, fades by day; and the lotus, though lovely by day, grows dim (closes) at night. But, friend, the face of My beloved Rādhikā always, day and night, shines with beauty. With what, then, can it be compared?"

Anubhāṣya.
Vidhuḥ (the moon) **divā** (by day), **śata-patraṁ** (the lotus) **śarvarī-mukhe** (in the evening) **bata** (alas) **virūpatāṁ** (loss of luster) **eti** (attain); **iti** (thus) **sadā** (always, day and night) **śriyā** (with beauty) **ujjvalam** (shining) **mat-priyānanam** (Śrī Rādhikā's face) **kena** (with what object of comparison) **tulanāṁ na arhati**[35] (does it not bear comparison — that is, it can be compared with nothing)?

*(*Vidagdha-mādhava*, Act 2, verse 5)*

প্রমদরসতরঙ্গস্মেরগণ্ডস্থলায়াঃ
স্মরধনুরনুবন্ধিভ্রূলতা-লাস্যভাজঃ ।
মদকলচলভৃঙ্গীভ্রান্তিভঙ্গীং দধানো
হৃদয়মিদমদাঙ্ক্ষীৎ পক্ষ্মলাক্ষ্যাঃ কটাক্ষঃ ॥ ১৭১ ॥

pramada-rasa-taraṅga-smera-gaṇḍa-sthalāyāḥ
of joy of rasa with waves smiling whose cheeks
smara-dhanur anubandhi-bhrū-latā-lāsya-bhājaḥ
Kāma's bow resembling of brow-creepers dance having
mada-kala-cala-bhṛṅgī-bhrānti-bhaṅgīṁ dadhāno
intoxicated humming darting of a bee of resemblance the charm bearing
hṛdayam idam adāṅkṣīt pakṣmalākṣyāḥ kaṭākṣaḥ
heart this has stung of the one with lovely lashes the sidelong glance

171 "Her cheeks smile with waves of the rasa of joy, and Her creeper-brows dance like Kāma's bow. The sidelong glance of that girl with lovely lashes, charming as an intoxicated, softly humming, darting bee, has stung this heart of Mine." (Vidagdha-mādhava, 2.5)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Her cheeks, with a gentle, gentle smile, are stirred by waves of the *rasa* of joy; Her creeper-brows dance like the bow of Kāma, resembling a bee that darts about in intoxicated abandon. And the glance that flew from Her lashes has stung My heart."

Anubhāṣya.

Pramada-rasa-taraṅga-smera-gaṇḍa-sthalāyāḥ (of Her whose cheeks smile — touched with a gentle smile — from the waves of the *rasa* of joy, the flow of the *rasa* of bliss), **smara-dhanur-anubandhi-bhrū-latā-lāsya-bhājaḥ** (of Her whose creeper-brows, like the bow of Kāmadeva, perform a dance [*lāsya*]), **pakṣmalākṣyāḥ** (of Rādhā, whose eyes are graced with lovely lashes), **mada-kala-cala-bhṛṅgī-bhrānti-bhaṅgīṁ** (such a charm [*bhaṅgī*] that one mistakes [*bhrānti*] it for a bee darting, restless and fickle with intoxicated humming [*kala*]) **dadhānaḥ** (bearing), (Rādhā's) **kaṭākṣaḥ** (glance) **idam** (this, My) **hṛdayam** (heart) **adāṅkṣīt** (has stung).

*Rāya asks Śrī Rūpa to recite the *nāndī* of the *Lalita-mādhava* —*

রায় কহে, — "তোমার কবিত্ব অমৃতের ধার ।
দ্বিতীয় নাটকের কহ নান্দী-ব্যবহার" ॥ ১৭২ ॥

rāya kahe, — tomāra kavitva amṛtera dhāra
Rāya says your poetry of nectar a stream
dvitīya nāṭakera kaha nāndī-vyavahāra
of the second play tell of the nāndī the use

172 Rāya said, “Your poetry is a stream of nectar. Now tell us the *nāndī* of the second play.”

Anubhāṣya.
Of the second drama: that is, of the drama *Lalita-mādhava*. From here on Śrī Rāmānanda asks about the *Śrī Lalita-mādhava* composed by Śrī Rūpa.

Comparing himself with Rāya's greatness, Śrī Rūpa expresses his humility —

রূপ কহে, — “কাঁহা তুমি সূর্য্যোপম ভাস ।
মুঞি কোন্ ক্ষুদ্র, — যেন খদ্যোত-প্রকাশ ॥ ১৭৩ ॥

rūpa kahe, — kāṁhā tumi sūryopama bhāsa
Rūpa says where you like the sun in radiance
muñi kon kṣudra, — yena khadyota-prakāśa
I what insignificant one like of a firefly the glimmer

173 Rūpa said, “Where are you, radiant like the sun, and what am I? An insignificant creature, like the glimmer of a firefly.

তোমার আগে ধার্ষ্ট্য এই মুখ-ব্যাদান” ।
এত বলি’ নান্দী-শ্লোক করিলা ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ১৭৪ ॥

tomāra āge dhārṣṭya ei mukha-vyādāna
you before impudence this of the mouth the opening
eta bali’ nāndī-śloka karilā vyākhyāna
this saying the nāndī verse made recitation

174 Even to open my mouth before you is impudence.” Saying this, he recited the *nāndī* verse:

*In the opening verse (*maṅgalācaraṇa*), praise of the fame of Mukunda, who*

crushes the asuras and gladdens the gods —

সুররিপুসুদৃশামুরোজকোকা-
ন্মুখকমলানি চ খেদয়ন্নখণ্ডঃ ।
চিরমখিলসুহৃচ্চকোরনন্দী
দিশতু মুকুন্দযশঃশশী মুদং বঃ ॥ ১৭৫ ॥

sura-ripu-sudṛśām uroja-kokān
of the enemies of the gods of the fair-eyed wives the breast-cakravākas
mukha-kamalāni ca khedayann akhaṇḍaḥ
the face-lotuses and saddening full
ciram akhila-suhṛc-cakora-nandī
forever of all friends the cakoras delighting
diśatu mukunda-yaśaḥ-śaśī mudaṁ vaḥ
may it give of Mukunda of the fame the moon joy to you

175 "May the full moon of Mukunda's fame give you joy — the moon that saddens the *cakravāka* birds, the breasts of the fair-eyed wives of the gods' enemies, and the lotuses, their faces, while it forever delights the *cakora* birds, all His friends." (Lalita-mādhava, 1.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *cakravāka* birds — the breasts of the wives of the enemies of the gods — and the lotuses — their faces — the moon of Mukunda's fame casts into dejection, into sorrow, while it forever delights the *cakora* birds — all His friends. May that full moon of Mukunda's fame give you happiness.

Anubhāṣya.
Sura-ripu-sudṛśām (of the wives of Naraka and the other asuras) **uroja-kokān** (the *kokas*, *cakravākas*, that are their breasts) **mukha-kamalāni ca** (and the lotuses that are their faces) **khedayan** (casting into dejection), **akhila-suhṛc-cakora-nandī** (He who is wont to delight the *cakoras* — all His friends), **akhaṇḍaḥ** (full) **mukunda-yaśaḥ-śaśī** (the moon that is Mukunda's fame) **vaḥ** (you) **mudaṁ** (happiness) **ciram** (for long) **diśatu** (may it give).

Rāya asks Śrī Rūpa to describe his own worshipful Lord; Śrī Rūpa's

embarrassment —

'দ্বিতীয় নান্দী কহ দেখি?' — রায় পুছিলা ।
সঙ্কোচ পাঞা রূপ কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ১৭৬ ॥

dvitīya nāndī kaha dekhi? — rāya puchilā
the second nāndī tell let us see Rāya asked
saṅkoca pāñā rūpa kahite lāgilā
hesitation feeling Rūpa to speak began

176 Rāya asked, "Now recite the second *nāndī*." Feeling hesitant, Rūpa began to recite:

A prayer for blessings to his worshipful Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya —

নিজপ্রণয়িতাং সুধামুদয়মাপ্নুবন্ যঃ ক্ষিতৌ
কিরত্যলমুরীকৃতদ্বিজকুলাধিরাজস্থিতিঃ ।
স লুঞ্চিত-তমস্ততির্মম শচীসুতাখ্যঃ শশী
বশীকৃতজগন্মনাঃ কিমপি শর্ম্ম বিন্যস্যতু ॥ ১৭৭ ॥

nija-praṇayitāṁ sudhām udayam āpnuvan yaḥ kṣitau
for Himself of love the nectar rising having attained who on earth
kiraty alam urī-kṛta-dvija-kulādhirāja-sthitiḥ
pours out abundantly having accepted of the twice-born the race of the supreme king the position
sa luñchita-tamas-tatir mama śacī-sutākhyaḥ śaśī
that dispelling of darkness the mass to me Śacī's son named the moon
vaśī-kṛta-jagan-manāḥ kim api śarma vinyasyatu
having won of the world the minds some blessing may He bestow

177 "Rising over the earth, He pours out abundantly the nectar of love for Himself; He reigns as supreme king of the twice-born; He dispels the mass of darkness and has won the minds of the whole world. May that moon, called the son of Śacī, grant me some blessing." (Lalita-mādhava, 1.3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rising over the earth, He pours out the nectar of the *rasa* of love for Himself; He has accepted the position of supreme king of the twice-born; He dispels the

darkness; He wins the minds of the whole world. May that moon named Śacīnandana grant me auspiciousness.

Anubhāṣya.

Yaḥ (He who), **kṣitau** (on the earth) **udayam** (appearance) **āpnuvan** (having attained), **nija-praṇayitāṁ sudhām** (the nectar of love for Himself) **alam** (abundantly) **kirati** (pours out), **urī-kṛta-dvija-kulādhirāja-sthitiḥ** (He by whom the position — the dignity of sovereignty — of supreme king of the twice-born has been accepted), **luñcita-tamas-tatiḥ** (He by whom the mass of darkness — the heap of the deceit of ignorance — has been plundered and driven away), **vaśī-kṛta-jagan-manāḥ** (He by whom the minds of the worlds have been won), **śacī-sutākhyaḥ** (named Śacīnandana) **saḥ śaśī** (that moon) **mama** (to me) **kim api śarma** (some auspiciousness) **vinyasyatu** (may He grant).

In His heart the Lord is pleased, but outwardly He makes a show of anger —

শুনিয়া প্রভুর যদি অন্তরে উল্লাস ।
বাহিরে কহেন কিছু করি' রোষাভাস ॥ ১৭৮ ॥

śuniyā prabhura yadi antare ullāsa
hearing of the Lord though within joy
bāhire kahena kichu kari' roṣābhāsa
outwardly He says something showing a semblance of anger

178 On hearing it, the Lord felt joy within, yet outwardly, with a show of anger, He said:

"কাঁহা তোমার কৃষ্ণরসবাক্য-সুধাসিন্ধু ।
তার মধ্যে মিথ্যা কেনে স্তুতি-ক্ষারবিন্দু ?" ॥ ১৭৯ ॥

kāṁhā tomāra kṛṣṇa-rasa-vākya-sudhā-sindhu
where your of Kṛṣṇa's rasa of words of nectar the ocean
tāra madhye mithyā kene stuti-kṣāra-bindu
of that in the midst false why of praise of alkali a drop

179 "Your words about the rasa of Kṛṣṇa are an ocean of nectar. Why have you mixed into it a drop of alkali — this false praise?"[26]

Rāya praises the verse —

রায় কহে, — “রূপের কাব্য অমৃতের পূর ।
তার মধ্যে এক বিন্দু দিয়াছে কর্পূর” ॥ ১৮০ ॥

rāya kahe, — rūpera kāvya amṛtera pūra
Rāya says Rūpa’s poetry of nectar a flood
tāra madhye eka bindu diyāche karpūra
of that in the midst one drop he has put of camphor

180 Rāya said, “Rūpa’s poetry is a flood of nectar, and into it he has put a drop of camphor.”

প্রভু কহে, — “রায়, তোমার ইহাতে উল্লাস ।
শুনিতেই লজ্জা, লোকে করে উপহাস” ॥ ১৮১ ॥

prabhu kahe, — rāya, tomāra ihāte ullāsa
the Lord says Rāya your in this joy
śunitei lajjā, loke kare upahāsa
even to hear shame people make mockery

181 The Lord said, “Rāya, you are delighted by this, but I am ashamed even to hear it, and people will laugh.”

রায় কহে, — “লোকের সুখ ইহার শ্রবণে ।
অভীষ্ট-দেবের স্মৃতি মঙ্গলাচরণে” ॥ ১৮২ ॥

rāya kahe, — lokera sukha ihāra śravaṇe
Rāya says people’s happiness of this in the hearing
abhīṣṭa-devera smṛti maṅgalācaraṇe
of the cherished Deity remembrance in the auspicious invocation

182 Rāya said, “People are happy to hear it, for an auspicious invocation is the remembrance of one’s cherished Deity.”

*Rāya asks about the parts of the *Lalita-mādhava* and how its characters are*

introduced; Śrī Rūpa answers by quoting verses from his drama —

রায় কহে, — "কোন্ অঙ্গে পাত্রের প্রবেশ ?"
তবে রূপ-গোসাঞি কহে তাহার বিশেষ ॥ ১৮৩ ॥

rāya kahe, — kon aṅge pātrera praveśa?
Rāya says in which part the characters' entrance
tabe rūpa-gosāñi kahe tāhāra viśeṣa
then Rūpa Gosāñi tells of that the particulars

183 Rāya asked, "In which part do the characters enter?" Then Rūpa Gosāñi explained the particulars:

Anubhāṣya.

See above (Antya, Chapter 1) verse 134 and its *Anubhāṣya*. By which part of the drama [*aṅga*] is a character introduced? There are five kinds of *prastāvanā* — *udghātyaka*, *kathodghāta*, *prayogātiśaya*, *pravartaka*, and *avalagita* — and three parts of the *bhāratī-vṛtti* — *prarocanā*, *vīthī*, and *prahasana*. Śrī Rāmānanda asks Śrī Rūpa: "In which of these five kinds of *prastāvanā*, and adopting which part of the *bhāratī-vṛtti*, do you bring a character onto the stage in the guise of an actor in your drama?"

*(*Lalita-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 11)*

নটতা কিরাতরাজং নিহত্য রঙ্গস্থলে কলানিধিনা ।
সময়ে তেন বিধেয়ং গুণবতি তারাকরগ্রহণম্ ॥ ১৮৪ ॥

naṭatā kirāta-rājaṁ nihatya raṅga-sthale kalā-nidhinā
dancing of the Kirātas the king having slain on the stage by Kalānidhi
samaye tena vidheyaṁ guṇavati tārā-kara-grahaṇam
in due time by him is to be done virtuous of Tārā of the hand the taking

184 "Kalānidhi (Kṛṣṇa, the moon), dancing on the stage, will slay the king of the Kirātas (Kaṁsa) and at an auspicious time take the hand of Tārā (Rādhā)." (Lalita-mādhava, 1.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Dancing on the stage, Kalānidhi (Kṛṣṇacandra) will destroy Kaṁsa, the king of the Kirātas, and at an auspicious time called "Pūrṇa-manoratha" is to take the hand of

Tārā (Śrī Rādhā).

Anubhāṣya.

Naṭatā (playing a role) **tena kalā-nidhinā** (by the actor named Kalānidhi) **raṅga-sthale** (on the stage) **kirāta-rājaṁ** (the ruler of the land of the Kirātas) **nihatya** (having slain), **guṇavati** (presided over by a favorable constellation) **samaye** (at the time) **tārā-kara-grahaṇam** (marriage to the girl named Tārā) **vidheyam** (is to be performed). In the other sense: **raṅga-sthale** (in the arena) **tena kalā-nidhinā** (by Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the treasury of the sixty-four arts) **kirāta-rājaṁ** (Kaṁsa) **nihatya** (having slain), **guṇavati samaye** (at the time called "Pūrṇa-manoratha," in the tenth act) **tārā-kara-grahaṇam** (marriage to Śrī Rādhikā) **vidheyam** (is to be performed).

In this verse the *āmukha*, that is, the *prastāvanā*, is named — *udghātyaka* — and the part of the *bhāratī-vṛtti* — *vīthī*. The *Sāhitya-darpaṇa* (Chapter 6, no. 520) says: "In a *vīthī* there is one act, and in it some single [hero] is presented. Addressing imagined voices from the sky, he carries on varied speeches and replies, abundantly suggests *śṛṅgāra* and to some extent other *rasas* as well; it has the opening and closing junctures (*mukha* and *nirvahaṇa*) and all the *artha-prakṛtis*." That is, in a *vīthī* there is only one act. In this act some single hero is presented; through voices from the sky he resorts to varied speeches and replies, abundantly suggests *śṛṅgāra-rasa* and to some extent other *rasas* as well; and in its opening (*mukha*) and junctures (*sandhis*) all the *artha-prakṛtis*, that is, the *bīja*, should be employed. Here, if the word *naṭatā* (playing a role) is applied to the moon, the meaning is unclear; therefore it is applied to Kṛṣṇa, and since the meaning thus becomes clear, the *prastāvanā* called *udghātyaka* has been formed. Taking the meaning that relates to Kṛṣṇa, Paurṇamāsī, too, entered the stage.

'উদ্ঘাত্যক' নাম এই 'আমুখ' — 'বীথী' অঙ্গ ।
তোমার আগে কহি — ইহা ধার্ষ্ট্যের তরঙ্গ ॥ ১৮৫ ॥

'udghātyaka' nāma ei 'āmukha' — 'vīthī' aṅga
udghātyaka by name this prologue of the vīthī a part
tomāra āge kahi — ihā dhārṣṭyera taraṅga
you before I speak this of impudence a wave

185 “This prologue is called *udghātyaka*; it is a part of the *vīthī*. To speak of it before you is a wave of impudence.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Rūpa says to Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya: “Before a learned master of the *rasa-śāstra* such as you, every word of mine is like a wave in an ocean of impudence, that is, in a sea of presumption.”

*(*Sāhitya-darpaṇa*, the section on visual poetry [*dṛśya-śravya-nirūpaṇa*], Chapter 6, verse 289)*

পদানি ত্বগতার্থানি তদর্থগতয়ে নরাঃ ।
যোজয়ন্তি পদৈরন্যৈঃ স উদঘাত্যক উচ্যতে ॥ ১৮৬ ॥

padāni tv agatārthāni
words however of unclear meaning
tad-artha-gataye narāḥ
their meaning to grasp people
yojayanti padair anyaiḥ
join with words other
sa udghātyaka ucyate
that udghātyaka is called

186 ‘When people, to grasp the meaning of words whose sense is unclear, join them with other words, it is called *udghātyaka*.’” (Sāhitya-darpaṇa, 6.289)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

When people join words whose meaning is unclear with other words in order to grasp their meaning, this is called *udghātyaka*.

Anubhāṣya.

Narāḥ (experts in poetics) **tu agatārthāni** (whose meaning is not reached, not understood) **padāni** (words) **tad-artha-gataye** (in order to grasp the meaning of those words whose meaning is not understood) **anyaiḥ padaiḥ** (with other words) **yat yojayanti** (join), **saḥ** (that) **udghātyaka** (*udghātyaka*) **ucyate** (is called).

রায় কহে, — “কহ আগে অঙ্গের বিশেষ” ।
শ্রীরূপ কহেন কিছু সংক্ষেপে-উদ্দেশ ॥ ১৮৭ ॥

rāya kahe, — kaha āge aṅgera viśeṣa
Rāya says tell further of the parts the particulars
śrī rūpa kahena kichu saṅkṣepe-uddeśa
Śrī Rūpa tells something in brief indicating

187 Rāya said, “Tell us further about the particular parts.” Śrī Rūpa indicated a few of them briefly:

Anubhāṣya.
“The particulars of the parts”: see above (Antya, Chapter 1) verse 156; that is, as before, the descriptions in order of Vṛndāvana, the sound of the *muralī*, Kṛṣṇa, and Rādhikā.

*(*Lalita-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 23)*

হরিমুদ্দিশতে রজোভরঃ
পুরতঃ সঙ্গময়ত্যমুং তমঃ ।
ব্রজবামদৃশাং ন পদ্ধতিঃ
প্রকটা সর্ব্বদৃশঃ শ্রুতেরপি ॥ ১৮৮ ॥

harim uddiśate rajo-bharaḥ
Hari points to of dust the mass
purataḥ saṅgamayaty amuṁ tamaḥ
ahead unites Him darkness
vraja-vāma-dṛśāṁ na paddhatiḥ
of Vraja of the fair-eyed not the path
prakaṭā sarva-dṛśaḥ śruter api
manifest all-seeing to the Śruti even

188 “The mass of dust points to Hari; the darkness ahead unites Him (with the gopīs). The path of the fair-eyed girls of Vraja is not revealed even to the all-seeing Śruti.” (Lalita-mādhava, 1.23)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The dust raised by the cows' hooves points to Hari; the darkness ahead unites Him with the gopīs. Therefore the path of the cowherd women is beyond the reach even of the all-knowing Śruti.

Anubhāṣya.

Rajaḥ-bharaḥ (the mass, heap, multitude of dust raised by the cows' hooves) **harim uddiśate** (points to Hari), **tamaḥ** (darkness) **purataḥ** (ahead) **amum** (Kṛṣṇa) **saṅgamayati** (unites [with the gopīs]); (therefore) **vraja-vāma-dṛśāṁ** (of the women of Vraja) **paddhatiḥ** (the path) **sarva-dṛśaḥ** (all-seeing) **śruteḥ** (to the Veda) **api** (even) **prakaṭā na** (is not revealed).

The Veda, whose subject is the three *guṇas*, says nothing of how to point to Kṛṣṇa, who is beyond the *guṇas*, or of meeting Him. The conditioned *jīva*, turned away from Kṛṣṇa, is agitated by the *guṇa* of *rajas*, and so has no pointer to Kṛṣṇa; he is covered by the *guṇa* of *tamas*, and so he does not meet Kṛṣṇa. But in the transcendental Vṛndāvana the dust (*rajas*) raised by the cows' hooves points out Kṛṣṇa's coming to the eternally liberated gopīs, and *tamas*, the darkness, lets the eternally liberated gopīs meet Kṛṣṇa. Therefore both the gopīs, whose nature is pure *sattva*, and Śrī Vṛndāvana, whose nature is pure *sattva*, are beyond the reach of the Veda, whose subject is the three *guṇas*. This is the meaning of the verse.

*(*Lalita-mādhava*, Act 1, verse 24)*

ह्रियमवगृह्य गृहेभ्यः कर्षति राधां वनाय या निपुणा ।
सा जयति निसृष्टार्था वरवंशजकाकली दूती ॥ ১৮৯ ॥

hriyam avagṛhya gṛhebhyaḥ karṣati rādhāṁ vanāya yā nipuṇā
shyness overcoming from the house draws Rādhā to the forest who skilful
sā jayati nisṛṣṭārthā vara-vaṁśaja-kākalī dūtī
she is victorious entrusted with the purpose born of the finest bamboo the soft melody the messenger

189 “Glory to that skilful messenger, entrusted with the purpose — the soft melody born of the finest bamboo — who overcomes Rādhā’s shyness and draws Her from home to the forest!” (Lalita-mādhava, 1.24)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Glory to that messenger — the sweet, soft tone (*kākalī*) of the flute born of the finest bamboo! Skillful and entrusted with the purpose, she frees Śrī Rādhā from shyness and draws Her from home into the forest.

Anubhāṣya.

Yā (she who), **hriyam** (shyness) **avagṛhya** (taking away, that is, destroying), **gṛhebhyaḥ** (from home) **vanāya** (to the forest, so that She goes to the forest) **rādhāṁ karṣati** (draws Rādhā), **sā nipuṇā** (skillful) **nisṛṣṭārthā** (bearing the task entrusted to her) **vara-vaṁśaja-kākalī** (the sound of the flute) **dūtī** (messenger) **jayati** (is supreme).

Nisṛṣṭārthā: the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* (section on the kinds of messengers, verse 29) says: "She to whom one of the two has entrusted the task, and who by her skill unites them both, is called *nisṛṣṭārthā*."

*(*Lalita-mādhava*, Act 2, verse 10)*

সহচরি নিরাতঙ্কঃ কোঽয়ং যুবা মুদিরদ্যুতি-
ব্রজভুবি কুতঃ প্রাপ্তো মাদ্যন্মতঙ্গজবিভ্রমঃ ৷
অহহ চটুলৈরুৎসর্পদ্ভির্দৃগঞ্চলতস্করৈ-
র্মম ধৃতিধনং চেতঃকোষাদ্বিলুণ্ঠয়তীহ যঃ ॥ ১৯০ ॥

saha-cari nirātaṅkaḥ ko 'yaṁ yuvā mudira-dyutir
O friend fearless who this youth with the lustre of a cloud

vraja-bhuvi kutaḥ prāpto mādyan mataṅ-gaja-vibhramaḥ
to the land of Vraja from where has come of an intoxicated elephant with the sporting grace

ahaha caṭulair utsarpadbhir dṛg-añcala-taskarair
ah restless stealing forth by the glance-thieves

mama dhṛti-dhanaṁ cetaḥ-koṣād viluṇṭhayatīha yaḥ
My of composure the wealth from the treasury of the heart plunders here who

190 "Friend, who is this fearless youth, with the lustre of a rain cloud and the sporting grace of an intoxicated elephant? From where has He come to the land of Vraja? Ah, with the thieves of His restless, roving glances He is

plundering the wealth of My composure from the treasury of My heart!" (Lalita-mādhava, 2.10)[27]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Friend, who is this fearless youth, shining like a fresh cloud, sporting like an intoxicated elephant? From where has He come to the land of Vraja? Ah, with His restless gait and thieflike glances He is plundering from the treasury of My heart the wealth of My composure!"

Anubhāṣya.

He saha-cari (O friend), **ahaha** (ah!), **iha** (here, in the forest of Vṛndā) **yaḥ** (He who) **caṭulaiḥ** (restless) **utsarpadbhiḥ** (gliding in every direction) **dṛg-añcala-taskaraiḥ** (with the thieves — His sidelong glances) **mama cetaḥ-koṣāt** (from the treasury of My heart) **dhṛti-dhanaṁ** (the wealth that is My composure) **viluṇṭhayati** (plunders) — **mudira-dyutiḥ** (He whose luster is like that of a cloud [*mudira*], shining like a fresh cloud), **mādyan-mataṅ-gaja-vibhramaḥ** (He whose play [*vibhrama*, *vilāsa*] is like an intoxicated elephant's, restless like an elephant deep in intoxication), **nirātaṅkaḥ** (fearless) — **kaḥ ayaṁ yuvā** (who is this youth)? **Kutaḥ** (from where) **ca vraja-bhuvi** (to the land of Vraja) **prāptaḥ** (has He come)?

*(*Lalita-mādhava*, Act 2, verse 10)*[36]

বিহারসুরদীর্ঘিকা মম মনঃকরীন্দ্রস্য যা
বিলোচন-চকোরয়োঃ শরদমন্দচন্দ্রপ্রভা ৷
উরোঽম্বরতটস্য চাভরণচারুতারাবলী
ময়োন্নতমনোরথৈরিয়মলম্ভি সা রাধিকা ॥ ১৯১ ॥

vihāra-sura-dīrghikā mama manaḥ-karīndrasya yā
for sport the celestial river of My mind-king-elephant who
vilocana-cakorayoḥ śarad-amanda-candra-prabhā
for the cakoras of the eyes of autumn bright moon the light
uro 'mbara-taṭasya cābharaṇa-cāru-tārāvalī
of the chest-sky of the edge and ornament lovely string of stars
mayonnata-manorathair iyam alambhi sā rādhikā
by Me through lofty desires this has been attained that Rādhikā

191 “She who is the celestial river in which the king-elephant of My mind sports, the light of the bright autumn moon for the *cakora* birds of My eyes, and a lovely string of stars adorning the sky of My chest — that Rādhikā I have attained through My lofty desires.” (Lalita-mādhava, 2.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

“Rādhikā is, for the king-elephant of My mind, the Gaṅgā in which it sports; for the *cakora* birds of My eyes, the brilliant light of the autumn moon; for the sky of My chest, an ornament like a lovely string of stars. Today I have attained that Rādhikā — and with Her My lofty desires are fulfilled.”

Anubhāṣya.

Yā (She who — Rādhā) **mama manaḥ-karīndrasya** (for the king-elephant of My mind, My heart) **vihāra-sura-dīrghikā** (is the celestial river for its play, the heavenly Gaṅgā), **yā** (She who) **vilocana-cakorayoḥ** (for the two *cakoras* that are My eyes) **śarad-amanda-candra-prabhā** (is the light of the autumn moon, undimmed, that is, full), **yā** (She who) **uraḥ-ambara-taṭasya** (for the edge of the sky that is My chest — the chest itself is the sky) **ca ābharaṇa-cāru-tārāvalī** (is, among ornaments, a lovely string of stars, a constellation), **sā iyaṁ rādhikā** (this Rādhikā) **mayā** (by Me, Kṛṣṇa) **unnata-manorathaiḥ** (through lofty desires — what I had desired for many days) **sāmpratam** (now) **alambhi** (has been attained).

Rāya praises Śrī Rūpa's poetic gift without end, as if with a thousand mouths

—

এত শুনি’ রায় কহে প্রভুর চরণে ।
রূপের কবিত্ব প্রশংসি’ সহস্র-বদনে ॥ ১৯২ ॥

eta śuni’ rāya kahe prabhura caraṇe
this hearing Rāya speaks at the Lord’s feet
rūpera kavitva praśaṁsi’ sahasra-vadane
Rūpa’s poetry praising with a thousand mouths

192 Hearing this, Rāya spoke at the Lord’s feet, praising Rūpa’s poetry as if with a thousand mouths:

“কবিত্ব না হয় এই অমৃতের ধার ।
নাটক-লক্ষণ সব সিদ্ধান্তের সার ॥ ১৯৩ ॥

kavitva nā haya ei amṛtera dhāra
poetry not is this of nectar a stream
nāṭaka-lakṣaṇa saba siddhāntera sāra
of drama the features all of conclusive truths the essence

193 “This is not poetry — it is a stream of nectar. All its dramatic features are the essence of conclusive truth.

প্রেম-পরিপাটী এই অদ্ভুত বর্ণন ।
শুনি’ চিত্ত-কর্ণের হয় আনন্দ-ঘূর্ণন” ॥ ১৯৪ ॥

prema-paripāṭī ei adbhuta varṇana
of love the artful order this wondrous description
śuni’ citta-karṇera haya ānanda-ghūrṇana
hearing of mind and ears there is of bliss whirling

194 This wondrous description is love artfully unfolded; hearing it, the mind and ears whirl in bliss.

(a verse of an ancient author)

কিং কাব্যেন কবেস্তস্য কিং কাণ্ডেন ধনুষ্মতঃ ।
পরস্য হৃদয়ে লগ্নং ন ঘূর্ণয়তি যচ্ছিরঃ ॥ ১৯৫ ॥

kiṁ kāvyena kaves tasya
what use of the poetry of the poet that
kiṁ kāṇḍena dhanuṣ-mataḥ
what use of the arrow of the archer
parasya hṛdaye lagnaṁ
of another in the heart lodged
na ghūrṇayati yac chiraḥ
not makes spin which the head

195 ‘What use is a poet’s poetry or an archer’s arrow which, lodged in another’s heart, does not make his head spin?’ (a verse of an ancient poet)[28]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

If the poet's poetry and the archer's bow, having entered another's heart, cannot make his head spin — what use are they?

Thus ends the first chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

Tasya kaveḥ (of that poet) **kāvyena** (with the poetry, words full of *rasa*) **kim** (what use)? **Dhanuṣ-mataḥ** (of the archer) **kāṇḍena** (with the arrow) **kim** (what use)? — **yat** (if) [the poetry or the arrow], **parasya hṛdaye lagnaṁ** (having pierced another's heart), **tasya śiraḥ** (his head) **na ghūrṇayati** (does not make spin).

[Rāya] infers the Lord's mercy upon Śrī Rūpa —

তোমার শক্তি বিনা জীবের নহে এই বাণী ।
তুমি শক্তি দিয়া কহাও, — হেন অনুমানি ॥ ১৯৬ ॥

tomāra śakti vinā jīvera nahe ei vāṇī
Your power without of a living being is not this speech
tumi śakti diyā kahāo, — hena anumāni
You power giving make him speak so I infer

196 Without Your power, such words could not come from an ordinary soul. I infer that You have given him power and are making him speak."

The Lord praises Śrī Rūpa's poetic gift —

প্রভু কহে, — "প্রয়াগে আমা-সনে হইল মিলন ।
ইঁহার গুণে ইঁহাতে আমার তুষ্ট হৈল মন ॥ ১৯৭ ॥

prabhu kahe, — prayāge āmā-sane haila milana
the Lord says at Prayāga with Me took place meeting
iṁhāra guṇe iṁhāte āmāra tuṣṭa haila mana
his by qualities with him My pleased became mind

197 The Lord said, "He met Me at Prayāga, and his qualities pleased My heart.

মধুর প্রসঙ্গ ইঁহার কাব্য সালঙ্কার ।
ঐছে কবিত্ব বিনা নহে রসের প্রচার ॥ ১৯৮ ॥

madhura prasaṅga iṁhāra kāvya sālaṅkāra
sweet the subject his poetry adorned with ornaments
aiche kavitva vinā nahe rasera pracāra
such poetry without is not of rasa the preaching

198 Sweet is the subject of his poetry, and it is rich in ornaments. Without such poetry rasa cannot be made known.

The Lord Himself asks the devotees to bestow mercy on Śrī Rūpa, whom He loves and on whom He bestows the greatest mercy —

সবে কৃপা করি' ইঁহারে দেহ' এই বর ।
ব্রজলীলা-প্রেমরস যেন বর্ণে নিরন্তর ॥ ১৯৯ ॥

sabe kṛpā kari' iṁhāre deha' ei vara
all mercy showing to him give this blessing
vraja-līlā-prema-rasa yena varṇe nirantara
of Vraja pastimes of love the rasa that he may describe unceasingly

199 All of you, be merciful and give him this blessing: that he may unceasingly describe the rasa of love in the pastimes of Vraja.

*The Lord praises Śrī Sanātana and considers him Śrī Rāya's equal in detachment and in learning — in knowledge of the *siddhānta* and the *rasa* of *prema-bhakti* —*

ইঁহার যে জ্যেষ্ঠভ্রাতা, নাম — 'সনাতন' ।
পৃথিবীতে বিজ্ঞবর নাহি তাঁর সম ॥ ২০০ ॥

iṁhāra ye jyeṣṭha-bhrātā, nāma — 'sanātana'
his who elder brother name Sanātana
pṛthivīte vijña-vara nāhi tāṁra sama
on earth most learned there is not to him equal

200 His elder brother is named Sanātana; there is no learned man on earth equal to him.

তোমার যৈছে বিষয়ত্যাগ, তৈছে তাঁর রীতি ।
দৈন্য-বৈরাগ্য-পাণ্ডিত্যের তাঁহাতেই স্থিতি ॥ ২০১ ॥

tomāra yaiche viṣaya-tyāga, taiche tāṁra rīti
your as of worldly things renunciation so his way
dainya-vairāgya-pāṇḍityera tāṁhātei sthiti
of humility detachment learning in him alone the abode

201 His renunciation of worldly things is just like yours, and humility, detachment, and learning abide in him.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Mahāprabhu said to Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya: "You have given up all sense objects and serve Kṛṣṇa exclusively. Just so Sanātana Gosvāmī, exactly like you, has left everything other than Kṛṣṇa: he is always 'humbler than a blade of grass,' that is, filled with the mood of one who owns nothing (*akiñcana*), and seeks no enjoyment apart from Kṛṣṇa, that is, he is free from the bonds of everything that is not Kṛṣṇa. He has made service to Kṛṣṇa the object of his senses and has fully mastered the knowledge of the highest devotion (*parā-bhakti*). Śrī Sanātana is the ideal embodiment of sincere humility, detachment, and learning. Exactly like you, he is knowledgeable and accomplished in pure renunciation, that is, *yukta-vairāgya*, and in learning — in knowledge of the *siddhānta* and the *rasa* of *prema-bhakti*."

[The Lord] tells how He empowered Śrī Rūpa and Sanātana and sent them to Vraja —

এই দুই ভাইয়ে আমি পাঠাইলুঁ বৃন্দাবনে ।
শক্তি দিয়া ভক্তিশাস্ত্র করিতে প্রবর্ত্তনে" ॥ ২০২ ॥

ei dui bhāiye āmi pāṭhāiluṁ vṛndāvane
these two brothers I sent to Vṛndāvana
śakti diyā bhakti-śāstra karite pravartane
power giving of devotion the scriptures to make to set forth

202 I gave these two brothers power and sent them to Vṛndāvana to set forth the scriptures of devotion."

*Rāya glorifies the Lord, seeing Him as the One who impels action (*prayojaka-kartā*) —*

রায় কহে, — "ঈশ্বর তুমি যে চাহ করিতে ।
কাষ্ঠের পুতলী তুমি পার নাচাইতে ॥ ২০৩ ॥

rāya kahe, — īśvara tumi ye cāha karite
Rāya says the Lord You whatever wish to do
kāṣṭhera putalī tumi pāra nācāite
of wood a puppet You can make dance

203 Rāya said, "You are the Lord: whatever You wish to do, You can make even a wooden puppet dance.

*In Rāya's words and in Śrī Rūpa's writings one and the same *rasa* of *prema-bhakti* is proclaimed —*

মোর মুখে যে সব রস করিলা প্রচারণে ।
সেই রস দেখি এই ইঁহার লিখনে ॥ ২০৪ ॥

mora mukhe ye saba rasa karilā pracāraṇe
my through the mouth which all rasas You made proclaiming
sei rasa dekhi ei iṅhāra likhane
those rasas I see these his in the writings

204 All the rasas You proclaimed through my mouth I now see in his writings.

*The Lord proclaims the glory of the transcendental *rasa* of Vraja through devotees moved by His will —*

ভক্তে কৃপা-হেতু প্রকাশিতে চাহ ব্রজ-রস ।
যারে করাও, সেই করিবে জগৎ তোমার বশ" ॥ ২০৫ ॥

bhakte kṛpā-hetu prakāśite cāha vraja-rasa
to the devotees out of mercy to reveal You wish of Vraja the rasa
yāre karāo, sei karibe jagat tomāra vaśa
whom You make act he will make the world to You subject

205 Out of mercy for Your devotees You wish to reveal the rasa of Vraja; whoever You empower to do it will bring the whole world under Your sway."

The Lord embraces Śrī Rūpa; Śrī Rūpa bows at the feet of the devotees —

তবে মহাপ্রভু কৈলা রূপে আলিঙ্গন ।
তাঁরে করাইলা সবার চরণ বন্দন ॥ ২০৬ ॥

tabe mahāprabhu kailā rūpe āliṅgana
then Mahāprabhu made Rūpa an embrace
tāṁre karāilā sabāra caraṇa vandana
him made do of all at the feet homage

206 Then Mahāprabhu embraced Rūpa and had him bow at everyone's feet.

Nityānanda, Advaita, and all the others embrace Śrī Rūpa —

অদ্বৈত-নিত্যানন্দাদি সব ভক্তগণ ।
কৃপা করি' রূপে সবে কৈলা আলিঙ্গন ॥ ২০৭ ॥

advaita-nityānandādi saba bhakta-gaṇa
Advaita Nityānanda and the others all the devotees
kṛpā kari' rūpe sabe kailā āliṅgana
mercy showing Rūpa all made embrace

207 Advaita, Nityānanda, and all the other devotees mercifully embraced Rūpa.

All are amazed at the Lord's mercy on Śrī Rūpa and at Śrī Rūpa's qualities that

attract Kṛṣṇa —

প্রভু-কৃপা রূপে, আর রূপের সদ্‌গুণ ।
দেখি' চমৎকার হৈল সবাকার মন ॥ ২০৮ ॥

prabhu-kṛpā rūpe, āra rūpera sad-guṇa
the Lord's mercy to Rūpa and Rūpa's good qualities
dekhi' camatkāra haila sabākāra mana
seeing amazed became of everyone the mind

208 Seeing the Lord's mercy to Rūpa and Rūpa's good qualities, everyone was amazed.

Ṭhākura Haridāsa embraces Śrī Rūpa —

তবে মহাপ্রভু সব ভক্ত লঞা গেলা ।
হরিদাস-ঠাকুর রূপে আলিঙ্গন কৈলা ॥ ২০৯ ॥

tabe mahāprabhu saba bhakta lañā gelā
then Mahāprabhu all the devotees taking went
haridāsa-ṭhākura rūpe āliṅgana kailā
Haridāsa Ṭhākura Rūpa embrace made

209 Then Mahāprabhu left with all the devotees, and Haridāsa Ṭhākura embraced Rūpa.

Haridāsa praises Śrī Rūpa's good fortune —

হরিদাস কহে, — "তোমার ভাগ্যের নাহি সীমা ।
যে সব বর্ণিলা, ইহার কে জানে মহিমা ?" ॥ ২১০ ॥

haridāsa kahe, — tomāra bhāgyera nāhi sīmā
Haridāsa says your of fortune is not limit
ye saba varṇilā, ihāra ke jāne mahimā?
what all you have described of this who knows the greatness

210 Haridāsa said, "There is no limit to your good fortune. Who can know the greatness of all that you have described?"

Śrī Rūpa expresses his humility and regards himself as an instrument in the hands of the Lord, who moves him —

শ্রীরূপ কহেন, — “আমি কিছুই না জানি ।
যেই মহাপ্রভু কহান, সেই কহি বাণী” ॥ ২১১ ॥

śrī rūpa kahena, — āmi kichui nā jāni
Śrī Rūpa says I nothing at all not know
yei mahāprabhu kahāna, sei kahi vāṇī
whatever Mahāprabhu makes speak those I speak words

211 Śrī Rūpa said, “I know nothing at all. I speak only the words that Mahāprabhu makes me speak.”

*(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Pūrva-vibhāga, the “Sāmānya-bhakti-laharī,” verse 2)*

হৃদি যস্য প্রেরণয়া প্রবর্ত্তিতোঽহং বরাকরূপোঽপি ।
তস্য হরেঃ পদকমলং বন্দে চৈতন্যদেবস্য ॥ ২১২ ॥

hṛdi yasya preraṇayā pravartito ’haṁ varāka-rūpo ’pi
in the heart whose by the prompting set to work I wretched by nature though
tasya hareḥ pada-kamalaṁ vande caitanya-devasya
of that Hari the lotus feet I worship of Caitanya-deva

212 “Though I am wretched, I have been set to this work by His prompting within my heart. I worship the lotus feet of that Hari, Śrī Caitanya-deva.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.1.2)[29]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 19.134.

Śrī Rūpa and Haridāsa converse about Kṛṣṇa —

এইমত দুইজন কৃষ্ণকথা-রঙ্গে ।
সুখে কাল গোঙায় রূপ হরিদাস-সঙ্গে ॥ ২১৩ ॥

ei-mata dui-jana kṛṣṇa-kathā-raṅge
in this way the two of talks about Kṛṣṇa in the delight
sukhe kāla goṅāya rūpa haridāsa-saṅge
happily time passes Rūpa with Haridāsa in company

213 In this way the two of them delighted in talks about Kṛṣṇa, and Rūpa happily passed his time in Haridāsa's company.

*At the end of the *cāturmāsya* the devotees who came from Gauḍa return to Gauḍa —*

চারি মাস রহি' সব প্রভুর ভক্তগণ ।
গোসাঞি বিদায় দিলা, গৌড়ে করিলা গমন ॥ ২১৪ ॥

cāri māsa rahi' saba prabhura bhakta-gaṇa
four months staying all the Lord's devotees
gosāñi vidāya dilā, gauḍe karilā gamana
the Lord leave gave to Gauḍa made departure

214 When all the Lord's devotees had stayed for four months, the Lord bade them farewell, and they returned to Gauḍa.

Śrī Rūpa stays at the Lord's feet until the Dola-yātrā —

শ্রীরূপ প্রভুপদে নীলাদ্রি রহিলা ।
দোলযাত্রা প্রভুসঙ্গে আনন্দে দেখিলা ॥ ২১৫ ॥

śrī rūpa prabhu-pade nīlādri rahilā
Śrī Rūpa at the Lord's feet in Nīlādri stayed
dola-yātrā prabhu-saṅge ānande dekhilā
the Dola-yātrā with the Lord together joyfully saw

215 Śrī Rūpa stayed at the Lord's feet in Nīlādri and joyfully watched the Dola-yātrā with Him.

The Lord empowers Śrī Rūpa —

দোলযাত্রা হৈলে প্রভু রূপে আজ্ঞা দিলা ।
অনেক প্রসাদ করি' শক্তি সঞ্চারিলা ॥ ২১৬ ॥

dola-yātrā haile prabhu rūpe ājñā dilā
the Dola-yātrā when over the Lord to Rūpa order gave
aneka prasāda kari' śakti sañcārilā
much grace showing power infused

216 When the Dola-yātrā was over, the Lord gave Rūpa His order; bestowing much grace on him, He infused him with power.

The order to go to Vṛndāvana and send Sanātana to Purī —

"বৃন্দাবনে যাহ' তুমি, রহিহ বৃন্দাবনে ।
একবার ইঁহা পাঠাইহ সনাতনে ॥ ২১৭ ॥

vṛndāvane yāha' tumi, rahiha vṛndāvane
to Vṛndāvana go you stay in Vṛndāvana
ekabāra iṁhā pāṭhāiha sanātane
once here send Sanātana

217 "Go to Vṛndāvana and stay there. Send Sanātana here once.

*In Vṛndāvana [the Lord] entrusts [Śrī Rūpa] with four kinds of service: (1) composing scriptures on *bhakti-rasa*, (2) restoring lost holy places, (3) establishing the service of the Deities and in temples, and (4) proclaiming the transcendental *bhakti-rasa* —*

ব্রজে যাই' রসশাস্ত্র করিহ নিরূপণ ।
লুপ্ত-তীর্থ সব তাঁহা করিহ প্রচারণ ॥ ২১৮ ॥

vraje yāi' rasa-śāstra kariha nirūpaṇa
to Vraja going of rasa the scriptures make exposition
lupta-tīrtha saba tāṁhā kariha pracāraṇa
lost holy places all there make known

218 Go to Vraja and set forth the scriptures of rasa, and there make known all the lost holy places.

কৃষ্ণসেবা, রসভক্তি করিহ প্রচার ।
আমিহ দেখিতে তাঁহা যাইমু একবার ॥ ২১৯ ॥

kṛṣṇa-sevā, rasa-bhakti kariha pracāra
Kṛṣṇa's service of rasa devotion make preaching
āmiha dekhite tāṁhā yāimu ekabāra
I too to see there shall go once

219 Spread the service of Kṛṣṇa and devotion in rasa. I too shall go there one day to see it."

Anubhāṣya.
That Mahāprabhu went to Vṛndāvana again is not heard of.

The Lord embraces [Śrī Rūpa]; Śrī Rūpa bows down [to Him] —

এত বলি' প্রভু তাঁরে কৈলা আলিঙ্গন ।
রূপ-গোসাঞি শিরে ধরে প্রভুর চরণ ॥ ২২০ ॥

eta bali' prabhu tāṁre kailā āliṅgana
this saying the Lord him made an embrace
rūpa gosāñi śire dhare prabhura caraṇa
Rūpa Gosāñi on his head places the Lord's feet

220 Saying this, the Lord embraced him, and Rūpa Gosāñi placed the Lord's feet on his head.

Taking leave of the devotees, Śrī Rūpa comes to Vraja by way of Gauḍa —

প্রভুর ভক্তগণ-পাশে বিদায় লইয়া ।
পুনরপি গৌড়-পথে বৃন্দাবনে আইলা ॥ ২২১ ॥

prabhura bhakta-gaṇa-pāśe vidāya laiyā
the Lord's from the devotees leave taking
punarapi gauḍa-pathe vṛndāvane āilā
again by the Gauḍa road to Vṛndāvana came

221 Taking leave of the Lord's devotees, he went back to Vṛndāvana by the road through Gauḍa.

*Hearing the account of the meeting of the Lord and Rūpa, the *jīva* devoid of consciousness (*acaitanya*) attains the feet of Caitanya —*

এই ত' কহিলাঙ পুনঃ রূপের মিলন ।
ইহা যেই শুনে, পায় চৈতন্যচরণ ॥ ২২২ ॥

ei ta' kahilāṅa punaḥ rūpera milana
thus indeed I have told again Rūpa's meeting
ihā yei śune, pāya caitanya-caraṇa
this whoever hears attains Caitanya's feet

222 Thus I have told of Rūpa's second meeting with the Lord. Whoever hears this attains the feet of Caitanya.

Anubhāṣya.
Thus ends the first chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ২২৩ ॥

śrī rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

223 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 1.36; translation as there. The edition (p. 850) prints *dāsa raghunātha* without a hyphen. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 1.15 and Madhya 1.3; translation as there. ↩
3. The same verse as Ādi 1.16 and Madhya 1.4, except the third line: here *śrīmad-rādhā* (“the beautiful Rādhā”, that is, Śrīmatī Rādhā), there *śrī śrī rādhā*; translation as there, with this difference. ↩
4. The same verse as Ādi 1.17 and Madhya 1.5; translation as there. ↩
5. The same verse as Ādi 1.18; translation as there. ↩
6. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition (p. 850) reads *śivānanda ghāṭite rahilā*, “Śivānanda stayed at the tollgate”; the earlier text had *śivānande … rākhilā*, “they detained Śivānanda”. ↩
7. The second line is the same as Madhya 7.80; translated as there. ↩
8. The same verse as Madhya 1.58; translation as there. Reference as in the edition heading (p. 853): *Kāvya-prakāśa* 1.4, *Sāhitya-darpaṇa* 1.10, *Padyāvalī* 382; in Madhya 1.58 — 386, after the numbering of other editions. ↩
9. The same verse as Madhya 1.76; translation as there. Here the edition (p. 854) prints *saṅgama-sukham* correctly. Reference as in the edition heading: *Padyāvalī* 383, a verse composed by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī; in Madhya 1.76 — 387, after the numbering of other editions. ↩
10. Source as in the edition heading (p. 854): *nyāya-vacana*, a maxim of logic. ↩
11. The speakers as in the edition heading (p. 855): *Vidagdha-mādhava*, act 1, verse 15, the words of Paurṇamāsī to Nāndī(mukhī). ↩
12. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *mādhurī* (“sweetness”) in the second line; some texts repeat *mahimā* (“glory”). ↩
13. Reference as in the edition heading (p. 855): *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Dakṣiṇa-vibhāga, Vibhāva-laharī, 138. ↩
14. *Piṇḍā* — a raised platform or veranda; in 111 Rūpa and Haridāsa sit below it (*piṇḍā-tale*). ↩
15. The same verse as 79 of this chapter (= Madhya 1.76); translation as there. Reference as in the edition heading (p. 856): *Padyāvalī* 383, a verse composed by Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī; elsewhere numbered 387. ↩
16. The same verse as 99 of this chapter; translation as there. The edition heading here gives only the reference (*Vidagdha-mādhava*, act 1, verse 15); the speakers are named in the heading to 99. ↩
17. *Śikhariṇī* (*rasālā*) is a sweet drink of curd with sugar, spices, and camphor. ↩
18. The same verse as Ādi 1.4 (= Ādi 3.4); translation as there. ↩

19. The verse has a second sense: on the full-moon night (*paurṇamāsī*) the night unites the moon, its lord, with the star Rādhā (Viśākhā). The principal sense refers to Bhagavatī Paurṇamāsī, who unites Śrī Kṛṣṇa with Rādhikā (*Anubhāṣya*, *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*). Before the verse the edition prints, in verse type, *tasyodāharaṇaṁ yathā* (“Its example:”) — a linking phrase that is not part of the verse. ↩
20. The speaker as in the edition heading (p. 860): *Vidagdha-mādhava*, act 2, verse 8, the words of Śrī Rādhā to Lalitā and Viśākhā. ↩
21. The verse is in Prakrit (in Sanskrit, *dhṛtvā praticchanda-guṇaṁ sundara mama mandire tvaṁ vasasi…*). *Mandira* here means “house”: in this love letter Rādhā says that Kṛṣṇa, in the form of a painted picture, lives in Her house (*Anubhāṣya*, *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*). ↩
22. The same verse as Madhya 2.52; translation as there. ↩
23. The speaker as in the edition heading (p. 862): “An example of Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s remorse after He had tested Her love (*rāga*).” ↩
24. Neither the verse nor the edition heading names the speaker; the *Anubhāṣya* names the one addressed, Śrīdāmā. The edition heading gives 158–159 as *Vidagdha-mādhava*, act 1, verses 23–24. ↩
25. In line 4 the edition (p. 866) reads *vibhrad-bhrū-bhramaram*, “bearing bee-like brows” (so also the *Anubhāṣya*); other editions have *riṅgad-bhrū-bhramaram*, “with brows moving like bees”. ↩
26. So in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: *kṛṣṇa-rasa-vākya*, “words about the rasa of Kṛṣṇa”; other editions read *kṛṣṇa-rasa-kāvya*, “poetry”. ↩
27. Reference as in the edition heading (p. 870): *Lalita-mādhava*, act 2, verse 10; the edition gives the same number over 191, so one of the two references is probably inexact; other editions have 2.11 here. ↩
28. Source as in the edition heading (p. 871): *prācīna-kṛta śloka*, a verse composed by an ancient author. ↩
29. The same verse as Madhya 19.134; translation as there. Reference as in the edition heading (p. 872): *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Pūrva-vibhāga, Sāmānya-bhakti-laharī, verse 2. ↩
30. So in the edition (*prabhu*, “the Lord”); in verse 140 it is Rāmānanda Rāya who asks. ↩
31. In the head word of the gloss the edition reads “…*viṣaya-saṁsāra*…” (as does the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: “worldly existence”), while the verse and the explanation have *viṣamā* (harsh); translated according to the verse (checked against the scan). ↩

32. So in the edition (checked against the scan). Verse 17 concerns Śivānanda's dog; the *āmukha* and *prastāvanā* are explained in the *Anubhāṣya* on Antya 1.71 — the digits are probably transposed. ↩
33. The words “An example of this” (*tasyodāharaṇaṁ yathā*) are printed in the edition in the bold type of the verses, between verses 135 and 136; they are absent from the verse translation. ↩
34. Bakī is Pūtanā, the sister of the demon Baka. ↩
35. The edition's gloss has a negative (*tulanāṁ na arhati*); the verse reads *tulanām arhati* (“with what can it be compared?”). The sense is the same: there is nothing to compare it with. ↩
36. So in the edition (checked against the scan): both verse 190 and verse 191 are marked “Act 2, verse 10.” ↩